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Tough draws await Sujeet, Antim, Aman in Asian Games



Opposition escalates SIR battle

The Congress raised the ante on Tuesday as INDIA bloc leaders plan to discuss a joint agitation

DEEPAK KUMAR JHA
New Delhi

The Congress on Tuesday demanded the removal of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar, immediate suspension of the SIR, restoration of names struck off from the electoral rolls and the resignation of Prime Minister Narendra Modi on moral grounds.

The party made the demand after a two-and-a-half hour meeting of the Congress Working Committee (CWC) chaired by Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge and attended by former party chiefs Sonia Gandhi and Rahul Gandhi, and general secretaries Jairam Ramesh, KC Venugopal, Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, among others.

"History bears witness that ten years ago, this very prime minister devastated India's economy with the decision of *notebandi* (demonetisation). And now, ten years later, he is destroying our robust democracy through a conspiracy of *votebandi* (voter disenfranchisement)'," the Congress chief said.



Congress President and LoP in the Rajya Sabha Mallikarjun Kharge along with Congress Parliamentary Party Chairperson Sonia Gandhi, LoP in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi and MP KC Venugopal during Congress Working Committee (CWC) meeting on Tuesday PTI

In his opening CWC address, Kharge also put forward five demands of his party, including making public the complete data regarding every major change made to the electoral rolls and providing political parties with the electoral rolls and relevant data in a simple format and in a timely manner.

Kharge also demanded an independent and time-bound inquiry wherever evidence of serious discrepancies emerges. That voters whose names have been removed must be fully informed and given an opportunity to appeal, and there must be such transparency in the critical data and decisions related to the election process so that no party has grounds to claim that information is being withheld, the Congress chief said.

At the CWC, a resolution was passed which said it recognises that what was once Rahul Gandhi's solitary conviction has become a nationwide demand for accountability, transparency, and the restoration of the sanctity of India's electoral system.

Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi told the CWC that EVM and voters' list "match-fixing" of polls was underway in the country and asserted that his party should not budge from the path of *virodh* (opposing) as well as *pratirodh* (resistance) from streets to Parliament, sources said.

During the meeting, the Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha pointed out that the Congress had been raising the "vote chori" issue strongly and talked about irregularities in polls in Haryana, Karnataka and Maharashtra but many were sceptical of it, sources said.

CONTINUED ON >> P4



The attack lead by Smriti Irani was an effort to dispel perceptions that the ruling party was on the back foot on the SIR issue WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Irani launches BJP's SIR counterstrike

RAJESH KUMAR
New Delhi

Amid Opposition's nationwide protests against the functioning of the poll body, BJP National General Secretary Smriti Irani on Tuesday accused the Congress of "tearing apart" India's constitutional framework.

Speaking to reporters at the BJP headquarters, Irani questioned the Opposition's objections the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of voter rolls citing the Election Commission of India's (ECI) clarification on the issue. She also criticised the Congress for invoking the Lahore Congress session, where the historic resolution for *Purna Swaraj* was adopted, while attacking the poll panel.

"If a name appears as a duplicate on the electoral roll, or if the name of a deceased person appears on the electoral roll, why does the Congress Party want it restored? Why does the Congress Party want duplicate names to remain on the electoral roll? Why does the Congress Party want to ensure that duplicate names persist on the electoral rolls? " Irani questioned.

The retaliation was an effort to dispel perceptions that the ruling party was on the back foot on the SIR issue. This was her first media interaction after being appointing general secretary and in charge of UP affairs.

The reaction came after a Congress Working Committee (CWC) meeting chaired by party president Mallikarjun Kharge demanded the immediate removal of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar, suspension of the SIR, restoration of over 13 crore names struck off from the electoral rolls and the resignation of Prime Minister Narendra Modi for allegedly manipulating elections.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

Trump unveils Essar's $18b steel push in US

SAGAR KULKARNI
Washington

President Donald Trump announced Essar-backed Mesabi Metallics' $18 billion investment to build a fully integrated American steel company, including what he called the "largest steel plant in American history" in Iowa.

The investment includes a proposed $15 billion steel complex in Iowa and about $3 billion invested in an iron ore mine and pelletizing facility in Minnesota.

The project, which is expected to begin production by 2030, will produce



President Donald Trump speaks in the Oval Office of the White House AP

about 10 million tonnes of steel a year and employ at least 1,750 people once operational, according to the White House and the company.

"Today, we're thrilled to announce that Mesabi Metallics will be building the largest steel plant in American history in the great state of Iowa," Trump said at the White House, where he appeared alongside Essar Group founder and vice chairman Ravi Ruia and his son, Rewant Ruia, chairman of Mesabi Metallics, a US-based company owned by Essar.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

The ByStander



PIONEER IN SHORT

ASSAM RIFLES PATROL COMES UNDER FIRE

A 42-year-old Assam Rifles jawan was killed and four others injured after their patrol team came under suspected militant fire along the India-Myanmar border in Arunachal Pradesh's Changlang district on Tuesday, officials said. The attack took place around 6.30 am near Nampong Nallah, under Nampong circle, as personnel of the 21 Assam Rifles were patrolling an area where border fencing work is underway. Havildar Jankhokai Kuki was killed in the firing, while the four injured personnel were evacuated for medical treatment. Their condition was not immediately known. Security forces have intensified operations in the area following the incident.

FOUR KILLED IN CISF FIRING INCIDENT

Four CISF personnel, including an assistant commandant, were killed after a colleague allegedly opened fire at a hydroelectric power project in Jammu and Kashmir's Kathua district on Tuesday evening, officials said. The incident occurred around 7.30 pm at the Sewa-III hydroelectric power project in Mashka village, Basohli, near the Himachal Pradesh border. Preliminary information suggested that CISF Head Constable Abhidesh Kumar allegedly opened fire with his service rifle following an argument with colleagues. Four personnel suffered critical injuries and later succumbed to their injuries at a nearby NHPC hospital. The deceased were identified as Assistant Commandant Ankit Kumar Pandey, Sub-Inspector Lakshman Singh and constables Rafiq Ahmed and Sandeep Kumar.

DELHI SEEKS CHINA ROUTE FOR FLIGHTS

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

India is exploring an aviation corridor through China to reduce the extra cost and time airlines face because of the ongoing closure of Pakistani airspace, Civil Aviation Minister Ram Mohan Naidu said on Tuesday.

The proposed route would pass through the Hotan area



Indira Gandhi International Airport, Delhi. Representative image WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

of southwestern Xinjiang. It could provide Indian airlines with a shorter connection to destinations in Europe, North America and parts of Central Asia.

Naidu said India's Union Ministry of External Affairs was engaged with Chinese authorities on the issue, while cautioning that discussions were still underway.

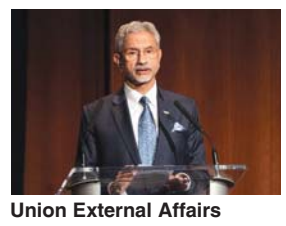
CONTINUED ON >> P4

EAM raises terror concerns amid India-US trade strains

ASHOKE RAJ New Delhi

Union Minister for External Affairs S Jaishankar has said India's relationships with its partners, including the US, could be affected if New Delhi's concerns over cross-border terrorism are not adequately understood.

Speaking at an Asia Society event in New York alongside former US diplomat Daniel Russel, Jaishankar said India-US relations had encountered several challenges, including prolonged trade



Union External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar addresses an event at Asia Society, in New York, US AP

negotiations, uncertainty surrounding US tariffs and differences over India's concerns about terrorism linked to Pakistan.

"For us in India, what is particularly important is the issue of terrorism," he said, arguing that India had experienced a sustained form of terrorism from a neighbouring country that New Delhi considers deliberate and State-supported.

"If something which matters so deeply to us, there isn't enough understanding or appreciation or empathy of that, I think that creates a problem too," Jaishankar said.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

Amit Shah opens Barapullah phase III, promises smoother east-south link

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Tuesday inaugurated five road infrastructure projects worth Rs 1,941 crore in the national Capital, including the long-pending Barapullah Phase-III elevated corridor, which is expected to reduce travel time between east and south Delhi.

Shah inaugurated the projects at a function at Barapullah attended by Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, her Cabinet colleagues and Union Minister of State for Road Transport Harsh Malhotra, among others.

CONTINUED ON >> P4



Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Delhi CM Rekha Gupta with others during the launch of four major road projects including the Barapullah Phase 3 elevated corridor PTI

Goldy Brar's FBI listing puts India's UAPA terror list in focus

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
New Delhi

A day after Canada-based Satinderjeet Singh, better known as Goldy Brar, was added to the FBI's Ten Most Wanted Fugitives roster, India's Fourth Schedule of the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, which lists designated terrorists is back in focus. It currently lists 80 names. Brar was added to the list by the Union Ministry of Home Affairs in January 2024. In New Delhi's records, he is serial number 56.

Official records identify him as son of Shamsher Singh and Preetpal Kaur, originally of Sri Muktsar Sahib, Punjab, and



A poster published by the FBI on Monday FBI.GOV

last recorded as living in Brampton, Canada. The gazette notification said he was associated with Babbar Khalsa International, had been involved in multiple killings, and used drones to move arms and explosives across the Indian border.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

GOLDEN MOMENT



India's Neeru Dhanda poses with the national flag during the victory ceremony for the women's trap shooting individual event at the 20th Asian Games 2026, in Nagoya, Japan AP

Rare two-sex carp discovered in Tehri Dam

VINOD CHAMOLI New Tehri

Scientists in Uttarakhand have documented hermaphroditism in the common carp found in the Tehri Dam reservoir. Identifying specimens with both male and female reproductive organs, researchers at the Fish Reproduction and Conservation Biology Research Lab of the Hemvati Nandan Bahuguna Garhwal Central University (HNBGU) claimed such instances were found abroad in the past but this is the first instance in India.

The finding could add a new dimension to the study of fish reproduction and environmental influences in Himalayan freshwater ecosystems. The observation was made during an annual population assessment and reproductive biology study of common carp by head of the NK Agarwal and research scholar Jyoti Bisht.



Common Himalayan carp WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Agarwal said that the finding goes beyond simply recording an unusual reproductive condition and provides a foundation for further investigation into the reproductive biology of fish. The influence of environmental factors such as thermal stratification or altered hydrological regimes in large Himalayan dam reservoirs may influence phenotypic plasticity in fishes, potentially affecting the genetic and physiological mechanisms underlying reproductive differentiation under environmental stress or atypical ecological conditions.

Researchers said that while common carp typically exhibit distinct male or female sexes, the identified fishes exhibited clear, co-existing male and female reproductive structures, prompting scientific documentation of the strange reproductive condition. The finding assumes significance as common carp fish is an economically and ecologically important freshwater fish species, and changes in its reproductive characteristics can offer valuable clues about new reproductive stage, population dynamics and environmental adaptation.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

DDA launches interactive GIS-based map for Master Plan 2047 land use

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Delhi residents will no longer need to visit DDA offices or rely on intermediaries to check a property's land-use status, as the Delhi Development Authority has launched a GIS-based interactive digital map of the Land Use Plan under the Master Plan for Delhi-2047.

People can now access information about the designated land use of their area or property online, without visiting civic or local body offices or relying on third parties for such basic information.

According to the DDA, the GIS-based interactive Land Use Plan of MPD-2047 is available on the official DDA website under the "Master Plan for Delhi-2047" section. Citizens and other stakeholders can search for a particular area, location, or property and view its designated land-use category directly on the map.

The digital map brings together different planning information through multiple thematic layers, including Land Pooling Areas and Transit-Oriented Development (TOD) Zones, along with Dwarka Sub-City,



Rohini Project Layout, PMUDAY Colonies, DDA Parks and other thematic layers. The MPD-2047 layer enables users to view proposed land use across different parts of Delhi. In contrast, the Land Pooling and TOD layers help identify areas covered or proposed under these planning frameworks.

The Land Use Plan displays nine major land-use categories, namely Residential, Commercial, Industrial, Recreation, Transport, Utility, Government, Public and Semi-Public Facilities, and Agriculture & Water Body. Each category is represented through distinct colour coding for easy identification.

The interactive map lets users search for specific locations, zoom down to the plot level, and pinpoint a particular area or property, making it easier to understand a property's designated land use and its surroundings. Unlike conventional 2D maps prepared at a fixed scale, the digital map provides a more detailed and location-specific view.

The platform also includes practical measurement and drawing/sketching tools. Users can effortlessly measure distances and dimensions on the map, such as the width or length of a road or plot. They can also mark or sketch directly on the platform for their own personal reference and analysis.

The GIS-based Land Use Plan is designed to be continuously updated as new data becomes available, keeping land-use and planning information current and relevant while enabling the planning framework to respond more dynamically and effectively to changes in Delhi's spatial characteristics.

Making the Land Use Plan and thematic layers available on a single digital platform will benefit not only citizens but also planners, professionals, government agencies, and other stakeholders by providing convenient access to relevant planning information for preliminary planning and infrastructure and development-related assessments. It will promote greater transparency, improve access to planning information, and support Ease of Doing Business.

Furthermore, this GIS-based approach also provides a strong foundation for integrating multi-sectoral and multi-agency spatial data, aligning with national initiatives such as the Atal Mission for Rejuvenation and Urban Transformation (AMRUT) and the PM Gati Shakti National Master Plan.

48 villages get urban tag, MCD to hire 70 sweepers amid AAP ruckus

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

The Municipal Corporation of Delhi's House meeting on Tuesday, otherwise devoted to civic reform, was disrupted by an alleged confrontation between AAP councillors and security personnel at the entry gate. The House approved a raft of decisions ranging from urbanising 48 villages to procuring new sanitation machinery, while enforcement teams continued demolishing illegal structures across the city.

Leader of the House Jai Bhagwan Yadav expressed serious concern over the incident, alleging that AAP Leader of Opposition Ankush Narang and other party councillors misbehaved with security personnel deployed at the Municipal House while entering the premises, and engaged in pushing and shoving with them.

Yadav said the House meeting was proceeding smoothly, with councillors engaged in meaningful discussions on pollution, unauthorised construction and other issues of public interest, when AAP councillors, who had not participated in the discussion at the start of the meeting, arrived nearly two hours late.



The Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD)'s house of councillors meeting at the Civic Centre in New Delhi on Tuesday PANKAJ KUMAR

He alleged that when Narang arrived to enter the House, security personnel asked him to use the designated entry gate, following which Narang and some accompanying councillors argued with the personnel and allegedly engaged in pushing, shoving and misbehaviour.

"Security arrangements are not meant for any particular party or individual; they are in place for the security of the entire Municipal House. Preventing security personnel from performing their duties, pushing or shoving them, or misbehaving with them cannot be justified under any circumstances," Yadav said.

"The Opposition has every right to put forward its views, and dissent is an important part of democracy. However, the appropriate means of expressing disagreement should be through the rules of the House and the democratic process," he said.

Amid this friction, the House still pushed through several decisions with direct bearing on residents' daily lives. It approved declaring 48 villages on Delhi's outer fringes as urbanised under Section 506(A) of the Delhi Municipal Corporation Act, a move Deputy Mayor Monika Pant said would accelerate the expansion of civic amenities and infrastructure in these areas.

The House also approved procurement of 70 new mechanical road sweepers to strengthen dust control, and 1,000 vacuum-based, battery-operated litter picker machines to improve sanitation efficiency on roads and public spaces.

Beyond the headline decisions, councillors across party lines raised ward-specific issues, from sanitation and road conditions to infrastructure gaps and unresolved local grievances.

Pant separately alleged that AAP councillors were largely missing from discussions on serious issues such as pollution and illegal construction, urging elected representatives to rise above political differences and play a constructive role in the House.

As part of its ongoing crackdown on unauthorised construction, the Corporation carried out 33 demolition actions across all 12 zones on Tuesday, sealed 12 properties and issued three fresh demolition orders for violations of the Master Plan of Delhi and Building Bye-Laws.

This followed an even larger sweep a day earlier, when 29 properties were demolished and 10 sealed across the city.

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E-AUCTION SALE NOTICE
(Under SARFAESI Act 2002)

APPENDIX- IV-A [SEE PROVISO TO RULE 8(6) & 9(1) SALE NOTICE FOR SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTIES

E-Auction Sale Notice for sale of Immovable Assets under the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 read with proviso to Rule 8(6) & 9(1) of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002.

Notice is hereby given to the public in general and in particular to the borrower(s) and guarantor(s) that the below described immovable property mortgaged / charged to the Central Bank of India (secured creditor), the constructive/ physical Possession of which have been taken by the authorized officer of Central Bank of India(Secured creditors), **will be sold on "As is where is", "As is what is" and "whatever there is" basis on date 16.10.2026** for recovery of dues to the **Central Bank of India** from below mention Borrower(s) and Guarantor(s). The Reserve Price and Earnest money deposit (EMD) is displayed against the details of respective properties.

E-AUCTION SCHEDULED TO BE HELD ON 16.10.2026 (15 DAY'S NOTICE)

S. No.	Name of Branch	Authorised Officer / B.M.	Name of the Account / Property ID on E-Baanknet Portal	Description of Property & Owner Name	Demand Notice Date & Amount Dues (in Rupees)	Date & Type of Possession	In Rupees: Reserve Price / EMD / Bid Increase
1.	Akshardham New Delhi	Mr R.S.Mishra Mob: 8800013551	Puja Enterprises / CBIN02845441	Shop No.317, Part Of Old Office No 10, 11, 12 On Third Floor Property R-22 Out Of Khasra No.473 Building Khaneja Complex Shakarpur Village Madawali Fazalpur Delhi-110092, Area 180 Sqft Owner: Dinesh Kumar Yadav	25.02.2020 Rs.54.84 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	10.02.2023 (Physical)	₹ 10,00,000.00 / ₹ 1,00,000.00 / ₹ 10,000.00
2.	Patel Nagar New Delhi	Mr. Vinod Meena Mob: 9694707646	Harendra Kumar / CBIN402505	Ground Floor Without Roof Right Plot No.C-28 Khasra No. 1541 Keshav Kunj, Hadbast Gram, Rasaipur, Pargana-Dasna Thesil & Distt Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh. Area -667.36 Sq Ft **Owner- Mr.Harendra Kumar,**	09.08.2023 Rs.15.33 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	04.06.2025 (Physical)	₹ 13,00,000.00 / ₹ 1,30,000.00 / ₹ 10,000.00
3.	Usmanpur Delhi	Mr Hussain Ali Mob: 9568431985	Ram Darash Ram / CBIN352401	MIG Flat No GF-2 (Without Roof Rights), Plot No. B-12/11, DLF Ankur Vihar, Vill Sadullabad, Pargani Loni, Dist- Ghaziabad, U.P. Area 700 Sq Ft **Owner - Ram Darash Ram**	23.10.2018 Rs.22.26 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	19.02.2019 (Physical)	₹ 12,00,000.00 / ₹ 1,20,000.00 / ₹ 12,000.00
4.	Vasundhara Ghaziabad	Mr. Anand Jaiswal Mob: 8800013545	Akash Sharma / CBIN497205	Flat No SF-5,Second Floor (With Roof Rights), Back Side, LIG, Plot No A-7/6,DLF Ankur Vihar, Loni Ghaziabad. Area: 37.16 Sqmt **Owner - Akash Sharma**	12.09.2023 Rs.17.33 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	16.01.2026 (Physical)	₹ 7,35,000.00 / ₹ 73,500.00 / ₹ 10,000.00
5.	Arthala Ghaziabad	Mr. Naveen Kumar Mob: 9220402685	Chander Kali / CBIN402401	Flat No SF-2, LIG, Second Floor, Back Side, Plot No. A-2/15, DLF Ankur Vihar, Loni, District Ghaziabad-Uttar Pradesh. Area 37.16 Sq Mtr **Owner: Chander Kali**	20.09.2021 Rs.8.90 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	21.07.2022 (Physical)	₹ 6,50,000.00 / ₹ 65,000.00 / ₹ 10,000.00
6.	Usmanpur Delhi	Mr. Husnain Ali Mob: 9568431985	Deepak Tiwari / CBIN3524001	Free Hold Residential Property Bearing No. A-113, Second Floor, Pvt Flat No. SF-1, Front Left Side (South West), With Roof /Terrace Rights, Situated At Colony Known As SLF Ved Vihar, Pargana Loni, Tehsil & Distt Ghaziabad , Uttar Pradesh, 201102 Area- 400 Sq Ft. **Owner- Sh. Deepak Tiwari S/o Shri Ganesh Tiwari**	21.05.2024 Rs.11.29 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	19.07.2025 (Physical)	₹ 10,45,000.00 / ₹ 1,04,500.00 / ₹ 10,000.00
7.	Usmanpur Delhi	Mr. Husnain Ali Mob: 9568431985	Mushahid Alam / CBIN3524002	Property Bearing No. F-32 & F-33, Ground Floor, Pvt Flat No. GF-2, Without Roof/Terrace Rights, Situated At Colony SLF Ved Vihar, Pargana- Loni, Tehsil and Distt. Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh- 201102 Area - 400 Sq Ft **Owner- Mushahid Alam S/o Jamshed Alam**	28.05.2024 Rs.10.45 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	19.07.2025 (Physical)	₹ 10,40,000.00 / ₹ 1,04,000.00 / ₹ 10,000.00
8.	Vasundhara Ghaziabad	Anand Jaiswal Mob: 8800013545	Vishal Kumar Sharma / CBIN497205	Residential Flat, Ist Floor (Without Roof Rights), Part of Rudra Niwas On Khasra No. 380, Indergarhi, Vill. and Paragna Dasna, Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh-201001. Area 70 Sqm **Owner - Vishal Kr Sharma & Premlata Sharma**	02.09.2020 Rs.18.78 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	20.12.2021 (Physical)	₹ 12,50,000.00 / ₹ 1,25,000.00 / ₹ 10,000.00
9.	Vasundhara Ghaziabad	Anand Jaiswal Mob: 8800013545	Anita Sharma / CBIN497216	Residential Builder Flat,On Part of Khasra No.380, Out of Four Storey Building, Ground Floor, Without Roof Rights, Vill-Indergarhi, Paragna Dasna, Near Block-C, Govindpuram, Ghaziabad Uttar Pradesh-201001, Area 60 SqMt **Owner - Anita Sharma**	29.02.2020 Rs.21.30 Lakh + Other Charges Applicable Deductions/ Repayments	16.11.2021 (Physical)	₹ 12,20,000.00 / ₹ 1,22,000.00 / ₹ 10,000.00

E-AUCTION DATE: 16.10.2026, TIME: 12:00 NOON TO 04:00 PM WITH AUTO EXTENSION OF 10 MINUTES

Last Date & Time of Submission of EMD and Documents (Online) On or Before: 16.10.2026 Upto 03:30 PM.

Bidder will register on website: **https://BAANKNET.com** and upload KYC documents and after verification of KYC documents by the service provider, EMD to be deposited in **BAANKNET** EMD wallet through NEFT/RTGS/Transfer / Generation of challan from (**https://BAANKNET.com**). The auction will be conducted through common landing platform BAANKNET.com Portal (**https://BAANKNET.com**). E-auction will be held "As is where is", "As is what is" and "whatever is there is" basis. **(All other charges/dues to the property will be borne by the purchaser).**

For detailed terms and conditions please refer to the link provided in **www.centralbank.bank.in** Secured Creditor or auction platform (**https://BAANKNET.com**). **Helpdesk: (+91) 8291220220, E-mail: support.BAANKNET@psballiance.com**

STATUTORY 15 DAY'S SALE NOTICE UNDER RULE 8(6) & 9(1) OF THE SARFAESI ACT, 2002

Borrowers/Guarantors/ Mortgagors are hereby notified to pay the sum as mentioned above along with upto date interest and ancillary expenses before the date of e-auction, failing which the property will be auctioned/sold and balance dues, if any, will be recovered with interest and cost.

DATE: 29.09.2026
PLACE: DELHI

Authorised Officer,
CENTRAL BANK OF INDIA, RO Delhi (North), Delhi

Public Notice

This is to inform the general public that Mr. Siddhant Anand is the owner of Flat no. A-7, on Third Floor (Front Side), without roof right, covered area measuring 92.90 Sq. Mtrs, Plot no. 88, out of Khasra no. 357, Situated at Anand Vihar Colony, Village Nasarpur, Pargana Loni, Tehsil & District Ghaziabad, U.P. through Sale Deed dated 24.08.2022 as doc.no. 9466 executed by Mr. Yash Pal Sharma in favour of Mr. Siddhant Anand in respect of Said Flat.

The owner had misplaced the document is Original Sale Deed dated 25.01.2017 doc. no. 393 executed by Mrs. Satyawati Sharma in favour of Mr. Pramod Kumar in respect of Flat no. A-7, on Third Floor (Front Side), without roof right, super covered area measuring 92.90 Sq. Mtrs, Plot no. 88, out of Khasra no. 357 for which complaint is regd. vide Application No.- 20260000986001, registered at P.S. Police Computer Center, Technical Services HQ, Lucknow on 27.09.2026. Anyone who finds the above-mentioned documents is requested to hand over the same to the Manager of ICICI Home Finance Co. Ltd., Plot No. 17, 1st Floor, Vishwakarma Complex, 18, Behind Yashoda Hospital, Kaushambi, Ghaziabad - 201010.

Mr. Siddhant Anand intends to transfer the ownership of above said flat by way of Sale Deed to Mrs. Shivani Singh. Subsequently, Mrs. Shivani Singh is in the process of mortgaging the said flat with ICICI Home Finance Co. Ltd. Any objections or concerns regarding this transaction should be raised within a period of 15 days from the date of this public notice. Any objections submitted after the completion of this 15-days period will not be considered binding with respect to the said property or the interests of our client.

If anyone wishes to raise an objection, please do so within the stipulated 15-days period by contacting Law Veritas: North (Advocates & Legal Consultants) at Office No. 11, 1st Floor, Building No. A-44/A, Sector-16, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301; Landline(s): +91012-04499711, e-mail: accounts@lvnorth.in

Public Notice

This is to inform the general public that Mr. Dinesh Tomer is the owner of Residential Plot No. 2/232, admeasuring 127.50 sq. mtrs., situated at Sector-02, Yojna No. 10, Madhavpuram, Meerut, Uttar Pradesh through Sale Deed dated 25.05.2022 as doc. no. 7799 executed by Mrs. Suman Jain in favour of Mr. Dinesh Tomer in respect of Said Plot.

The owner had misplaced the documents are 1) Original Sale Deed Cum Freehold Deed dated 30.11.2004 as doc. no. 9166 executed by Uttar Pradesh Avas and Vikas Parishad in favour of Mrs. Anita Jain in respect of Plot No. 2/232, admeasuring 1250 sq. mtrs., situated at Sector-02, (2) Original Allotment Letter issued by Uttar Pradesh Avas and Vikas Parishad in favour of Mrs. Anita Jain in respect of said property, (3) Original Possession Letter issued by Uttar Pradesh Avas and Vikas Parishad in favour of Mrs. Anita Jain in respect of said property for which complaint is regd. vide Application No.- 20260000976585, registered at P.S. Police Computer Center, Technical Services HQ, Lucknow on 24.09.2026. Anyone who finds the above-mentioned documents is requested to hand over the same to the Manager of ICICI Home Finance Co. Ltd., Meerut.

Mr. Dinesh Tomer intends to transfer the ownership of above said plot by way of Sale Deed to Mr. Arun Kumar. Subsequently, Mr. Arun Kumar is in the process of mortgaging the said Plot with ICICI Home Finance Co. Ltd. Any objections or concerns regarding this transaction should be raised within a period of 15 days from the date of this public notice. Any objections submitted after the completion of this 15-days period will not be considered binding with respect to the said property or the interests of our client.

If anyone wishes to raise an objection, please do so within the stipulated 15-days period by contacting Law Veritas: North (Advocates & Legal Consultants) at Office No. 11, 1st Floor, Building No. A-44/A, Sector-16, Noida, Uttar Pradesh-201301; Landline(s): +91012-04499711, e-mail: accounts@lvnorth.in.

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given on behalf of **Mr. Rajeev Goel and Mrs. Madhu Goel** who are owner of ENTIRE SECOND FLOOR & THIRD FLOOR along with 50% undivided share of stilt parking, along with 50% back side roof/terrace rights up to sky level PART OF PROPERTY BEARING NO.C-1/82, LAND AREA MEASURING 283.33 SQ.YDS. OR SAY 236.89 SQ. MTRS., situated in the layout plan of Wazirpur Residential Scheme, Phase-II, presently known as Ashok Vihar, Phase-II, Delhi-110052 vide Partition Deed dated 28.09.2026, Registration No.2026/80/II/196, Book No.I, Volume No.23, page 31 to 56 on this dated 28.09.2026, **That, 1). SMC of late Mr. Kashmiri Lal Gupta expired on 10.12.2002 and 2). SMC of late Mr. Radhey Shyam Goel expired on 28.05.2019 are lost/misplaced/not available**, now **Mr. Rajeev Goel and Mrs. Madhu Goel** intend to mortgage the subject property with **UTKARSH SMALL FINANCE BANK LIMITED** against the financial assistance. So, to comply the requirements of BANK/NBFC, we give this public notice that if any Person having any type of claim/right/title/interest creating mortgage over the said property, may inform in writing, at the address mentioned below, about his objections, within **07 days** from today, failing which it shall be presumed that the said property is free from all type of Encumbrances, lien etc. **Lucem Legal LLP** N-161, Ground Floor, Saira Tower, Gautam Nagar Near Yusuf Sarai Community Centre,New Delhi-110049 Contact # 011-40046316 & 41667327

BSES
BSES Rajdhani Power Limited, New Delhi

NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR SHORT TERM PURCHASE OF POWER FOR THE PERIOD 01st April' 2027 TO 30th Sep' 2027 Tender No. Head (PMG)/BRPL/E Tender/2026-27/923

In accordance with the guidelines for short term procurement of power notified by the Ministry of Power and directions issued by Hon'ble DERC, BRPL has floated power procurement tender with the General Terms and Conditions for purchase of power and same is available on e-Bidding portal www.mstcecommerce.com & www.bsesdelhi.com .

Bidders are requested to kindly visit above website and submit the competitive purchase offers on www.mstcecommerce.com.

Last date of bid submission is 08th Oct' 2026 up to 15:00 hrs and Opening of non financial technical Bids is 09th Oct' 2026 at 11:00 hrs

Address:- **Head PMG**, BSES Rajdhani Power Ltd., BSES Bhawan, 2nd Floor, D-Block, Nehru Place, New Delhi – 110019 Tel: (Tel: 011-49209037)

Regd. Off. : BSES Rajdhani Power Limited, BSES Bhawan, Nehru Place, New Delhi-110019
Corporate Identification No.: U40109DL2001PLC111527
Telephone No. : +91 11 4910 7235
Website : www.bsesdelhi.com

नीलामी सूचना

दिए गए कार्यक्रम के अनुसार "जो जहाँ है जैसा है" के आधार पर जर्जर भवन एवं कमरों को तोड़ने, सोल्वेज्डमटेरियल को अधिकार में लेने सहित मोजूदा ढांचे के डिसमेंटेलिंग सामग्री की स्थल से सफाई के उद्देश्य हेतु निम्न लिखित पुराने व असुरक्षित ईमारत की नीलामी:–

Sr. No.	Block	Name of School	No. of unsafe declared rooms	Time limit from date of auction	Reserve price of auction	Place of auction	Date of auction
1.	F.P. Khirka	GPS Ghata Shabsabad	3	1.5 months	93551	BEO Office NUH	06-10-2026 at 11 AM
2.	Nagina	GSS Umra	7	1.5 months	314779		
3.	NUH	GPS Mehrka	3	1.5 months	112402		
4.	NUH	GPS Adbar	8	1.5 months	222290		
5.	NUH	GPS Gundabas	6	1.5 months	139622.81		
6.	NUH	GPS Ranika	2	1.0 months	12951		
7.	NUH	GPS Chhapra	7	1.0 months	247662		
8.	NUH	GPS Nababgarh	2	1.0 months	41156		
9.	NUH	GPS Kamarchand Pur	4	1.5 months	117402.56		
10.	NUH	GPS Muradbas	2	1.0 months	46066		
11.	NUH	GPS Kherla	4	1.5 months	49199		
12.	NUH	GPS Untka	4	1.5 months	131647		
13.	NUH	GPS Terakpur	4	1.5 months	48605		
14.	NUH	GPS Hirmathla	3	1.5 months	34421		
15.	NUH	GPS Indri/ PM Shri GSSS	6	1.5 months	174813		
16.	NUH	GSSS Ghasera	2	1.0 months	18718		
17.	NUH	GGSSS Ghasera	1	1.0 months	12961		
18.	NUH	GSSS Kherla	12	1.5 months	523110		
19.	NUH	GPS Qutubgarh	2	1.0 months	23517		
20.	NUH	GPS Badwa	1	1.0 months	48901		
21.	NUH	GHS Bhirawati	3	1.5 months	10149		
22.	Tauru	GPS/GSSS Chharora	4	1.5 months	47759	BEO Office Tauru	06-10-2026 at 03 PM
23.	Tauru	GPS Pipaka	2	1.0 months	34259		
24.	Tauru	GPS Bhutlaka	2	1.0 months	61689		
25.	Tauru	GPS Didhara	4	1.5 months	107905		
26.	Tauru	GPS Fatehpur	2	1.0 months	27995		
27.	Tauru	GPS Gurnawat	7	1.5 months	123887		
28.	Tauru	GPS Kharkhari	1	1.0 months	10152		
29.	Tauru	GPS Malhaka	6	1.5 months	79474		
30.	Tauru	GPS Bhajlaka	1	1.0 months	1292		
31.	Tauru	GPS Kaliyaki	2	1.0 months	59612		
32.	Tauru	GPS Gogjaka	1	1.0 months	16246		
33.	Tauru	GPS Chundhika	1	1.0 months	10750		
34.	Tauru	Gmssss Tauru	1	1.0 months	30101		
35.	Tauru	Gsss Pachgaon	1	1.0 months	47759		
			120		3082803.37		

शर्तें:–

1. प्रत्येक बोलीदाता को जिला शिक्षा अधिकारी, नूंह के पक्ष में बैंक ड्राफ्ट के रूप में खण्ड अनुसार स्कूलों की 10% रुपये की राशि (खण्ड नूंह, नगीना, फिरोजपुर झिरका 242392.3 रुपये एवं खण्ड तावडू–65888.1/– रुपये) बोली के लिए योग्यता प्राप्त करने के लिए 2 दिन पूर्व जिला शिक्षा अधिकारी कार्यालय नूह में श्री सतवीर लिपिक को जमा करवानी होगी जोकि सफल बोलीदाता को छोड़कर नीलामी की समाप्ति पर वापिस कर जापनी।
2. सफल बोलीदाता का बोली राशी का 100: 2 दिन के अन्दर अन्दर उपरोक्त विद्यालय अनुसार सम्बंधित विद्यालय मुखिया के पक्ष में बैंक ड्राफ्ट बैंक के माध्यम से जमा करवाना होगा। असफल रहने पर जमा करवाई गई बैंक ड्राफ्ट के रूप जमा 10% रुपये की राशि जब्त कर जी जाएगी।
3. ईमारत अनुमोदन जारी के 1.5 माह में ईमारत तोड़ी जानी चाहिए तथा स्थल सोल्वेज्डरहित होना चाहिए जिसके असफल रहने पर शेष सोल्वेज्डपर सरकार द्वारा कब्जा ले लिया जायेगा।
4. पार्टियों के मध्य किसी भी विवाद में न्यायिक क्षेत्राधिकार नूंह का होगा।
5. बोनी के समय किसी भी बोलीदाता द्वारा विवाद किया जाता है तो उसकी 10% राशि जब्त कर ली जाएगी एवं बोली में भाग लेने से वंचित कर दिया जायेगा।
6. अगर अपरिहार्य परिस्थितियों के कारण डिसमेंटेलिंग के लिए ईमारत का कब्ज़ा समय में नहीं दिया जाता है तो ठेकेदार को कोई राहत नहीं दी जाएगी। केवल समय बढ़ाया जायेगा।

नोट– बोलीदाता बोली व नीलामी होने से पहले स्थल (विद्यालय की असुरक्षित ईमारत) को देख सकते हैं।

प्रत्येक गाँव में सम्बन्धित प्राचार्य द्वारा मुनादी करानी होगी जिसमे अगर उस गाँव का कोई भी व्यक्ति बोली लगाना चाहता है तो उसके लिए विशेष छूट रहेगी। उसको अपने गाँव के लिये 10% स्कूल की राशि दो दिन पूर्व जिला शिक्षा अधिकारी कार्यालय में DD / CASH के माध्यम से जमा करानी होगी।

जिला शिक्षा अधिकारी,
नूंह।

kotak Kotak Mahindra Bank

NOTICE

Locker Hired by **MRS. BASHNEET KAUR SEHGAL** having address at **G-5 SAI APPTT ROHINI SECTOR-13 DELHI -110085** with **KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK** Situated at **F-19/12 BASEMENT AND GROUND FLOOR SECTOR 8 ROHINI, DELHI-110085** remains un-operated from last 9 years & 6 Months and the rent due for the last 8 years & 5 Months.

All the 3 letters earlier sent to **MRS. BASHNEET KAUR SEHGAL** calling her to clear dues and to operate the locker has returned unserved and she is not contactable.

It is hereby informed that despite this notice, if dues not cleared and locker is not operated by **MRS. BASHNEET KAUR SEHGAL** within 90 days from the date of this notice, break open of the said locker will be done on **December 29, 2026** at around **12p.m.**

kotak Kotak Mahindra Bank

NOTICE

Locker Hired by **MR. ANIL KUMAR** having address at **E-50 1ST FLOOR SECTOR-1 ROHINI PARK VIEW OFFICERS ENCLAVE DELHI - 110085** with **KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK** Situated at **F-19/12 BASEMENT AND GROUND FLOOR SECTOR 8 ROHINI, DELHI-110085** remains un-operated from last 8 years & 6 Months and the rent due for the last 4 years& 5 Months.

All the 3 letters earlier sent to **MR. ANIL KUMAR** calling him to clear dues and to operate the locker has returned unserved and he is not contactable.

It is hereby informed that despite this notice, if dues not cleared and locker is not operated by **MR. ANIL KUMAR** within 90 days from the date of this notice, break open of the said locker will be done on **December 29, 2026** at around **12p.m.**

Although every possible care and caution has been taken to avoid errors or omissions, this publication is being sold on the condition and understanding that information given in this publication is merely for reference and must not be taken as having authority of or binding in any way on the writers, editors, publishers, and printers and sellers who do not owe any responsibility for any damage or loss to any person, a purchaser of this publication or not for the result of any action taken on the basis of this work. All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent court and forums in Delhi/New Delhi only. Readers are advised and requested to verify and seek appropriate advice to satisfy themselves about the veracity of any kind of advertisement before responding to any contents published in this newspaper. The printer, publisher, editor and any employee of the Pioneer Group's will not be held responsible for any kind of claim made by the advertisers of the products & services and shall not be made responsible for any kind of loss, consequences and further product-related damages on such advertisements.

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The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

Dreaded gangster Goldy Brar, wanted by India and US

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
New Delhi

The Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) on Monday added Satinderjeet Singh, known as Goldy Brar, to its Ten Most Wanted Fugitives list and posted a reward of up to $1 million for information leading to his arrest. The move has drawn fresh attention to India's own roster of designated terrorists, where the Punjab-born fugitive already sits at serial number 56.

Satinderjeet Singh, widely known as Goldy Brar, is a fugitive from Punjab and is alleged to be one of the senior members of the organised crime group led by Lawrence Bishnoi. He was born on 11 March 1994 in the Sri Muktsar Sahib district of Punjab, India, although some documents give other dates in 1994. His father, Shamsher Singh, served as an assistant sub-inspector with the Punjab Police before retiring; his mother's name is Preetpal Kaur.

Brar grew up in the Malwa region and later became linked to some villages in the Faridkot area. As a teenager, he ran afoul of the law in a 2012 incident under provisions relating to endangering safety, as well as several local cases that ended in his acquittal through settlements. Around 2017, his family arranged for him to go to Canada on a student visa. There, he took on a variety of jobs, including truck driving, before, according to the authorities, becoming a main overseas coordinator for the Bishnoi network.

Brar is referred to as Bishnoi's reliable lieutenant in North America. The man who is currently imprisoned in India is accused of running a transnational operation via illegal means of communication.

It is alleged that Brar passed on instructions, oversaw his associates, and controlled activities in India, Canada, the United States, and Mexico. He can speak both Punjabi and English. According to US authorities, he has connections in Sacramento and Fresno, California, and is known to live in California and in certain areas of Canada. The FBI views him as extremely violent, armed and dangerous and believes he poses an escape risk.

A large number of cases have been filed against him by Indian authorities covering charges of murder, attempted murder, extortion, criminal conspiracy, and offences relating to weapons.



FBI has added gangster Satinderjeet Singh alias Goldy Brar to its list of Ten Most Wanted Fugitives and announced a reward of USD one million for information leading to his arrest PTI

He is alleged to have been responsible for the killing in February 2021 of Gurlal Singh Pehalwan, a youth leader of the Faridkot Congress, the act being carried out as revenge for the death of a cousin. The most well-known accusation is that of the 29 May 2022 assassination of Sidhu Moose Wala, the Punjabi singer and politician, in the Mansa district.

A social media post that was linked to Brar took responsibility and connected the shooting with previous gang feuds, mentioning in particular the death of the student leader Vicky Middukhera. India issued an Interpol Red Notice, later declared him a terrorist under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, and alleged that he had associations with Babbar Khalsa International, was involved in arms smuggling, and carried out cross-border activities. Canada's BOLO programme included him among its top 25 most-wanted fugitives.

A federal warrant was served in the United States on 1 July 2026 in the Central District of California. The accusations made include conspiracy to form racketeering-influenced and corrupt organisations, conspiracy to interfere with commerce by means of extortion, and conspiracy to distribute controlled substances.

The prosecutors claim that the Bishnoi organisation carried out targeted assassinations of political and religious figures, as well as shootings, murders, kidnappings, assaults, and the trafficking of narcotics and weapons.

A notable accusation is that Bishnoi and Brar instructed the killing on 18 June 2023 of the Sikh activist Hardeep Singh Nijjar outside a temple in Surrey, British Columbia.

Other allegations concern huge extortion demands in Southern California and his role in cocaine shipments and in stealing from rival traffickers in the Los Angeles area. On 28 September 2026, the FBI added Brar to its Ten Most Wanted Fugitives list as the 543rd name and offered a reward of up to one million dollars for information leading to his arrest. He is still at large. All US charges are allegations pending trial.

Cabinet approves ₹394 cr for 30 EV sweepers, ₹19 cr for IIT pollution study



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

For residents of narrow lanes and smaller roads across Delhi, where mechanised cleaning has never reached, relief may finally be on the way. The Delhi Cabinet, chaired by Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday, approved two decisions aimed at tackling pollution, one to bring mechanised sweeping to smaller roads for the first time, and another to build a real-time system for tracking where the capital's pollution actually comes from.

Under the first decision, the Delhi Municipal Corporation will receive a grant to procure 30 electric vehicle-based mechanical road sweeping machines, extending mechanised cleaning to roads previously left out of the system. The initiative will cover around 609 km of roads with a right of way of less than 10 metres, spanning 854 roads across 250 wards, precisely the kind of narrow neighbourhood streets residents have long complained get overlooked.

The Chief Minister said the Delhi Government would fund the initiative while MCD would deploy and operate the machines on the ground. The deployment of the 30 EV-based machines is estimated to cost around ₹393.73 crore over 10 years, with electric machines chosen to keep the cleaning process itself environmentally friendly. Under the second decision, the Cabinet approved a partnership with IIT Delhi for continuous, real-time source apportionment of PM2.5 and PM10 pollution.

The Chief Minister said the system would scientifically analyse major pollution sources and their quantities round the clock, helping identify how much of Delhi's pollution comes from vehicular emissions, road dust, biomass burning and other sources.

As part of the project, the existing super site at Rouse Avenue will be reactivated for scientific operations, along with the mobile laboratory, enabling targeted studies of pollution hotspots and local sources. The collaboration with IIT Delhi will run for five years at an estimated cost of ₹19.22 crore, covering the super site and mobile lab restart, a real-time public dashboard, analytical reporting, and capacity building for DPCC officials.

The Chief Minister said the Delhi Government did not view pollution merely as a winter problem, but was working continuously and scientifically on its sources throughout the year, with support and guidance from the Central Government and Prime Minister Narendra Modi. She said various Government departments, the Delhi Pollution Control Committee, the municipal corporation and scientific institutions were working together on concrete steps against pollution.

She said the government's effort was to tackle every major source of pollution simultaneously, from road dust and vehicular emissions to construction and demolition dust, industrial pollution, waste and biomass burning, while increasing green cover and strengthening enforcement.

The Chief Minister said the two Cabinet decisions complemented each other, one strengthening ground-level action, the other strengthening the science behind it, together reflecting a strategy that combines funding, inter-agency coordination, clean technology and scientific expertise to tackle pollution at its source.

She reiterated that the government's pollution control campaign runs year-round, not just during Delhi's high-pollution winter months, with sustained work on road dust, vehicular emissions, construction dust, industrial pollution, waste burning, green cover, enforcement and public participation.

MHA officials held for seeking bribe for FCRA registration

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
New Delhi

The Delhi Police Special Cell, in cooperation with central agencies, arrested two Government officials in New Delhi after the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) received specific information about alleged demands for illegal gratification linked to the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act (FCRA) registration process.

The arrested duo, a Senior Accountant and the Accountant, are said to have gone to an association and asked for an illegal payment in exchange for helping it with its pending FCRA registration. One of the two officials now works in the Foreigners Division of the MHA, while the other, currently in a Pay & Accounts Office, previously worked in the same division.

Initial questioning suggests both people had been contacting various organisations to arrange the registration and renewal of their FCRA permissions in exchange for illegal bribes. Further investigation is still going on.

The FCRA regulates the receipt and use of foreign contributions by associations, non-governmental organisations and other bodies in India. Eligible organisations that wish to accept foreign funds for particular purposes must register or obtain prior approval under the Act.

The Ministry handles applications and related services through a special online portal.

The Ministry has again stated that it provides all FCRA services solely through this portal and that no intermediary, agent, or individual has the authority to assist with any FCRA service.

The MHA has made it clear that it has a zero-tolerance policy on corruption. Suitable legal and departmental measures are currently being taken in this instance.

The fact that officials in office are being apprehended shows how seriously allegations of misusing one's official position in regulatory procedures are taken.



If such cases are proven, they not only damage the public's confidence in administrative systems but also put at risk the integrity of a system meant to guarantee transparency and accountability when foreign contributions are received.

This situation shows that departments responsible for sensitive regulatory matters require careful attention. Officials posted in sections dealing with FCRA scrutiny hold positions of trust. Any effort to use that position for personal gain amounts to a serious violation of service rules and criminal law.

The coordinated action involving the Ministry, the Delhi Police Special Cell and other central agencies is an example of the institution taking immediate action in response to specific information rather than waiting for formal complaints to develop.

"If you are applying for or renewing your FCRA registration, use only the official online portal and official channels. Contacting unauthorised people who say they can help may lead to legal trouble or financial loss.

The Ministry has clearly warned both officials and associations not to seek or offer private help", a senior MHA official said.

Investigators are still looking into how many people were contacted, how many associations were involved, and whether any payments have already been made.

The MHA will decide what happens to the two officials after the inquiry, depending on the findings and any charges.

Namo Bharat rolls out trip pass for daily commuters



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

For the commuter who has memorised every platform announcement between Sarai Kale Khan and Modipuram, who counts the days between recharges the way others count paydays, NCRTC has finally offered a small mercy: the Trip Pass, a way to buy the daily grind in bulk and walk past the ticket counter from now on.

Namo Bharat currently carries over 1.1 lakh commuters every single day, and a sizeable share of them are not casual travellers but creatures of habit, moving between the same two points morning and evening, week after week. The Trip Pass is built around this rhythm. Instead of buying a fresh ticket or topping up an NCMC card each time, these commuters can now load multiple trips onto their card in one transaction, letting the system quietly deduct the fare each time they pass between their chosen stations, sometimes several times in a single day.

The arithmetic behind the launch is telling. A single Sarai Kale Khan to Modipuram journey costs ₹210 in Standard Coach and ₹250 in Premium. Against the NCMC wallet's maximum recharge limit of ₹2,000, a commuter making that round trip daily would burn through the entire balance in as little as four days, sometimes less than a week, meaning near-constant recharges to keep moving. The Trip Pass is designed to interrupt that cycle, letting commuters plan and pay for a stretch of journeys in one sitting rather than returning to a counter every few days.

Jamia suspends PhD student for over canteen protest; AISA demands rollback

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The Jamia Millia Islamia has suspended a PhD student for five days for allegedly participating in an unauthorised gathering at the university's central canteen and "inciting" students to breach discipline.

The action followed a protest on September 28 against the recent eviction of hostel residents, particularly women hostellers, the All India Students' Association (AISA) said and demanded immediate revocation of the action.

According to a show-cause notice issued by the university's Chief Proctor, the PhD (Sociology) student was suspended with immediate effect from September 28 till October 2 and barred from entering the university campus during the period.

The notice alleged that the student participated in an "unauthorised gathering" at the central canteen on September 28 and delivered a speech promoting what the university termed "misleading accounts and rumours" among students. It further alleged that his actions incited other students to breach discipline.

The university said the gathering, held at around 5 pm, disrupted the routine functioning of the north campus and affected teaching, learning and research activities in nearby classrooms, laboratories and libraries.

The notice also cited provisions of the university's ordinances on student discipline and directed the student to explain "why the Discipline Committee should not impose a higher punishment".

In a statement, AISA's Jamia unit condemned the suspension. It alleged that the student had been targeted for speaking in solidarity with women students and raising issues concerning hostel accommodation and living conditions.

The student organisation questioned the university's action, saying the protest raised concerns over the distribution of hostel accommodation, the living conditions of residents, and the quality of food served in hostels.

AISA also alleged that the administration's action violated the right to peaceful protest and referred to a Delhi High Court order on students' right to protest.

The student organisation said it would continue its protest until the suspension was withdrawn and also raised broader concerns over what it described as an "ongoing suspension raj" at Jamia.

No Eligible Voter to be excluded and No ineligible Person to be included

Special Intensive Revision, Delhi

SIR 2026 DELHI

In case of any person to whom notice has been issued during the ongoing SIR

(There is no longer a need to visit the ERO/AERO office for a hearing.)

BLOs will now visit voters homes to collect the necessary documents. Please provide the BLO with the documents prescribed by the Election Commission of India.

Scan the provided QR code for information regarding the relevant documents.

Revised SIR Schedule

Revision Activities	Revise Schedule
Period for filling claim & objections	31.08.2026 to 30.10.2026
Notice Phase/Disposal of claims & objections	31.08.2026 to 30.11.2026
Final publication	04.12.2026

Fill Appropriate Form:

FORM-6
Application for inclusion of Name in Electoral Roll for new voter.
Eligible voters whose name does not reflect in the electoral roll Please fill Form-6 (Along with the Declaration Form)

Form 7: Objection for Proposed Inclusion/Deletion of Name in Existing Electoral Roll.

Form 8: For Correction to particulars entered in Electoral Roll

Fill out and submit the form:
1. At the ERO / AERO office
2. With the BLO
3. At designated locations

To fill out the above forms online, visit the Citizen Service Portal:
voters.eci.gov.in Or Use the ECINet Mobile App

Special camps will be organized at all educational institutions (colleges, universities) in Delhi for new and young voters aged 18 and above on September 30, and October 7 and 8, 2026, from 9:00 AM to 3:00 PM.
BLO will be available to assist you.

Special camps will be organized at all polling stations in Delhi on October 4 and 11, 2026, from 10:00 AM to 5:00 PM.
BLO will be available to assist you.

Note: Fill out Forms 6, 7, and 8 by 30/10/2026, to ensure the electoral roll is accurate and up-to-date.

For matters related to claims and objections or to check your name in the electoral roll, visit: voters.eci.gov.in or www.ceodelhi.gov.in

ECINet app

voters.eci.gov.in

Chief Electoral Officer, Delhi
Old St. Stephen's College Building, Kashmere Gate, Delhi – 110006
Websites: www.ceodelhi.gov.in, voters.eci.gov.in

Voter Helpline No. 1950

Follow: /ceodelhioffice

DIP/Shabdarth/Display/0100/26-27

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

IN FOCUS



Police personnel stop the Congress workers as they burn an effigy and stage a protest against CEC Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in SIR process in Ahmedabad, Gujarat on Tuesday PTI

Delhi CP conducts surprise night checks in South Delhi

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Commissioner of Police (CP) Delhi Anurag Kumar carried out surprise night inspections in South Delhi on Monday. Special Commissioner Neeraj Thakur and other senior officers, including Sanjay Kumar Jain, Vijay Kumar, Anant Mittal, and field staff, joined him. The CP's night inspection aimed to prioritise citizens' safety and maintain law and order.

The inspection included the Pink Booth at Lady Shri Ram College, nearby areas, the National Park and Central Park, and Arun Jaitley Park in Hauz Khas. The goal was to check nighttime security arrangements and review recent safety measures in these parks.

At the Pink Booth and around the college, the CP and his team checked how police were deployed, how visible they were, and whether the booth was helping students and the public. They looked at lighting, CCTV, gates, where security staff were posted, and how access was controlled. The team focused on routes students use after dark and nearby areas that are quieter at night.

Next, the team visited National Park and Central Park. These parks are busy during the day but have different security challenges at night. Officers walked through the parks, checked entrances and exits, ensured lighting covered all paths, and confirmed cameras and gates were working. They also checked whether security staff were present and alert. In Hauz Khas, the team checked the same things: lighting on walkways and corners, CCTV coverage, the condition of gates and boundaries, and whether enough staff were on duty.

The visit was intended not only to check existing arrangements but also to test whether earlier instructions on patrols, dark-spot identification, and coordination with civic agencies were translating into visible night-time security.

During the inspections, officers spoke with students and residents. People shared worries about moving around at night, poor lighting, and wanting police to be more visible and approachable. Senior officers assured everyone that keeping women and the public safe after dark is a top priority, and that these inspections help make sure orders from headquarters are followed on the ground.

The CP told South district police to increase patrols, including on foot and by motorcycle during vulnerable hours, and to improve and supervise security measures. Officers were asked to closely monitor lighting, cameras, gates, and access; report any problems quickly to the right agencies; and remain present around colleges, parks, and nearby public spaces. These inspections are part of a larger effort to make Delhi's public spaces safer at night, especially for women and students.

Rains lash parts of Mumbai



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Mumbai

Parts of Mumbai witnessed heavy rains on Tuesday evening, with waterlogging reported in some low-lying areas, including the Andheri subway, officials said.

The eastern and western suburbs of Mumbai received more rain compared to the island city areas. Some parts of south Mumbai received only light showers.

The India Meteorological Department (IMD), in a nowcast issued at 7 pm, warned of thunderstorms accompanied by lightning, light spells of rain and gusty winds reaching 30-40 kmph at isolated places in Mumbai in the next three hours.

The IMD issued a yellow warning for the city and advised people to take precautions. According to BMC officials, rain gauges at Kala Killa Municipal School (Dharavi) recorded 14 mm, Rawali Camp (Sion) 10.8 mm, F North Ward Office (Matunga) 10.2 mm, Wadala Fire Station (Wadala) 9.14 mm and Dadar Fire Station (Dadar) 8.8 mm of rainfall.

In the western suburbs, Aarey Colony Municipal School (Goregaon) recorded 64 mm, Banana Leaf and Juhu Dispensary 55.4 mm, Malpa Dongari Municipal School (Andheri) 50.2 mm, K East Ward Office (Andheri East) 48.2 mm and Versova WWTF and Lagoons (Versova) 45.4 mm of rain.

In the eastern suburbs, MCMCR (Powai) recorded 59.4 mm of rain, followed by Paspoli Powai Municipal School (Powai) 53 mm and Building Proposal Office (Vikhroli West) 44.4 mm. S Ward Office (Bhandup) and Tagore Nagar Municipal School (Vikhroli) recorded 35.8 mm and 33.6 mm of rain, respectively.

NCERT Class 9 book traces goddesses in warfare

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Worship of goddesses was a long standing tradition in India and many kings and princes since the seventh century continued to invoke goddesses such as Kali, Durga, Bhavani and other forms of Shakti as protectors in times of conflict, the new class 9 social science textbook prepared by NCERT says.

The book titled "Understanding Society India and Beyond-Part 2" was released on Tuesday, six months after the new academic session began. The first part of the textbook was released in June.

The chapter titled "Resistance and Resilience", which has documented successive invasions of Indian subcontinent since the 7th century, has also described religious traditions in warfare.

"Worship of goddesses was a long standing tradition in India. The worship of goddesses including Kali, Durga and Bhavani is described as a longstanding practice, with rulers invoking Shakti forms as protectors in conflicts.

"Annamaraja, ruler of Bastar is believed to have received his sword from Manikyadevi (Danteshvari) while Kumara Kampana (Vijayanagara) was believed to have used a goddess-given sword against the Sultanate forces at Madurai. Similarly, Shivaji is also traditionally believed to have obtained a sword from goddess Tulja Bhavani," it reads.

The chapter says the Indian subcontinent witnessed successive invasions since the seventh century driven by territorial expansion and religious motives and documents how and when Indian rulers and communities mounted resistance against Arab, Turkish, Mughal and European forces.

According to NCERT chief Dinesh Saklani, "Social Science learning at this (secondary) stage is expected to cultivate analytical and discursive abilities, encourage critical inquiry, promote intercultural understanding, and enable learners to participate with confidence and responsibility in civic and social life."

UP Council polls: BJP announces 4 candidates

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Gorakhpur

The BJP on Tuesday announced four candidates for the Uttar Pradesh Legislative Council polls, voting for which is scheduled to be held on October 23.

A list issued by the BJP office in New Delhi mentioned the names of Kedar Nath Singh (Varanasi Graduates' constituency), Dinesh Goel (Meerut Graduates'), Ashok Kumar Rathore (Allahabad-Jhansi Graduates'), Dr Pramod Mishra (Varanasi Teachers'), Hari Kishore Tiwari (Agra Teachers') and Dhruv Tripathi (Gorakhpur-Faizabad Teachers' constituency).

A graduates' constituency is one in which only graduates from any recognised Indian university, or those with an equivalent qualification, are qualified to be enrolled in the voter rolls. Similarly, in a teachers' constituency, only a full-time teacher at a secondary school or higher for at least three years out of the previous six years is eligible to vote.

Earlier, Uttar Pradesh Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) Navdeep Rinwa announced the schedule for the 2026 biennial polls to five graduates' and six teachers' constituencies of the state Legislative Council.

The last date for filing nominations will be October 6, while the scrutiny of the nominations will take place on October 7. Candidates can withdraw their nominations till October 9.

Polling will be held from 8 am to 4 pm on October 23, and the counting of votes will take place on October 27. The entire election process will be completed before October 31, the CEO had said.

Customs intercepts three with drones, parts worth ₹1.03 crore at IGI Airport

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Customs officers at IGI Airport have booked three Indian passengers for smuggling drones and drone parts worth ₹1,03,55,900, after intercepting them at Terminal-3 following their arrival from Hong Kong via Vietnam on September 25, 2026.

The passengers arrived on Flight No VN593 dated September 25, 2026 from Hong Kong to Vietnam, and Flight No VN981 dated September 25, 2026 from Vietnam to Delhi. During customs proceedings, the passengers were intercepted and subjected to a baggage search.

The search led to recovery of ten Autel Robotics MDX-1 drones, eleven remote controllers for Autel Robotics MDX-1 drones, ten AC/DC adaptors, ten USB chargers, twenty data cables, ten remote controller lanyards, sixty propellers, ten gimbals with payload cameras, twenty remote controller antennas, ten power cables for Autel Robotics MDX-1 drones, ten remote controller stands, forty remote controller joysticks, one Autel ESC PCBA used, four plastic arms, and one used iPhone 18 Pro Max with 512 GB storage.

A chartered engineer called upon by customs officers reported that the drones are professional grade, fitted with thermal imaging and laser range-finder capabilities, classifying them as military or defence-grade Unmanned Aerial Vehicles that require mandatory DGCA registration for each drone. The total market value of the recovered items was assessed at ₹1,03,55,900.

The recovered drones, parts and the iPhone were seized under Section 110(1) of the Customs Act, 1962, in the presence of independent witnesses, vide detention receipts numbered 67050 dated September 26, 2026, 67051 dated September 26, 2026, 67052 dated September 26, 2026 and 67053 dated September 26, 2026.

According to customs officials, the passenger stated that the drones and parts had been brought by him from Hong Kong for one of his friends, who is the real owner of the goods, and that he had intentionally smuggled the drones into India without declaring them before customs authorities and without payment of applicable customs duty. Further investigation into the matter is under process, according to a press release issued by Shankar Prasad Sarma, Additional Commissioner of Customs, IGI Airport, New Delhi, on September 27, 2026.

FROM PAGE - 1

Opposition escalates SIR battle

Chief ministers of Congress-ruled states — DK Shivakumar (Karnataka), V D Satheesan (Kerala), A Revanth Reddy (Telangana) and Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu (Himachal Pradesh) — also participated in the meeting.

On Wednesday, the top leaders of the INDIA bloc will meet to finalise an action plan for a joint agitation over alleged irregularities in the SIR exercise and to press for the CEC's resignation. A draft notice to move a motion in the Lok Sabha and the Rajya Sabha seeking the removal of CEC would be deliberated upon for approval at the meeting, sources added.

Besides the top Congress leadership, TMC's Mamata Banerjee and Abhishek Banerjee, and leaders from parties such as the SP, the CPI, the CPI(M), the NCP(SP) and the Shiv Sena (UBT), among others, will participate in the meeting. The DMK and the AAP will not be part of the meeting.

EAM raises terror concerns amid...

He added that when a partner country does not fully appreciate one of India's primary concerns, it can have an effect on the broader relationship.

The comments come as New Delhi and Washington continue to work through trade-related differences while managing wider disagreements over tariffs and their respective approaches to relations with other major powers.

He explained that India's large agricultural sector, small producers and manufacturing base made trade negotiations particularly complicated because any agreement had to take into account a wide range of domestic interests.

According to Jaishankar, there is now broadly an understanding on the trade agreement, although uncertainty remains over changes in the US tariff regime. He referred to developments following the US reciprocal-tariff measures and said a new process under Section 301 was still evolving. Jaishankar also discussed India's approach to maintaining relationships with multiple countries, describing the international system as increasingly multipolar. He recalled an earlier period when some voices in Washington argued that India should limit its strategic options and place greater emphasis on its relationship with the US. According to Jaishankar, that approach has changed as countries increasingly engage with several major powers simultaneously.

He pointed to Washington's relationships with China, Russia, Ukraine, Europe and countries across Asia as examples of this broader diplomatic approach. Jaishankar said India had long pursued a similar strategy, maintaining relationships with different countries while protecting its own strategic interests.

Jaishankar's comments followed his criticism of Pakistan during the United Nations General Assembly's high-level session in New York.

Without naming Pakistan Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif, Jaishankar accused Pakistan of misrepresenting facts at the UN and described Islamabad as a "serial practitioner of terrorism".

He said India would continue to exercise its right to defend itself against terrorism and argued that friendship and goodwill could not coexist with terrorism. Sharif had referred in his UN address to the four-day military confrontation between India and Pakistan in May 2025, which followed India's Operation Sindoor. He invoked Pakistan's right to self-defence under Article 51 of the UN Charter and credited US President Donald Trump with intervening during the confrontation.

India has maintained that the ceasefire that ended the May 2025 hostilities resulted from direct communication between New Delhi and Islamabad and was not the product of third-party mediation.

Jaishankar also highlighted the growing influence of public opinion on foreign policy in the era of social media.

He said diplomacy was no longer conducted exclusively by governments, political leaders, ministers and diplomats. Public reactions and wider societal engagement, he noted, now play a greater role in shaping the environment in which foreign policy is pursued.

Irani launches BJP's SIR counterstrike

"Talking about history, then the Congress should also speak about AO Hume, who served as the Secretary in the Department of Revenue, Agriculture, and Commerce in the then British government. It is historically documented that AO Hume had discussed with the then Viceroy that 'formation of the Congress party was essential to provide protection of the British empire'," she claimed. She questioned whether Congress was raising similar concerns about the ECI in states such as Himachal Pradesh, Punjab, Kerala and Karnataka, where the BJP is not in power In a veiled reference to Rahul Gandhi, the BJP leader said that in 2019, the outgoing national president of the Congress party had stated that he would make every possible effort to tarnish PM Modi's image.

Prime Minister Modi has repeatedly said that they may criticise or attack him, but such attacks by the Congress should not turn into assaults on constitutional institutions or India's democracy, the BJP national general secretary said. "Yet, the Congress leadership is leaving no stone unturned in its attempt to undermine India's constitutional systems," she charged.

Trump unveils Essar's $18b steel push in US

Mesabi Metallics said the project will create more than 8,000 construction jobs and generate an estimated $95 billion in economic output during construction and the first 10 years of operations.

The company is developing the Minnesota mine in Nashwauk on the Mesabi Iron Range. It is expected to produce about 7.5 million tonnes of iron ore a year and employ about 350 people once fully operational.

The mine is expected to be the first new iron ore mine built in the United States in 50 years, according to the company and the White House.

The Minnesota operation will supply direct-reduction-grade iron ore pellets to the Iowa complex, creating what Mesabi Metallics describes as a fully integrated, domestic "mine-to-mill" steel supply chain. (*PTI*)

Delhi seeks China route for flights

Under the proposed arrangement, flights departing from Delhi and Mumbai would travel towards Leh before entering Chinese airspace near Hotan. From there, aircraft will proceed towards Kyrgyzstan and connect with established international routes serving Europe and North America.

Indian carriers have been using longer routes to avoid Pakistani airspace after its closure following the April 2025 Pahalgam terror attack. The diversion has required flights from northern and western India to travel south over the Arabian Sea before reconnecting with their international routes. A person familiar with the matter said airlines operating from the north and northwest are taking the L639 route, flying via Bhopal and Ahmedabad, crossing the Arabian Sea before heading towards Oman, to bypass Pakistani airspace, adding as much as two hours to some flights. The longer routes have increased fuel consumption and operating expenses for Indian carriers, with the impact particularly significant for Air India because of its extensive long-haul network from Delhi and Mumbai.

Campbell Wilson, Air India's former chief executive, estimated in 2025 that the airline incurred losses of about ₹4,000 crore as a result of the Pakistani airspace closure. However, the alternative route through China remains under discussion. Naidu did not indicate that the two countries had reached an agreement.

Rare two-sex carp discovered in Tehri Dam

The discovery has also opened a broader research window. Scientists can now investigate whether environmental conditions, genetic plasticity, evolutionary mechanisms or other biological factors may be associated with the occurrence of hermaphroditism in the freshwater fishes. In an era of increasing human pressure on freshwater ecosystems, such observations could help researchers examine how fish reproductive strategies respond to changing ecological conditions.

The study also underscores the scientific importance of the Tehri dam reservoir as a site for studying Himalayan aquatic biodiversity. Researchers believe that systematic monitoring of fish populations could help establish links between new reproductive strategies in fish populations, environmental changes and long-term population stability.

Goldy Brar's FBI listing puts India's UAPA...

Interpol issued a Red Notice in 2022. The National Investigation Agency has listed a reward of Rs 10 lakh and chargesheeted him in cases that include the May 2022 murder of singer Sidhu Moosewala and later blast and extortion probes.

A US federal warrant issued in Los Angeles on 1 July accuses him of racketeering conspiracy, extortion and narcotics conspiracy as the alleged North American leader of the Lawrence Bishnoi organised crime group. The FBI says the network carried out targeted killings, kidnappings, shootings and drug trafficking in California, elsewhere in the United States and in Canada.

Masood Azhar occupies the first place in the Fourth Schedule of the Unlawful Activities.

The 58-year-old was released from Tihar Jail in December 1999 in exchange for hostages of the hijacked Indian Airlines flight IC-814. Within a year, he built Jaish-e-Mohammed (JeM). Indian holds Azhar responsible for the December 2001 attack on Parliament, the 2016 Pathankot airbase attack and the February 2019 Pulwama bombing that killed 40 CRPF personnel. The United Nations listed him as a global terrorist in May 2019.

Hafiz Muhammad Saeed (76) is number two. The Lashkar-e-Tayyiba (LeT) founder is accused of orchestrating the November 2008 Mumbai attacks that killed 166 people. He has been on the UN sanctions list since December 2008. Zaki-ur-Rehman Lakhvi, LeT's long-time operational commander, occupies the third slot and faces the same UN listing.

Dawood Ibrahim Kaskar (71) is number four. The former Mumbai mafia, long reported to be in Pakistan, is wanted for the 1993 serial bombings that killed more than 250 people. The UN placed him on its Al-Qaida sanctions list in November 2003, citing support for Osama bin Laden and the Taliban. Indian records also accuse him of arms smuggling, drug trafficking, counterfeiting currency and terror financing.

Khalistani militants based abroad also figure prominently in the list. Wadhawa Singh Babbar, chief of the banned Babbar Khalsa International, ranks fifth. Lakhbir Singh Rode of the International Sikh Youth Federation ranks sixth. Ranjeet Singh alias Neeta, chief of the Khalistan Zindabad Force, ranks seventh. Other early names include Germany-based KZF operative Bhupinder Singh Bhinda and the founder of Sikhs for Justice Gurpatwant Singh Pannun.

Amit Shah opens Barapullah phase III...

The Barapullah Phase-III project, built at a cost of Rs 1,635 crore, was originally approved in 2014 and work began in 2015. It was initially scheduled for completion in 2017 but faced multiple delays, leading to a significant escalation in its cost.

The Delhi Government had planned another bridge over the Yamuna in 2014 to ease traffic from east Delhi and the National Capital Region towns of Noida and Ghaziabad towards central Delhi, where commuters rely on routes including the ITO and Nizamuddin bridges and National Highway 24.

"One of the unique features of Phase III is an extradosed bridge over the Yamuna. Such bridges use much shorter stay towers than cable-stayed bridges, such as the Signature Bridge," an official said.

In 2021, one of the pillars supporting the bridge tilted due to the strong flow of the Yamuna during the monsoon. Work on the bridge was subsequently halted during the monsoon season each year, officials said.

The corridor has nine loops to facilitate traffic movement in different directions, along with a footpath and a cycle track connecting Mayur Vihar Phase-I to the Ring Road.

The flyover will merge with the existing Barapullah flyover at Sarai Kale Khan, completing a stretch of around 10 km.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

No external role in Kashmir: MEA

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi


Ministry of External Affairs spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal

India has rejected Turkish President Recep Tayyip Erdogan's reference to Kashmir during his address to the United Nations General Assembly (UNGA), asserting that the issue concerns the country's territorial integrity and sovereignty and leaves no role for external parties.

Responding to questions about Erdogan's remarks at a press briefing on Tuesday, Ministry of External Affairs spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said India had taken note of the Turkish president's comments but rejected what New Delhi described as unwarranted references to India and the Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir.

"This is a matter pertaining to India's territorial integrity and sovereignty, and no external party has any locus standi on this issue," Jaiswal said.

Erdogan had raised the Kashmir issue during his UNGA address on September 22, calling for disputes in South Asia to be resolved through dialogue and within the framework of the United Nations Charter and relevant resolutions.

"In South Asia, it is important that all disputes, including the Kashmir issue, be addressed through dialogue within the framework of the United Nations Charter and of relevant resolutions," Erdogan said.

Turkey has previously raised the Kashmir issue at international forums, despite India's longstanding position that the matter should not be subject to third-party intervention.

New Delhi has consistently maintained that Jammu and Kashmir is an integral part of India and that any issues concerning Kashmir with Pakistan should be addressed bilaterally.

India's position was reiterated following the Pahalgam terror attack, with the Government stating that any future engagement with Pakistan on Kashmir-related matters would remain bilateral.

Turkey's position on Kashmir has emerged as a recurring point of diplomatic friction between New Delhi and Ankara, particularly as Turkey has maintained close strategic ties with Pakistan.

The issue has also featured against the backdrop of expanding security cooperation among Turkey, Pakistan and Saudi Arabia. The three countries signed what has been described as the "Mecca Pact" in August, establishing a framework for closer defence and security cooperation.

India, meanwhile, has continued to oppose internationalisation of the Kashmir issue and has maintained that questions concerning its sovereignty and territorial integrity are matters for India to address in accordance with its established bilateral position with Pakistan.

PIL filed in HC over LPU protest

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Chandigarh



A PIL was filed in the Punjab and Haryana High Court seeking a CBI probe into the vandalism and violence at Lovely Professional University in Phagwara.

Shopkeepers on the campus counted heavy losses after masked miscreants allegedly broke into stores and decamped with mobile phones, gadgets and other goods during the unrest.

A B Tech student of Lovely Professional University (LPU) filed the public interest litigation (PIL) plea, which is likely to be heard by the bench of Chief Justice Ashwani Kumar Mishra and Justice Rohit Kapoor on Wednesday.

The petitioner sought a probe by the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) into the violence and vandalism on the LPU campus.

Ravi Raj, the petitioner, submitted that an unverified post was circulated among the students on the night of September 26, claiming that a female student had been raped on the campus and the student had been sent home.

The students gathered outside the girls' hostel, and later National Highway-44 was blocked, according to the plea.

Later, a large number of outsiders, carrying swords, rods and sickles with their faces covered, reached the LPU campus and broke open the varsity main gates, destroyed CCTV cameras, looted shops and set several places on fire.

In the petition, the LPU students submitted that the relevant rules of the IT Act should have been enforced when the misleading rumours spread on the campus.

According to the plea, adequate security arrangements were also sought around the university campus.

LPU students held a massive protest on Sunday and also blocked a stretch of the New Delhi-Amritsar Highway outside their campus over claims that an outsider had raped a female student on the university premises.

However, violence also broke out on the campus, with students saying that some outsiders with their faces covered indulged in vandalism, damaged property, ransacked shops and also set several places on fire on the LPU campus.

Calm returned to the LPU campus on Monday, with a large number of students heading home following the suspension of classes for 10 days.The unrest, however, on the campus left a trail of destruction, with many shopkeepers at the university's Uni Mall claiming heavy losses.

The shop owners claimed that masked miscreants looted goods by breaking locks with iron rods during the students' protest.

Police said they are examining CCTV footage as part of the investigation into the violence.

NIA arrests four in West Bengal over terror links

SAUGAR SENGUPTA ■ Kolkata



The National Investigation Agency (NIA), on Tuesday, arrested four persons, including an Imam of a mosque, for their alleged links with terror groups, sources said.

The NIA arrested Piar Mohammad Sheikh, the Imam of a mosque in Palishgram village under the Mangalkot Police Station in East Burdwan district. Sources said the NIA team had seized certain materials, including a diary and a mobile phone, from the Imam. The sleuths found several names of Bangladeshi nationals in his diary, insiders said, adding they suspected the man's connection with Jamatul Mujahideen Bangladesh.

The investigators were also trying to find out the reasons behind his regular visits to the neighbouring country. The arrest followed a tip-off from Assam. Raids were also conducted in South 24 Parganas district. The agency also arrested Jumman Sheikh, a tailor from Mithapukur; Shahrul Purkait from Balarampur; Abdul Rafiq from Narendrapur — all in South 24 Parganas district.

ED searches 15 premises linked to ex-West Bengal minister Indranil Sen

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH ■ New Delhi/Kolkata



The Enforcement Directorate (ED) on Tuesday carried out search-and-seizure operations at 15 locations in Kolkata and nearby areas. These included properties connected to former West Bengal minister Indranil Sen. The searches are part of a money-laundering investigation under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA).

The agency's Kolkata office began acting under Section 17 of the PMLA early in the morning. Teams arrived at Sen's home in Kasba and other city locations around 6:30 am. They also searched farmhouses in Hooghly and Singur, relatives' homes, and the house of an event-management businessman in Highland Park. The team also conducted operations at Hindustan Park. Police and other security forces worked with the ED as teams checked documents and electronic records.

The investigation focuses on alleged financial irregularities by MassArt, also known as the Mahanirban Road Mass Art Society, which is led by Sen's wife, Madhuchhanda Sen. Officials said the society held Durga Puja "preview shows" for visitors from India and abroad before the festival opened to everyone. They sold passes and collected large amounts of money, presenting the society as a UNESCO-sponsored group.

Investigators say the organisation used UNESCO's name, branding, and logo without proper commercial permission after Durga Puja in Kolkata was given UNESCO's Intangible Cultural Heritage tag in 2021. Officials claim that money raised from the preview events and pass sales was later used for personal benefit. Sources close to the inquiry said investigators are looking into collections estimated at ₹50–60 crore over several years, with tens of thousands of people registering for the preview events between 2022 and 2024.

The federal case began after a complaint was filed with Kolkata Police in June against Sen, his wife, and other MassArt officials over alleged problems with selling preview passes. The complaint, made at Bowbazar police station, said that expensive donor and preview tickets were sold by claiming an official partnership with UNESCO. Earlier, the Calcutta High Court asked the State for a progress report and at one point ordered that no action be taken against Sen until a certain date while the police investigation continued.

ED teams are now tracing the flow and use of funds, examining the society's ownership and management, bank and digital payment records, and possible links to other groups, including an art gallery that was part of some tour plans. Officials said they are seizing documents and materials believed to be connected to proceeds of crime under PMLA rules. Sen, the Minister of State for Tourism and Information and Culture, had contested the 2026 West Bengal Assembly election as a Trinamool Congress candidate from Hooghly and lost.

Neither Sen nor MassArt could be immediately reached for comment on Tuesday's searches. The agency said the operation forms part of its continuing investigation into alleged proceeds of crime arising from the society's financial dealings.

Panel asks States for 15-year religious demographic data

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi



The High-Level Committee on Demographic Changes (HLCDC), under the Union Home Ministry, has asked States and Union Territories to share information about "visible changes" in religious demographics in districts, industrial clusters, and border areas over the past 15 years.

In its letter, the Committee asked States and Union Territories for "time series data" showing changes over the years, along with other administrative records. They also want state governments' assessments of "major trends" in demographics and data on the religious makeup of tribal populations since 2011.

The letter asks States and Union territories to collect data from their districts, as available in official records.

Sources said it is hard for States to compile such large datasets by religion because this information is not usually collected in that way.

According to sources, data collection is still in the early stages, and States will not have to provide any data that does not already exist.

They suggested that if some data is unavailable, other methods could be developed as the work continues to study these patterns.

States and Union territories have been asked to provide "data broken down by religion and by district" for birth registrations over the past 15 years. This includes late registrations, cases of "suspected fraud," and both institutional and non-institutional births, according to sources.

They have also been asked to share any surveys they have done on religious buildings like "temples, mosques, churches, etc." and to report any sudden changes in Aadhaar, voter card, or ration card enrollments, sources said. They have also requested transport department data on vehicle registrations by religion, any sudden increase in commercial vehicle licenses in border areas, patterns of property transfers in tribal regions, and cases of illegal transfers or encroachment on tribal land.

States have also been asked to provide information about "educational institutions such as Government, aided, and private religious" schools set up in tribal areas in the past 15 years. The administration has also been asked to share its assessment of how these changes have affected local demographic and social patterns. The ministry has asked States and Union territories to provide "details of specific technical, intelligence-based or community-initiated mechanisms used by local administration to detect and identify illegal migrants living in established settlements," sources said.

A Government statement said that during a meeting, the High Level Committee told the Union Home Minister it plans to visit different States and Union territories. The goal is to get first-hand information from local Governments and to meet with central ministries for feedback on demographic changes. The high-level Committee also prepared a detailed questionnaire to gather relevant information from States and Union Territories in advance so that the visits could be more meaningful and interactive.

The Committee, led by retired Justice Prakash Prabhakar Navlekar, said it will conduct a scientific assessment of demographic changes in different parts of the country caused by illegal immigration and other unusual factors. It will also examine the causes and recommend policy, legislative, and administrative measures.

Suvendu Adhikari accuses TMC, Congress of backing *Dimagi* Naxals

SAUGAR SENGUPTA ■ Kolkata



West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Tuesday mounted simultaneous attacks on the Congress and the Trinamool Congress for teaming up with the *Dimagi* Naxals to destabilise the nation.

While he attacked the Congress for keeping double standards — by celebrating victories in Kerala and Tamil Nadu and holding the Election Commission of India (ECI) responsible for the losses it suffers at the hands of the BJP in other States, he accused Trinamool Congress chief Mamata Banerjee of "planning sessions with *Dimagi* Naxals" and urged the security agencies to keep a close watch on her activities.

This came soon after the Trinamool Congress leader and her nephew, Abhishek Banerjee, left for the national Capital to take part in a meeting organised by the constituents of the the Indian National Democratic Inclusive Alliance.

"The meeting will focus on national issues including electoral scams... And formulating strategies to streamline a struggle against the corrupt persons who hijacked elections through electoral malpractice," Banerjee said before leaving for Delhi. He said, "Those who are jumping about this INDI alliance... let me tell them that this alliance is finished," and "she (Banerjee) is only going to Delhi for a planning session with *Dimagi* Naxals... Against this context, I would like to alert Delhi Police and central IB to remain on alert and keep a watch on such activities."

Air India to resume direct Delhi–Tel Aviv flights from December 1

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi



Air India will resume direct flights between Delhi and Tel Aviv from December 1, restoring a non-stop air link between India and Israel after the suspension of services amid the ongoing war and security situation in the region.

The airline will operate five weekly flights from Sunday through Thursday using Boeing 777 aircraft. With the resumption, Air India is set to be the only airline operating non-stop flights between India and Israel.

Air India will operate flight AI139 from Delhi, departing at 5:00 am and arriving in Tel Aviv at 8:30 am. The return service, AI140, will depart Tel Aviv at 10:30 am and arrive in Delhi at 7:45 pm. The flight time will be approximately seven hours from Delhi to Tel Aviv and around five hours and 45 minutes on the return journey.

Air India and other airlines had suspended or disrupted services to Tel Aviv during the ongoing conflict, affecting direct air connectivity between India and Israel. The restoration of the Delhi–Tel Aviv route comes as air links to Israel gradually resume amid changes in the regional security environment.

The return of the direct route also comes as the Israeli Ministry of Tourism strengthens its engagement with the Indian travel market and expands efforts to showcase the destination beyond its established appeal for pilgrimage and spiritual tourism.

The ministry is placing greater emphasis on leisure and family travel, MICE (meetings, incentives, conferences and exhibitions), luxury and experiential tourism.

Welcoming the announcement, Galit Hoffman, Consul for Tourism Affairs at the Israel Ministry of Tourism in India, said the restoration of direct connectivity would make travel between the two countries more convenient.

"The return of Air India's direct flights is an important development for tourism between India and Israel. For Indian travellers, the restoration of a regular non-stop connection makes the journey more convenient and gives them greater flexibility when planning a visit to Israel. India remains an important market for us, and direct air connectivity has a significant role to play in supporting the growth of travel between our two countries."

Hoffman also highlighted the range of experiences the destination offers to Indian travellers beyond pilgrimage and spiritual tourism.

"We would like more Indian travellers to discover the many different sides of Israel, beyond its longstanding appeal for pilgrimage and spiritual travel. From Jerusalem and the beaches, culinary experiences and vibrant city life of Tel Aviv, to the Dead Sea, the desert, Galilee and Eilat on the Red Sea, Israel offers an extraordinary variety of experiences within a relatively compact destination."

She added that the return of the Delhi route would provide an opportunity to increase awareness of Israel's broader tourism offering among Indian travellers.

India was a significant source market for Israel before the COVID-19 pandemic, with nearly 70,000 Indian visitors travelling to the country annually, according to the Israel Ministry of Tourism.

Alongside the restoration of direct air connectivity, the ministry is expanding its engagement with India's travel trade through destination training, webinars, familiarisation programmes for travel agents and media, and promotional initiatives highlighting Israel's varied tourism experiences.

The resumption of Air India's Delhi–Tel Aviv service is expected to strengthen air connectivity between the two countries and provide Indian travellers with a direct option for reaching Israel, while giving fresh momentum to tourism ties between the two markets.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

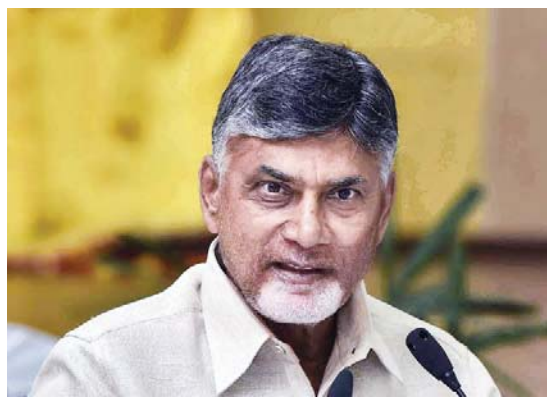
States Focus



ARUNACHAL GUV PRAISES IAF FOR SUPPORT TO STATE

Arunachal Pradesh Governor Lt Gen KT Parnaik (Retd) on Tuesday praised IAF's Eastern Air Command for its steadfast support to the border State.

The governor praised the Indian Air Force (IAF) during a meeting with Air Officer Commanding-in-Chief Air Marshal Inderpal Singh Walia, who called on him at the Lok Bhavan. During the interaction, the governor and the AOC-in-C of the Eastern Air Command discussed national security priorities, operational readiness of Advanced Landing Grounds (ALGs), and humanitarian assistance during natural calamities and medical emergencies, an official statement said. Highlighting the State's rugged terrain and complex geographical challenges, Parnaik praised the IAF's pivotal role in executing rapid response operations during floods and landslides. (*PTI*)



NEXT 20 YEARS CRUCIAL FOR INDIA'S DEVELOPMENT: NAIDU

Andhra Pradesh Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu on Tuesday said the next 20 years would be crucial for India's development and called for revolutionary reforms in the country's systems and institutions.

Addressing the southern regional workshop of 'Mission Karmayogi' in Vijayawada, the Chief Minister said emerging technologies such as AI would create significant prospects for the youth and the people of this country. "The next 20 years are crucial for India's development, requiring revolutionary reforms in our systems and institutions," said the CM.

After inaugurating the workshop aimed at capacity building among Government employees and enhancing their administrative skills, Naidu cited Prime Minister Narendra Modi's rise from a tea seller to the country's top elected office as an example of capacity building."

According to the CM, PM Modi started 'iGOT – Mission Karmayogi' with the ambition of enabling people to make use of immense opportunities available in India. Through capacity building commission, he said online training is available for enhancing capabilities with iGOT – Mission Karmayogi and quality training will be provided for State level to grassroots level officers. Naidu said India had "equal opportunities and resources", but lagged behind China in certain areas and called for introspection. (*PTI*)

CAG flags Odisha DMF lapses

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Bhubaneswar



The Comptroller and Auditor General has flagged several lacunae in the sanction and execution of projects under Odisha's District Mineral Foundation (DMF), meant for the interest and benefits of the mining-affected people and areas in the State.

In one of its reports, presented in the Odisha Assembly on Monday, the top audit authority flagged significant systemic shortcomings in the assessment, collection, and monitoring of District Mineral Foundation (DMF) contributions in test-checked mining circles and works divisions.

Incorrect application of prescribed DMF contribution rates, failure to reassess contributions after final royalty assessments, and non-levy of interest on delayed payments collectively resulted in a substantial loss in DMF collections, it said.

Such contributions refer to a mandatory financial payment made by mining leaseholders in Odisha to DMFs.

Although six districts collected ₹22,568.17 crore towards DMF contribution, including interest, and sanctioned 17,435 projects worth ₹20,947.52 crore from DMF funds during 2015-16 to 2023-24, none of the six DMFs prepared a perspective plan and master plan, the audit report said.

The six audited districts are Sundergarh, Keonjhar, Jajpur, Mayurbhanj, Dhenkanal and Nabarangpur.

"As many as 9,739 projects worth ₹17,926.79 crore were sanctioned from DMF in Keonjhar and Sundargarh districts during 2015-16 to 2023-24. Out of this, expenditure of ₹983.32 crore was made towards implementing projects in 976 non-affected villages, whereas not a single project was implemented in 488 directly affected villages and 96 indirectly affected villages," the report said.

Of the ₹1,164.43 crore utilised in Jajpur DMF, 43.54 per cent, that translates to ₹507.02 crore, was used in indirectly affected areas, exceeding the prescribed limit of 40 per cent, it stated.

Out of the six selected DMFs, Mayurbhanj, Dhenkanal and Nabarangpur districts had not opted for a flexi deposit/auto sweep account for surplus DMF funds during 2015-2024, resulting in an interest loss of ₹9.49 crore. Similarly, Keonjhar DMF incurred an interest loss amounting to ₹84.51 crore.

DMF funds of ₹171.79 crore from Jajpur, Keonjhar and Sundargarh districts were released to the MGNREGS director for the payment of additional wages to job seekers, which violates the Ministry of Rural Development guidelines, the CAG said.

"Out of total administrative expenditure of 99.81 crore in Sundergarh DMF, ₹25.01 crore was irregularly utilised for other than administrative expenditure, like engagement of vehicle for police patrolling, renovation of municipality office, renovation of reading room at collector's residence, inauguration charges and organisation of school function etc," the auditor pointed out.

In Jajpur, Keonjhar and Sundergarh DMFs, implementing agencies had not returned the unspent amount of ₹470.25 crore and the interest earned thereon, amounting to ₹26.51 crore, to the DMFs after project completion.Similarly, the implementing agencies of Dhenkanal and Mayurbhanj had not returned interest amounting to ₹87 lakh to their respective DMFs.

Furthermore, an expenditure of ₹136.77 crore was made for constructing a hockey stadium out of DMF funds in Sundergarh, and the project does not fall under any activities permissible under the scheme guidelines, the audit said.

The CAG further pointed out that ₹109.45 crore from Sundargarh's DMF was paid to a private hospital in Rourkela against a requisite payment of ₹98.85 crore, resulting in an excess payment of ₹10.60 crore during the Covid pandemic.

The auditor advised the Odisha Government to ensure proper maintenance of accounts of DMF funds as per the codal provisions and refund of accrued interest thereon by the implementing agencies.

INDIA bloc calls Odisha *bandh* over mining law



Odisha Pradesh Congress Committee president Bhakta Charan Das

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Bhubaneswar

INDIA bloc on Tuesday announced an Odisha *bandh* on October 8 to demand the repeal of the new mining law and two other issues, as members of the alliance staged a demonstration near Chief Minister Mohan Charan Majhi's residence.

Hundreds of workers and leaders of bloc partners such as the Congress, CPI(M), CPI, CPI(ML) Liberation, Forward Bloc, NCP, Samajwadi Party and RJD took part in the rally.

The protesters had earlier planned to gherao the Assembly but shifted their focus to the chief minister's residence after the Monsoon Session was adjourned sine die a day earlier.

"The BJP Government adjourned the Assembly sine die instead of answering our questions on the MMDR Bill, 'vote chori' and CEC Gyanesh Kumar. But they can't adjourn the people's questions. We are staging agitation before the CM's residence," Pradesh Congress Committee president Bhakta Charan Das said.

The protesters clashed with security personnel after police stopped them from marching towards the chief minister's residence.

Some supporters broke through the barricades and courted arrest, while several others were taken into custody for allegedly violating the law, a senior police officer said.

Addressing the gathering, Das announced the Statewide bandh for October 8 and appealed to people to join it.

The demands include repeal of the Mines and Minerals (Development and Regulation) (MMDR) Amendment Act, 2026, resignation of Odisha School and Mass Education Minister Nityananda Gond over alleged errors in school textbooks.

Maharashtra to absorb ex-Agniveers in police, coastal security: Fadnavis

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Mumbai



The Maharashtra Government will accommodate returning Agniveers, who have completed their four-year military tenure, in police and other state Government forces, with exemptions from fresh examinations and training, Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis said on Tuesday. Fadnavis said the first batch of Agniveers was now completing its tenure and returning from the armed forces.

"The Centre has stipulated that 25 per cent of Agniveers would continue in the armed forces, while the remaining 75 per cent should be absorbed in various forces of the Central and State Governments," he told reporters after the weekly cabinet meeting. "Maharashtra has decided that Agniveers (not retained in armed forces) will be accommodated in police and similar posts available in the State Government forces," Fadnavis said.

Under the 2022 Agnipath scheme, the Centre will retain 25 per cent of Agniveers in the armed forces, while the remaining 75 per cent will be released from service. Recruits under the scheme, known as Agniveers, serve for a total duration of four years, which includes 6 months of training.

Former Agniveers would not be required to appear for another recruitment examination or undergo fresh training as they had already undergone tests and training during their four-year service, said the CM, who also holds the Home portfolio.

Congress lambasts demography panel seeking religion-wise data

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Congress leader Jairam Ramesh

The Congress on Tuesday attacked the Modi Government over the Home Ministry-led demography panel reportedly seeking religion-wise data for the past 15 years on birth and vehicle registrations, school enrolment and property transactions, alleging the committee has a "patently diabolical agenda".

Congress general secretary in-charge communications Jairam Ramesh shared a report in The Hindu which claimed that the High-Level Committee on Demographic Changes has sought religion-wise data for the past 15 years on birth and vehicle registrations, school enrolment and property transactions, as well as district-wise details of religious structures and unusual increases in Aadhaar, voter ID and ration card registrations.

It has also sought intelligence assessments and commission reports on religious conversions among Scheduled Tribe communities, and details of operational detention centres, among other information, according to the media report.

In his post on X, Ramesh said this panel has a "patently diabolical agenda" and has clearly articulated preconceived biases. "Its report has already been prepared no doubt," Ramesh added.

The media report has claimed that state Governments are unable to answer most of the queries posed by the high-level committee studying demographic changes, as Government departments do not ordinarily maintain much of the information sought by the panel on a religion-wise basis.

Kumaraswamy alleges irregularities in Bengaluru-Mysuru corridor project

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Bengaluru



Union Minister HD Kumaraswamy on Tuesday alleged large-scale irregularities in the Bengaluru-Mysuru Infrastructure Corridor Project (BMICP) and accused the Karnataka Government of "failing" to protect farmers whose land was acquired for the project.

Kumaraswamy, who holds steel and heavy industries portfolio, also alleged deviations in the BMICP approved by Chief Minister DK Shivakumar, when he was the state Urban Development Minister on February 12, 2004.

During that period the Nandi Infrastructure Corporation Enterprises Limited (NICE) managing director Ashok Kheny was the sitting member of the Bengaluru Mysuru Infrastructure Corridor Area Planning Authority (BMICAPA).

The deviation, according to him, was done without Cabinet approval.

In this connection, he demanded that Shivakumar resign from his position and pave way for those who can correct the "large scale irregularities".

Addressing a press conference here, Kumaraswamy alleged that land and other resources had been diverted in violation of agreements and claimed that the matter involved irregularities worth more than ₹3 lakh crore.

He also demanded that the Government act on recent court observations and return land to affected farmers wherever legally possible.

BJP names candidates for four Bihar MLC seats

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Patna



The BJP on Tuesday announced its candidates for four of the eight legislative council seats in Bihar going to polls next month, with three sitting MLCs seeking re-election from their respective constituencies.

The JD(U), the second largest constituent of the ruling NDA in Bihar, has already announced its candidates for the other four constituencies.

BJP MLCs Nawal Kishor Yadav, NK Yadav and Sarvesh Kumar will seek re-election from Patna Teachers, Kosi Graduates and Tirhut Graduates seats, respectively.

The party has fielded Narendra Kumar Singh for the Tirhut Teachers constituency, which is held by Sanjay Kumar Singh of the Opposition INDIA bloc's CPI.

The RJD, which helms the Opposition coalition in Bihar, has declared its candidates for six of the seats. It had said that "talks are underway" for the Tirhut Teachers constituency as well as the Darbhanga Teachers seat, held by former state Congress chief Madan Mohan Jha.

Militants ambush Assam Rifles team in Arunachal; 1 soldier killed, 4 injured

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Itanagar



Representational image

An Assam Rifles jawan was killed and four others injured after a patrol team came under suspected militant attack along the India-Myanmar border in Arunachal Pradesh's Changlang district on Tuesday, officials said.

The incident took place around 6.30 am near Nampong Nallah under Nampong circle when personnel of the 21 Assam Rifles were patrolling an area where border fencing work is underway, they said.

Preliminary reports suggested that suspected militants opened fire on the patrol team, killing Havildar Jankhokai Kuki (42) and injuring four others.

The injured personnel were being evacuated for medical treatment, while details regarding their condition were awaited.

Security forces have intensified operations in the area following the incident, the official said. Preliminary reports suggested the involvement of militants belonging to the NSCN (K-YA).

However, officials have not confirmed the attackers' identities.

An official statement from the Assam Rifles is awaited.

Changlang SP Kirli Padu said he had received information about the incident and directed the officer-in-charge of Changlang police station to gather details.

9% students reported suicidal thoughts, 34% felt like outsiders on campus: SC task force survey

GUNJAN SHARMA
New Delhi



Representational image

About 15 per cent students in higher education institutions experienced a period in the previous six months when they felt overwhelmed or distressed, while nine per cent reported experiencing suicidal thoughts, according to a nationwide survey conducted by a Supreme Court-appointed panel examining student suicides.

The survey findings, accessed by *PTI*, are expected to be part of the final report of the National Task Force (NTF) to address mental health concerns of students and prevent suicides in higher educational institutions (HEIs), which is expected to be submitted by October 31.

The survey findings assume significance in the wake of renewed debate on student suicides following the death of two students at IIT Delhi and Bombay which have led to widespread outrage.

The SC-appointed panel had earlier this year submitted an interim report in which it had noted that the experience of higher education for students has been found to be marked by "deep-rooted social discrimination, rampant sexual harassment in medical and engineering colleges; gender discrimination by faculty in medical, law and State universities, in terms of academic support, hostel curfews and moral policing; caste identification by NEET-UG and JEE ranks; caste-based humiliation and discrimination in terms of admission, grading, language gaps and faculty attention".

According to the survey conducted by the NTF with responses from over 2.43 lakh students, 67 per cent of which belonged to SC, ST and OBC category, about

34 per cent reported feeling like an outsider on campus to varying extent.

"About 15 per cent students recalled a period in the previous six months when they felt very overwhelmed or distressed, or experienced low moods or anxiety continuously for several weeks. Nine percent reported experiencing suicidal thoughts often or very often in the past year.

"Fifty-six per cent students indicated having trust in the administration to handle serious issues fairly while roughly 32 per cent said their institute did not offer counselling services," the survey found. According to officials, concerns around academic choices and frequent worries related to employment were common.

"Responses to many other items, including open-text fields, are still being analysed. Moreover, due to non-representativeness of the current sample, the observations need to be taken as preliminary and tentative," a senior official told *PTI*.

The official, however, noted that emerging patterns suggest urgent action for standardized student support systems, implementation of measures such as faculty training, stigma-reduction, crisis SOPs, regular monitoring with quality-data and building responsive and transparent administration for addressing student mental health. In addition to the student survey, the NTF conducted a series of institutional visits and stakeholde consultations.

"A total of 30 meetings at 19 institutional sites have been conducted so far across Delhi and NCR, Tamil Nadu, Karnataka, Assam and West Bengal, spanning different types of institutions and disciplines. Due to the very small numbers visited, this is not a representative sample and hence the views provided will be taken in that light.

"Despite institutional limits and apprehension, students at most HEIs spoke extensively about their academic, social, mental health, faculty-related, and administrative concerns," the official said.

The academic problems reported by students had to do with strict attendance policies; demanding schedules and academic and clinical overload (medical and allied fields); on-call hours for medical students stretching well beyond mandated as well as human limits; paranoid levels of competition due to relative grading and stringent placement criteria in engineering colleges. (*PTI*)

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

Four CISF men killed in firing

MOHIT KANDHARI ■ Jammu



In a rare incident of fratricide, a head constable of the Central Industrial Security Force (CISF), allegedly shot dead four security personnel, including two officers, with his service weapon late Tuesday evening at the Sewa-II Hydroelectric Project unit in the Basohli area of Kathua district of Jammu division.

The firing incident was reported inside the office premises of the CISF personnel around 7.00 pm.

Preliminary investigations revealed that the accused head constable barged inside the office premises and opened indiscriminate fire with his service weapon (AK-47 Rifle). The injured CISF personnel, bleeding profusely, were rushed to a hospital in neighbouring Himachal Pradesh, where they later succumbed to their injuries.

Following the incident, the head constable was apprehended and handed over to the police.

An inquiry has been ordered to ascertain the circumstances under which the firing incident took place.

Senior Superintendent of Police, Kathua, Mohita Sharma, confirmed the incident and said police teams have already launched investigations into the firing incident. According to preliminary information, "Four Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) personnel were allegedly shot dead by a 2009-batch Head Constable of the force following a verbal argument among them over an issue at the Sewa-II Hydroelectric Project unit in Kathua.

The accused head constable has been identified as Abdesh Kumar of CISF. The deceased CISF personnel have been identified as Assistant Commandant Ankit Kumar Pandey (Company Commander) SI Lakshman Singh,CT Sanjeev Kumar,CT Mohd. Rafiq. Earlier, on December 8, 2024, a head constable of Jammu and Kashmir police allegedly shot dead his colleague in a fit of anger before shooting himself dead with his service weapon in a moving police van on the Jammu-Srinagar National Highway near Udhampur.

A similar incident of fratricide was reported in the Udhampur district in July 2022. At that time, a jawan of the Indo-Tibetan Border Police Force, deployed on Amarnath yatra duty, opened fire on his colleagues near Devika Ghat community centre. In the firing incident, three ITBP jawans received injuries, while one of them was found dead inside the Devika Ghat community centre.

On July 15, 2022, two soldiers of the Indian Army were killed while two others were injured in a similar firing incident inside a Surankote-based territorial army camp in Poonch.

NIA arrests two more accused in 2024 ambush on ex-Manipur CM convoy

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

The National Investigation Agency (NIA) has arrested two more persons in connection with the 2024 armed ambush on the convoy of then chief minister of Manipur N Biren Singh, officials said on Tuesday.

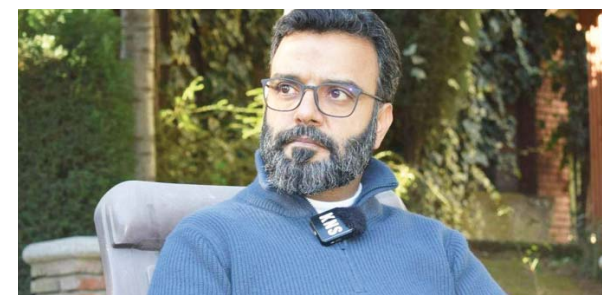
The accused have been identified as Jangminlun Singson alias Franky (44), a resident of Bethel, Churachandpur, and Thangjoel Haokip alias Thangboi (21), a resident of Gamphajang Tuibong, Churachandpur, they said.

The incident occurred on June 10, 2024, when unknown armed miscreants ambushed the then CM's convoy on NH-37 near K Sinam village in Kangpokpi district of Manipur.



NC MP Ruhullah accuses party of diluting statehood mandate

MOHIT KANDHARI ■ Jammu


MP Aga Syed Ruhullah Mehdi

A day after the Jammu and Kashmir Legislative Assembly passed a resolution calling on the Government of India to restore full statehood to the Union Territory immediately, disgruntled National Conference MP Aga Syed Ruhullah Mehdi on Tuesday accused his party of diluting the mandate it received in the Jammu and Kashmir Assembly elections, questioning its repeated resolutions on statehood.

Mehdi, who has set November 3 as the deadline for his exit from the National Conference (NC), said people had voted for the NC to fight for the restoration of constitutional and political guarantees taken away on August 5, 2019.

Mehdi also criticised the dilution of resolutions previously passed by the assembly concerning "autonomy" and "statehood".

"We had given an assurance, an expectation and a promise to the people that we will not fight any other battle. We will only fight for the return of our constitutional rights," he said.

Questioning the party's changing resolutions, he said, "Sometimes one resolution, then a second resolution to dilute the same resolution, and then a third resolution to amend that resolution — this is a joke with the people of Kashmir." "If there was no clarity, if they did not know what the objective was, why did they go before the people in the election?" Ruhullah asked.

He said the mandate had been reduced to "a victim of convenience" and warned that the people would not forgive those responsible. Referring to the ongoing slugfest between the treasury and opposition benches in the Legislative Assembly, Ruhullah said the J&K Assembly has failed to live up to the expectations of the people and has increasingly become a " wrestling ring" rather than a forum for resolving public issues.

Taking a jibe at the ruling party, Ruhullah said on Sunday that people had elected representatives in 2024 with the expectation that the assembly would provide a platform for addressing their everyday concerns and finding solutions to issues ranging from water supply and healthcare to education and employment.

However, he questioned the seriousness with which the assembly was now addressing these issues, alleging that instead of functioning as an institution for public problem-solving, it had turned into an "arena" of political confrontation and publicity.



Defence Minister Rajnath Singh, Chief of Defence Staff General NS Raja Subramani, PVSM, AVSM, SM, VSM and others in a group photograph during the Indian Navy Commanders' Conference, at Nausena Bhawan, in New Delhi PTI

India preferred security partner in Indian Ocean: Rajnath Singh

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh said on Tuesday, "India stands firm as the First Responder, Preferred Security Partner and as a symbol of trust and reliability in the Indian Ocean Region, and the entire world is witnessing the growth of both our strategic position and our strategic responsibility in the region."

Making these observations while addressing the Indian Navy's biannual Commanders' Conference in New Delhi, he also said, "Today, issues such as congestion, deception, and grey-zone activities have made our maritime domain far more complex than ever before. Hence, we must elevate our monitoring and response mechanisms to a new level."

Rajnath asserted that the presence of Indian warships extends to the South China Sea, the Mediterranean, and the Atlantic Ocean, demonstrating our blue-water force capability. The role of the Indian Navy is crucial in ensuring the strategic depth and regional power projection, he added.

Highlighting the Government's commitment to the modernisation of the Navy, he urged the top brass to maintain its unrelenting momentum while transforming itself into a future-ready, combat-ready, and globally respected force.

Lauding the Indian Navy's role in the crisis in West Asia, Rajnath highlighted that ensuring the safe transit of Indian-flagged merchant vessels — particularly LPG tankers — through the Strait of Hormuz under 'Operation UrjaSuraksha' is an outstanding achievement.

India imports approximately 85–90 per cent of its crude oil and around 50 per cent of its natural gas through maritime routes; therefore, the security of sea lanes is directly connected with the country's economy, energy supplies and defence preparedness, he added.

The defence minister called for a significant upgrade of India's maritime surveillance architecture, recognising the importance of existing systems. He added that the growing volume and complexity of maritime traffic require enhanced analytical capabilities.

Rajnath described 2026 as a historic year for the Indian Navy, with plans for the induction or commissioning of 18 warships, which would constitute the largest single-year force accretion in the Navy's history. "The developments reflected the growing maturity of India's domestic naval shipbuilding ecosystem, while emphasising that further capability enhancement remained necessary," he said. The three-day apex-level conference, being held from September 29 to October one, brings together the top leadership of the Indian Navy to review operational preparedness, maritime security and future capability development.

Left protests outside ECI headquarters, demands ouster of CEC

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi



CPI(M) General Secretary MA Baby along with supporters stage a protest against Chief Election Commissioner at ECI in New Delhi PTI

High drama unfolded outside Nirvachan Sadan, the headquarters of the Election Commission of India (ECI), as police detained dozens of Left party cadres and senior leaders during a protest demonstration demanding the removal of the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) and an immediate halt to the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) process.

The demonstration, part of a week-long nationwide agitation called by Left parties, saw leaders and workers marching towards the gates of the ECI head office before being stopped and removed by security personnel. The Communist Party of India (Marxist) strongly condemned the police action, alleging that brutal force was used against peaceful demonstrators and that women protesters were manhandled by male officers during the melee.

The agitation was led by top Left figures, including CPI(M) General Secretary MA Baby, veteran leaders Brinda Karat and Subhashini Ali, and Polit Bureau members BV Raghavulu and R Arun Kumar, alongside Members of Parliament V Sivadasan and AA Rahim. Prominent representatives from other Left constituents, including CPI Delhi State Secretary Dinesh , CPI(ML) Central Committee member Sucheta De, RSP National Secretariat member Rajiv Dimri, Forward Bloc leader Dharmendra Verma, and CGPI leader Birju Naik, also participated in the march.

The Left alliance outlined a set of core demands during the agitation, calling for the immediate removal of the Chief Election Commissioner, an absolute halt to the ongoing SIR process, and the prompt reinclusion of all genuine voters who were unjustly removed during the exercise. Furthermore, the leaders pressed for the rescinding of the 2023 law governing the appointment of the CEC and other Election Commissioners, demanding that future appointments strictly follow the guidelines established by the Supreme Court.

SRFTI classes suspended for 2nd day after campus violence

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Kolkata



PTI had erroneously reported on Monday that classes had resumed at the institute, following the clash between a section of students and members of the RSS-affiliated Akhil Bharatiya Grahak Panchayat (ABGP) on Sunday.

Classes at the Satyajit Ray Film and Television Institute (SRFTI) in Kolkata remained suspended for the second consecutive day on Tuesday as students continued their academic boycott following the campus violence, officials said.

Nachiket, general secretary of the SRFTI Students' Union, said the academic boycott would continue as the authorities were yet to accept their demands.

"The demands of the students are basic and simple - safety and security. How can outsiders come to the campus and attack the students? This is unacceptable," he said.

He had earlier criticised the delay in police intervention and sought accountability for those who allegedly breached campus security.

Several people were injured in the clash that broke out during a programme organised by the ABGP.

Students alleged that ABGP members attacked them after they protested a political programme on the campus, while the organisation claimed that its members were assaulted.Three FIRs have been registered in connection with the violence.

One was lodged suo motu by the police, while the other two were filed by ABGP functionary Anjan Sinha and SRFTI dean Sukanta Majumdar.

CCB raids 5 premises in DMK ex-minister probe

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Chennai



Expanding its probe into a corruption case registered against former DMK School Education Minister Anbil Mahesh Poyyamozhi and others, the CCB on Tuesday conducted simultaneous searches at five premises here and seized a laptop and 44 documents, police said.

The searches followed a First Information Report (FIR) registered by the Central Crime Branch on September 16, 2026, based on allegations of financial irregularities during the former minister's tenure, a press release said.

According to police sources, investigators had earlier gathered leads indicating that more than 30 persons were allegedly linked to the transactions under scrutiny. Acting on the information, five teams led by an Inspector of Police from CCB-I conducted searches at five locations in the city early Tuesday morning, police said.

LPU chancellor avoids campus violence questions



PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Phagwara

Days after violent protests rocked the Lovely Professional University, Rajya Sabha MP and the varsity's founder-chancellor Ashok Mittal made his first public appearance at a rally in Gandhi Chowk here on Tuesday for the BJP's 'Nasha Mukt Punjab Yatra'.

However, he refused to speak about the protest, where students went on a rampage, vandalising property and blocking a stretch of the New Delhi-Amritsar highway over claims that a plumber had raped a female student on the premises.

"I will speak on it separately, but today will entertain questions only about BJP's Nasha Mukt Yatra," he said. When Mittal was asked to respond to Congress leader Charanjit Singh Channi and SAD stalwart Bikram Singh Majithia's remarks that AAP targeted the LPU because he left the party to join the BJP, the R MP reiterated that he would address the issue separately.

Ladakh dispatches first consignment of Liliums flowers to markets

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Jammu



Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena flags off the first consignment of 15,000 A-grade Lilium stems at KBR Airport, Leh PIONEER PHOTO

Ladakh took a major step toward a new, sustainable livelihood through commercial floriculture by dispatching its first air consignment of exquisite, Ladakh-grown Lilium flowers to national flower markets on Monday.

Lieutenant Governor Vinai Kumar Saxena flagged off the first consignment of 15,000 "A-grade" Lilium stems at the KBR Airport, Leh, marking a historic initiative towards establishing new economic opportunities and entrepreneurship in Ladakh.

The Lieutenant Governor also presented bouquets of Ladakh-grown Liliums to each of the crew members, as a symbolic gesture of this initiative."A-grade" Liliums refer to the flower stems with 4-5 buds that fetch a premium price. The first consignment comprises red, pink, white, yellow and orange colours – all cultivated at an altitude of 10,600 feet, at the world's highest-altitude flower field in Leh. These flowers, with a shelf life of 5-7 days, will be sold in various domestic markets, primarily Delhi, Mumbai and Chandigarh.

LG Saxena termed the initiative "historic" and said floriculture has emerged as a powerful economic tool for creating alternate sustainable livelihood opportunities in Ladakh, inspired by PM NarendraModi's vision of financial sustainability of farmers and youth, through diversification of agriculture.

To begin with, 15 local women have been engaged in cutting, sorting and packaging of the Liliums at these flower fields, at a daily wage of ₹900 per person. A local young qualified Botanist has been given the task of marketing these flowers to the national markets. Liliums are premium cut flowers highly sought after in the floral and hospitality industries, fetching ₹150 to ₹200 per stem in domestic retail markets.

"This first-of-its-kind high-altitude commercial floriculture project in Ladakh represents a major agricultural and visual shift for the region, which has been identified by its rugged mountains and barren landscapes.

Building on the success of the pilot project at Leh, the Lieutenant Governor has further directed the Deputy Commissioners of the other six districts to replicate the model of high-value floriculture in their respective areas. The Deputy Commissioners of Kargil, Drass, Sham, Changthang and Zanskar have been directed to identify at least 20 acres of land in each district for developing flower fields. The initiative envisages eventually bringing at least 200 acres of land under high-value flower cultivation by next year, creating colourful stretches of Lilium and other high-value flowers across Ladakh's otherwise rugged landscape.

Notably, the Lilium flower field in Leh, with more than 25 lakh flowers, was developed and made ready within just two months, with continuous guidance and intervention from LG Saxena. After opening to the public on 17 September 2026, the flower field has received an overwhelming response, with hundreds of visitors seeing the flowers every day.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

Editor's TAKE

Delhi's early smog plan: Will clean air follow?

Delhi has prepared for winter pollution before winter arrives. But timing alone cannot solve a problem whose sources extend far beyond the capital's borders

Delhi has, for once, announced its winter pollution plan before the smog arrives. The 2026-27 action plan bans dust-generating construction from November 1 to January 31, with a complete halt between December 10 and January 20. Parking fees at authorised sites will double until February 28, though Metro-run car parks are exempt. Offices will move to staggered hours, with half their staff working from home. The 'No PUC, No Fuel' rule will be enforced from October 1, with number-plate cameras at 500 petrol pumps. Another 150 electric buses will join the fleet, while non-local commercial vehicles that fail to meet BS-VI norms will be barred. The most substantive part concerns industry. Of 2,354 targeted units, 2,197 have installed online emission monitors, 57 defaulters have been shut down, and the particulate limit will be tightened from 80 to 50 milligrams per cubic metre from October 1. The NCR's monitoring stations will increase from 85 to 157, and 334 enforcement teams will patrol in two shifts. This is what enforcement should look like.

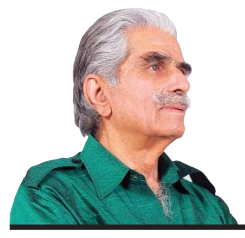
Yet much of the plan is the Graded Response Action Plan made pre-emptive. The novelty is timing, not substance – and GRAP has habitually arrived late: of 17 invocations between January 2025 and January 2026, 13 came only after air quality had crossed the threshold. Parking fees and work-from-home orders, meanwhile, are blunt tools that shift the burden onto commuters. Stubble burning is the familiar villain, and the trend is encouraging. By November 9 last year, Punjab had recorded 35 per cent fewer fire events than in 2024, while Haryana had recorded 65 per cent fewer. The Centre has spent over Rs 3,120 crore on crop-residue machinery since 2018-19, and the Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) has now ordered the complete elimination of stubble burning in 2026. But floods that delayed harvesting helped drive that decline, so it may not be repeated, and averages conceal spikes: farm fires supplied 48 per cent of Delhi's PM2.5 on a single day in 2021, though their average share in October-December 2025 was only 3.5 per cent. Even the Centre now calls farm fires an 'episodic event' rather than the core problem. December delivers the sharper lesson.

With farm fires having faded, slow winds and a stable atmosphere still forced the city into GRAP's harshest stages. In early December, Delhi's own sources supplied only about 35 per cent of its PM2.5; the rest drifted in from the wider NCR. Within the city, vehicles account for roughly half of local emissions, a fact that parking fees and 150 buses do not address.

So will the plan work? It should blunt the worst peaks, chiefly by curbing dust and industrial emissions, but it will not deliver clean air. That demands what Delhi cannot legislate alone: an airshed strategy with enforceable targets for Haryana, Uttar Pradesh and Rajasthan, a decisive shift from private vehicles to public transport, and CAQM directions that are obeyed, not merely issued. Early action is a virtue. The test comes on November 1, when curbs must arrive before the smog, not after it.

The India-China reset rests on an uneasy truce

The Modi-Xi meeting at the BRICS summit may have revived the language of normalisation, but it has done little to resolve the fundamental distrust along the LAC. Behind the diplomatic warmth lie an unresolved boundary, altered ground realities and continuing concerns over China's grey-zone pressure



ASHOK K MEHTA



After the Trump-Xi spectacular three-day meeting, with some notable outcomes last week in Washington, the short 45-minute interaction between Modi and Xi on the sidelines of the BRICS summit this month produced little except 'feel-good'. The US and China do not share borders but have matching tactical and strategic deterrence. India and China, in contrast, have been playing a charade over the normalisation of relations and an early harvest of a boundary settlement when the ground situation is just the opposite.

Following the Chinese ingress in Ladakh (2020), the failed Yangtse grab (2022) and the most recent Taksing encroachment in July 2026, denied by the Government, India is conspicuously missing the deterrent to PLA salami-slicing across the LAC. Delhi maintains a one-way internal dialogue on the Northern border, insisting that any public or parliamentary discussion will undermine soldiers' morale and national security. Last month, Delhi celebrated its BRICS moment with an agreed joint statement and a brief bilateral between President Xi Jinping and Prime Minister Narendra Modi, which marked the unbridgeable gaps in bilateral relations while indulging in mutual self-delusion. Normalisation has largely been dictated by China due to altered Indo-US geopolitics.

For Delhi, it is imperative to hedge against a second active front as Beijing continues propping up Rawalpindi as its 'secondary deterrent' against Delhi. India has allowed dilution of its primary deterrent through the Agniveer scheme and shallow defence investment, justified by Modi's rhetoric: "This is not an era of war" and "endless wars must end". On September 20, days after the BRICS Xi-Modi bilateral, Islamabad initiated the Pakistan-China Boundary Commission, which institutionalises the 1963 Agreement through which Pakistan ceded 5,140 sq km of Shaqsgam territory to China, pending an overall agreement on the J&K dispute. The new agreement revives the disputed status of J&K. China has historically insisted that it has no border/LAC in Ladakh with India, while Delhi questions the legality of the China-Pakistan Economic Corridor and the Karakoram Highway through its claimed territory. According to both Pakistan and China, India's internal political and cartographic alterations in August 2019 to the status of J&K have little impact on its international legal status.

The Modi-Xi jugalbandi, which began in 2014, resulted in joint statements only in 2014 and 2015; thereafter, there were separate read-outs until 2019 because most bilateral meetings were held on the sidelines of other multilateral events and not at bilateral summits. At the Astana meeting in 2017, the 'strategic guidance' mantra was coined: not to let differences become disputes, which was called the Astana Consensus. The last bilateral summit was held in Chennai in 2019, followed by the Ladakh encroachments and Galwan clashes, the most serious incident since Doklam (2017).

THE BRITISH INDEPENDENT NEWSPAPER CONFIRMED THE PLA INTRUSIONS IN TAKSING, INCLUDING DENIAL OF ACCESS TO CIVILIANS BY THE PLA TO THE BUDDHIST TEMPLE. WHILE THE PLA CAN REACH THE BORDER WITHIN 24 HOURS, THE INDIAN ARMY WILL TAKE DAYS DUE TO THE INFRASTRUCTURAL GAP

The writer, a retired Major General, served as Commander, IPKF (South), Sri Lanka, and was a founder member of the Defence Planning Staff, now the Integrated Defence Staff

The October 2024 meeting of the leaders at Kazan produced 'the disengagement breakthrough', followed by the August 2025 meeting at Tianjin, at which separate read-outs focused on each other's concerns and priorities: China wanting India to take a long strategic view, separating the border from the bilateral relationship, while a softened India emphasised that stability on the border would reflect the state of the bilateral relationship.

Strategic guidance by the leaders refers to a jugglery of vocabulary — "development partners, not rivals"; "benefit from each other's strengths" and so on. The mistrust/distrust cannot be masked. The apparent progression in relations was reflected as follows: Kazan — stabilisation; Tianjin — normalisation; and Delhi — enhancement. While overall relations have been re-established to the pre-Galwan level, on the border only disengagement has taken place at friction points.

It is instructive to review what China attempted/achieved across Ladakh.

In April-May 2020, in response to India's cartographic and political changes in J&K in August 2019, in the guise of mobilising PLA forces for an exercise, it built up forces at Demchok, Galwan, Hot Springs, Pangong Tso and Depsang, where, according to a Carnegie Endowment report, the PLA penetrated 1 to 10 km west of previous operational lines, creating a new operational reality for enhancing its bargaining position over the whole of Ladakh. In actual gains, it has blocked access at Depsang, its most strategic achievement; denied access to 26 of 65 patrolling points (Ladakh Police report, 2022); in other places, created buffer zones or no-patrol zones, established positions where it did not have any presence, curtailed civilian grazing rights and permitted selective coordinated patrolling.

Further, it demonstrated that the PLA can mobilise large forces, alter the military situation along the LAC and force India into prolonged military deployment. In short, it succeeded in changing the status quo and delivered a strategic warning to India about any future design over Aksai Chin.

India has described Chinese actions as "unilateral attempts to alter the status quo". It lauds its own achievement in counter-mobilisation and forcing China into disengagement through its pre-emptive action on Kailash Heights, a bargaining chip that was frittered away.

About the Kailash offensive, we will not know other facts due to the banning of Army Chief Gen Naravane's book. India traded away its biggest advantage on February 10, 2021, after holding Kailash Heights for five and a half months, for a half-cock disengagement process. Why the PLA did not occupy Kailash Heights along with other positions is another untold story. India failed to maximise its Kailash dividend to achieve, at the least, complete disengagement, preferably de-escalation and disengagement, and also to restore the status quo ante of 2020, which is now a pipe dream.

At another level, the Special Representative mechanism on the border question was resumed in December 2024, with the 25th round being held in Beijing in August 2026. The new normal for China is to continue its salami-slicing on the LAC while continuing negotiations ad infinitum. The most recent incident took place at Taksing in Subansiri district of Arunachal Pradesh in July 2026. Denial and obfuscation have become the Government's standard response. Doing the rounds on social media, and released earlier this year, is the detailed account of Chinese ingress at places 60 km deep by Panka Baghe, with Koko from the area.

The British Independent newspaper confirmed the PLA intrusions in Taksing, including denial of access to civilians by the PLA to the Buddhist temple. While the PLA can reach the border within 24 hours, the Indian Army will take days due to the infrastructural gap. The Chinese grey-zone operation will continue along the LAC even as India restores full bilateral normalisation, hailing Mao's dictum of winning without fighting.

Daiv Vani

WISDOM FOR A MEANINGFUL LIFE

The Devotee Who Fed God Before Herself

The Bhakti tradition often finds its clearest, most moving expression not in grand temples, but in small, ordinary acts of unguarded love.

Andal, a young devotee raised by her father, a garland-maker for the temple, would secretly wear the fragrant flower garlands meant as a formal offering to Lord Vishnu before they were ever presented at the altar, admiring herself in them quietly, then carefully replacing them exactly as they had been, hoping no one would ever notice. When her father eventually discovered this and was horrified at what he assumed was clear disrespect toward the deity, he quickly discarded those garlands and offered fresh ones instead, ashamed of his daughter's innocent trespass. That very night, Vishnu appeared in his dream, gently telling him that he only desired the garlands already touched by Andal's devotion, worn first by someone who loved him so completely and unselfconsciously.

Her innocent act, considered improper by strict human ritual standards, was cherished precisely because it came from unguarded, personal love rather than careful formal correctness or rehearsed protocol. We often assume that devotion, whether in faith or in our closest relationships, must follow proper, expected form to be considered valuable, forgetting that sincerity often matters far more than protocol ever could.

Today, express care for someone in your own natural, unrehearsed way, rather than the more "correct" or expected way you assume is required of you.

–DAIV

PIC TALK



An artist prepares idols of Goddess Durga ahead of the Durga Puja festival, in Nadia, West Bengal. PHOTO: PTI

Intolerance damages interpersonal relationships



AJIT KUMAR BISHNOI

2ND OPINION



Let me begin with a simple definition of tolerance. It is the ability to accept reality and adjust accordingly. For example, views do clash in some matters with a marriage partner. But views match in the majority of matters. Then, why not adjust to opposite views, which may cause less harm than rejecting the partner? Tolerance is accepting and coexisting.

Such an attitude also helps in dealing with the reality of the world. This planet is naturally painful due to the misuse of free will by the majority. There is no way we can undo it; even God does not; He respects individuality. After all, the 'Karmaphala Principle' (results according to acts) applies to all, with rewards and punishments. If we wish to receive more rewards than punishments, we must practise tolerance. Adjusting to others is highly beneficial.

Another example will help. A mother rejects her dear daughter due to her choice of marriage, which the mother considers wrong. She chooses to ignore the countless good qualities of her daughter. The mother does not even know what the result will be. The marriage may succeed. If it does not, what harm will be done that is greater than breaking the relationship with the daughter? Such is the damage caused by all-pervading intolerance.

I will take up next the matter of intolerance towards the circumstances in which we are placed. What does it do? We are forced into doing things that we feel should not have been thrust upon us. Now that there is no option other than to go along, accepting the pain of what has become a duty has to be learned. God has solutions in all such situations. He has all the answers, no matter what circumstances one is placed in (The Bhagavad Gita, verse 18.58). Most importantly, God will give us the capacity to tolerate. Returning to the same example of the estranged daughter, God can even make the marriage successful; there is nothing beyond Him.

Therefore, let us learn to be tolerant and act dutifully. Step one has to be a close connection with God. Step two has to be a preparedness to be tolerant. Step three must be dutifulness in all circumstances. Step four is to have faith that, with God in the loop, 'theek chalega' (things will work out) if we remain patient.

Now, some guidelines for peaceful and successful existence. Do not go by gut reaction or be judgmental. Let God guide; He does if we remain in His shelter. Have a empathy, which will allow you to listen to, and better still, see the viewpoint of others.

Have a mood to serve; then, you will accept others better. Even better is to have a mentality of sacrifice, which has more benefits than we can imagine. The benefits will be many more; the senses and the mind will come under better control. There will be harmony, and problem-solving will become easier. What more are we looking for? If we take shelter in God, He Himself will become the 'karta' (doer) in our life, which will ensure 100 per cent success.

The writer is a spiritual teacher and a columnist

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Keep politics off campuses

Educational institutions must remain free from political interference and partisan conflicts. The recent attempts by opposition parties to link the unrest at Lovely Professional University (LPU) to the political transition of its Chancellor are unfortunate and unhelpful. Using a campus incident to settle political scores risks distracting attention from the more important questions of student safety, discipline and institutional accountability. The university administration must bear primary responsibility for maintaining order and ensuring the safety and welfare of students on campus. Political changes involving individuals associated with an institution should not become a justification for administrative shortcomings. Universities must have strong, independent mechanisms to prevent and resolve conflicts effectively.

Dragging educational institutions into political disputes can undermine the academic environment and weaken public confidence in higher education. Political parties should therefore refrain from turning campus incidents into partisan battles. Universities must be allowed to address their internal affairs through established institutional processes, while authorities should ensure that student safety remains the foremost priority.

SANJAY CHOPRA | PUNJAB

Festive prices hit middle class

The increase in prices of consumer durables such as air-conditioners, televisions, refrigerators and washing machines from October 1 is likely to put additional pressure on middle-class households already dealing with rising expenses. The festive season is traditionally a period when families plan major purchases, including replacing ageing appliances or upgrading their homes. However, higher prices could force many to reconsider or postpone these purchases.

Air-conditioners are expected to become 5-8 per cent more expensive, while prices of some televisions, refrigerators and washing machines could rise by 3-4 per cent. For middle-income families, even a few additional thousand rupees can significantly affect household budgets and leave less room for spending on education, travel and healthcare.

There may, however, be a temporary opportunity for consumers. Dealers with older inventory may continue selling some products at previous prices before the increases are fully reflected. Festive discounts may offer limited relief if the overall affordability of consumer durables continues to decline. Businesses and policymakers should remain mindful of the pressure rising prices place on household consumption.

S SANKARANARAYANAN | CHENNAI

A miracle against the odds

The miraculous survival of 75-year-old Kasi Dalei, who reportedly floated nearly 25 kilometres for an entire night in the raging Brahmani River in Odisha's Jajpur district, is an extraordinary testament to human resilience.

Swept away in pitch darkness, she endured more than 12 hours in turbulent waters in an area known for saltwater crocodiles. Her determination to stay afloat against such terrifying odds is nothing short of remarkable.

Equally deserving of praise are two local fishermen whose swift and selfless actions helped rescue her the following morning. While Dalei's survival is cause for celebration, the circumstances of the incident raise a serious concern. She fell into the river while attending nature's call, highlighting the urgent need for safe sanitation facilities in vulnerable areas.

The local administration must also strengthen riverbank fencing and safety measures in flood-prone and crocodile-inhabited regions. Basic sanitation and safety infrastructure can prevent such tragedies.

Kasi Dalei's story is ultimately a powerful reminder that hope, courage and human resilience can prevail even in the most perilous circumstances.

RANGANATHAN SIVAKUMAR | CHENNAI

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FTA: A new foundation for a strong Naya Bharat

There is a need for today's youth to reskill and upskill on emerging technologies prevailing across the globe and to learn and experiment in international laboratories. Talented youth can bring back their knowledge and pool of information to our country to build a "Naya Bharat", leading to Viksit Bharat@2047



T SENTHIL SIVA SUBRAMANIAN

A question is always put across the table: Why should India establish strong innovation and business partnerships with global countries?



FTA – Ease of Business Leading to Ease of Living

The answer is as simple as that: India always believes in the visionary mantra "Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam" — the world is one family. Over the past decade/12 years, global countries have built fundamentally strong and vibrant faith and trust in India because of robust policy frameworks like Make in India and Make for India, that roar louder through simple working mechanisms like ease of doing business, ease of culture and ease of innovation and infrastructure, ease of manufacturing leading to ease of trade and, most importantly, ease of skilling.

The classical example is the Unified Payments Interface (UPI), which was widely accepted across the globe, and the pioneering discovery and invention of the COVID vaccine that has added value to humanity across the globe.

Outlook of global countries on India

India has achieved several milestones, as is clearly visible through the chairmanship and presidency of BRICS, QUAD, G20 and, recently, the Asian Productivity Organization, Japan. This shows the active involvement of our nation in extending support and sharing our technology, innovation, infrastructure and industrialisation with global countries. India is eager to learn and adapt to the benchmarks and quality standards of international systems.

Proven examples include the semiconductor manufacturing plants established by Micron, Kaynes and Foxconn, the recent Microsoft Hub centre established in India, and the Boeing Centre of Excellence in Bengaluru.

India's focus on several critical areas, such as critical minerals and defence systems strengthened through collaboration with foreign technologies, and sharing our innovative swadeshi, vocal-for-local products across the globe, stands out as prominent outcomes of relationships with emerging countries.

Global skilling/innovation avenues for youth of India

India's pool of talent is spread across the globe to carry forward the legacy of our Hon'ble Prime Minister of India, Shri Narendra Modi's vision of Viksit Bharat 2047, which is possible through collaborative and cooperative partnerships.

The interest of global industries in establishing Global Capability Centres across PAN India has brought tremendous impact on the employment of talented youth. Global countries have opened fellowships/training programmes for young professionals and experienced personnel, like the Fulbright Scholarship for teaching and research and fellowships for teaching administrators, highlighting a developed India and laying the foundational stones for Viksit Bharat.

International skilling programmes for youth of India

1. The National Productivity Council, under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry, Government of India, in collaboration with the Asian Productivity Organization (APO), in partnership with the Matsuo-Iwasawa Laboratory, University of Tokyo, is facilitating the APO Genuine AI Action (GAIA) Internship Placement Programme initiative to boost the practical application of Artificial Intelligence (AI) capability development and real-time AI applications.

2. IBM is offering a virtual internship training programme for undergraduate students at universities across PAN India, which is a credit-based course and a globally recognised industry-certified programme.

The tangible outcomes of SEMICON 2.0, held in September 2026, have resulted in the starting of a training programme on semiconductor technology from Class 10 onwards.

3. CERN, Switzerland, has invited Indian school students to display their unique product innovations, providing a rare opportunity to interact with the world's scientists.

4. International fellowships, student exchange programmes and calls for nominations include the OPCW Centre for Chemistry and Technology, Netherlands; UNESCO-Hamdan Prize for Teacher Development; University of Tours, France, under the Semester Exchange Programme; DAAD Fellowship; and Commonwealth Fellowship.

Additionally, global countries are inviting our young talents and innovators to highlight their frugal products on international platforms.

The Bharat Innovates 2026 — a breakthrough in the collaboration between India and France, jointly inaugurated and historically launched by Indian Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi and French President Emmanuel Macron on June 14, 2026, in Nice, France — stands out as a big breakthrough in the trusted partnership and alliances.

BRICS 2026 — A benchmarked partnership with BRICS countries has transformed the picture of India's keenness to accommodate and adapt foreign technologies for our nation.

Global AI Summit, SEMICON 2.0 and many more not only added value to partnerships and collaborations but also showed the strong and trusted commitment of our nation to welcome global countries to establish a strong foothold in India.

This paved the way and benefited our nation by several folds, especially in skilling and talent development across different fields such as semiconductors, quantum, AI, nuclear, aerospace, defence and critical minerals. India has taken a step-by-step and stable approach to reframe our policies, like the historic Foreign Trade Agreement (FTA), that could benefit global countries and result in enhancing our domestic value chain, which leads to enhancement in GDP.

THE BHARAT INNOVATES 2026 — A BREAKTHROUGH IN THE COLLABORATION BETWEEN INDIA AND FRANCE, JOINTLY INAUGURATED AND HISTORICALLY LAUNCHED BY INDIAN PRIME MINISTER SHRI NARENDRA MODI AND FRENCH PRESIDENT EMMANUEL MACRON ON JUNE 14, 2026, IN NICE, FRANCE — STANDS OUT AS A BIG BREAKTHROUGH IN THE TRUSTED PARTNERSHIP AND ALLIANCES

Viksit youth for Naya Bharat

There is a need for today's youth to reskill and upskill on emerging technologies prevailing across the globe and to learn and experiment in international laboratories. Talented youth can bring back their knowledge and pool of information to our country to build a "Naya Bharat6, leading to Viksit Bharat@2047.

Today's youth are keen to learn the techniques and tools, especially the clear visibility of Cadence and Synopsys, Samsung Cohort to build AI integrated with semiconductor chips in India, which could be used to predict critical domains like weather and climate change to prevent disasters, and quantum superconducting processors for drug discovery.

Indian bricks built through cementing skilling, innovation, international infrastructure, business partnerships, culture and consciousness will form the stepping stones for Viksit Bharat@2047.

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How drone policy is building an ecosystem





NEHA SEHRA | REETA SONY

A drone flying over an Indian farm is no longer a symbol of futuristic technology. The Government of India has been actively supporting the use of drones in agriculture, rural livelihoods, and public services. What was once an emerging technology is now finding practical applications nationwide. As of February 2026, India had 38,500+ registered drones, 39,890 DGCA-certified remote pilots, and 244 approved training organisations (PIB, 2026). Drones, or unmanned aerial vehicles (UAVs), are remotely operated aircraft equipped with sensors and other technologies that allow them to collect data and perform tasks from the air. Their ability to provide high-resolution, on-demand information has made them useful in agriculture, where they can support crop monitoring, precision spraying, crop insurance, and the early identification of pests and diseases.

India's drone journey initially began with regulation and safety. In 2018, Drone Regulations 1.0 focused on registration, permission, airspace restrictions, and safety. The Digital Sky platform introduced a 'No permission, no take-off' approach, while operations were initially limited to visual line of sight, daytime operations, and 400 feet. By 2021, the policy approach began to change from regulation to liberalisation. The Government moved from primarily regulating drone operations to creating conditions for their wider adoption. The new framework reduced the regulatory burden on operators and businesses: the number of forms fell from 25 to five, the number of fee categories from 72 to four, and the fee for a remote pilot licence from ₹3,000 to ₹100. The yellow zone around airports was also reduced from 45 km to 12 km, while the requirement for security clearance before operations was removed. These reforms were accompanied by a significant expansion of permissible operating space, with nearly 90 per cent of India's airspace subsequently designated as a green zone for drone operations up to 400 feet.



Taken together, these measures did more than simplify compliance; they lowered entry barriers for entrepreneurs, manufacturers, service providers, and users. The next step was to move beyond regulation and build an indigenous drone ecosystem. The Government began treating drones not only as an aviation technology but also as an emerging industrial sector. The Production Linked Incentive (PLI) Scheme allocated ₹120 crore over three financial years to support domestic manufacturing of drones and drone components, signalling an effort to build indigenous capabilities in the sector. It has attracted ₹595 crore in investment and generated around 2,650 jobs, alongside a reduction in GST on drones to 5 per cent in September 2025. This was complemented by the Drone Certification Scheme, which sought to simplify the certification process for manufacturers, while the Government's import policy restricted imports of complete drones but permitted drone components, encouraging domestic assembly and manufacturing.

Mission Drone Shakti strengthened the ecosystem by promoting drone start-ups and Drone-as-a-Service models. Since 2022, the focus has shifted towards deployment, particularly in agriculture through schemes such as the Sub-Mission on Agricultural Mechanisation and Namo Drone Didi. Between 2023-24 and 2025-26, 2,122 drones were approved for distribution, while over 40,000 Kisan Drone demonstrations covered approximately 41,000 hectares. Drones have also become central to the SVAMITVA programme for mapping rural inhabited areas and preparing property records. By March 2026, drone surveys had been completed in 3.29 lakh of the targeted 3.44 lakh villages, and 3.10 crore property cards had been prepared for 1.87 lakh villages. The impact is extending beyond land records: by August 2026, more than 11,000 loans worth around Rs 1,713 crore had reportedly been disbursed using SVAMITVA property cards.

At the same time, Namo Drone Didi is connecting drone technology with women-led rural entrepreneurship: 1,094 drones had been distributed to women Self-Help Groups by January 2026, including 500 under the scheme, with members trained as drone pilots. These developments show a broader shift in government policy from asking how drones can be regulated to demonstrating how the technology can improve agricultural services, strengthen land governance, and create new livelihood opportunities in rural India.

The experience on the ground also shows why these policy interventions matter. Interviews conducted with drone service providers, farmers, government officials, and academic experts as part of this research indicate significant potential for improving the efficiency of agricultural spraying. One drone operator reported that a UAV could cover a hectare in around 30 minutes. Another stakeholder compared conventional spraying, which could require approximately 100-120 litres of water and take two to two-and-a-half hours, with UAV spraying that used around 10-12 litres and could be completed in 10-15 minutes. These experiences illustrate how drones can make agricultural operations more targeted and time-efficient. Stakeholders also highlighted the importance of government-supported demonstrations and training, while pilots emphasised the need to assess field-level risks such as electrical wires and uneven terrain.

India's drone journey shows what sustained government support can achieve when regulation, industrial policy, and development programmes move together. The GoI has created an enabling policy environment while using drones to address practical challenges in agriculture, land governance, and rural livelihoods. The next challenge is to scale these gains while strengthening training, safety, awareness, and responsible use.

With continued policy support and greater participation from start-ups, farmers, women-led groups, and local institutions, drones can become an important part of India's broader technology and development strategy. The story of India's drones is therefore no longer only about flying machines; it is about building an ecosystem in which technology serves economic opportunity, public services, and inclusive development.

Neha Sehra, Research Associate, CSLG, JNU and Reeta Sony, Associate Professor, CSLG, JNU

Validation culture: A defining measure of success



GURDEEP KAUR

In today's age of online networking, most people, young or old, have developed a new habit of posting personal achievements and developments, no matter if they are big or small; happy or not so happy, on WhatsApp Status, Facebook, Instagram, and other platforms. A young child who clears his examination seeks validation for his success from not just close acquaintances but from online contacts as well. A college student wins a competition, but the celebration seems incomplete until the photographs go online. A young professional gets a new job and, before settling into the new role, updates his profile, announcing the achievement to the world.

The trend is not unusual anymore.

In today's world, life is increasingly being lived in two places — the real world and the virtual. Between the two lies validation. Likes, comments, followers, shares, views, and reactions may appear trivial, but they increasingly influence how people see themselves and measure their achievements. What was once a private moment of happiness now seeks acknowledgement from the public. The desire to be recognised and appreciated is an inherent human nature, of course. It indeed works as a positive reinforcer. A child looks towards a parent after winning a race; a student waits for a teacher's approval; an employee hopes for recognition from a superior. We all look forward to being appreciated and to knowing that our efforts matter. But something has changed. The audience has grown, the applause has become measurable, and comparison has become constant. Social media has transformed validation from an occasional experience into a daily habit.

A photograph/video is uploaded, and the waiting begins. Who liked it? Who did not? Why did a particular friend see the story but not react? Why did someone else receive thousands of likes for what appears to be an ordinary post?

These questions may sound harmless, but repeated often enough, they can affect self-esteem. For a section of young people, validation has become almost addictive. The notification on a phone provides a tiny burst of happiness, while silence results in disappointment. The problem is not the desire to receive appreciation. The problem begins when external approval becomes the yardstick for internal worth.

A person usually finds himself or herself asking, "Do I like this?" but "Will people like this?"

That is a subtle but significant change.

It can be seen in something as simple as photographs. Selection is done from dozens of pictures taken that appear to be "perfect". The image is edited, the caption is carefully chosen and the post is timed. What the world sees is not necessarily false, but it is certainly selective and fabricated to a certain extent. And therein lies the irony: while social media promises connection, it can sometimes encourage young people to curate themselves rather than reveal themselves. The culture of validation also encourages a particularly dangerous habit — comparison.



The addiction to scrolling through updates about the lives, achievements and celebrations of others is at an all-time high. People see seemingly perfect bodies, homes, lifestyles and celebrations, while the viewer, dealing with ordinary problems, can become trapped in the so-called "highlight-reel effect". The comparison is unfair, as the struggles behind these achievements are rarely visible.

Definitely, the old saying, "The grass is always greener on the other side," has never seemed more relevant. Another most visible change introduced by validation culture is the changed meaning of success itself. Traditionally, achievement was associated with qualities such as perseverance, discipline, knowledge, and integrity. Today, visibility often accompanies success, often overshadowing it. A person who quietly builds his/her CV/profitable business may receive less attention than someone who frequently posts about his/her achievements. A talented artist working for years may remain unnoticed while a less accomplished but more visible creator has a huge fan following. This, however, does not mean social media success is meaningless. Far from it. Digital platforms have opened doors that were previously closed.

A young musician from a small Indian town can reach listeners across the country, while students and entrepreneurs can showcase their work and find opportunities online. Activists can also mobilise support for causes within hours.

The same technology that creates pressure can create opportunity by giving voice to those who remain unheard. Social media can build confidence by offering recognition to ideas, creativity and talent. Simply blaming social media, therefore, misses the point. Seeking recognition is natural, and social media is not inherently an enemy.

The real danger lies in confusing recognition with identity. Perhaps the most troubling consequence of the validation culture is the pressure to appear happy. A quiet evening may feel less valuable because it is not "post-worthy". A simple achievement may seem insignificant because someone else has achieved something bigger. Even relationships can become partly performative, with photographs and public declarations becoming symbols of success. In such an environment, "keeping up with the Khuranas/Chhabras" has acquired a digital form. The Khuranas/Chhabras may not even be neighbours anymore. They may be influencers, classmates, celebrities or complete strangers appearing on a screen. Following the trend and mad race for unneeded competition has detrimental impacts. People gradually learn to prioritise appearance over authenticity; public approval can become more important than personal satisfaction; careers may be chosen for prestige rather than passion, and achievements may be pursued for applause rather than purpose. Over time, this can create a society that is increasingly concerned with how things look rather than what they actually are. The consequences, hence, are far beyond impacting self-esteem. There isn't a need to panic; the need to reject technology is not a solution either. The need of the hour is to develop digital maturity. People should be able to enjoy an experience without photographing it, celebrate without announcing it, and create without constantly checking whether others approve.

It is important to understand that a follower count is not a character certificate. A viral post is not necessarily an achievement. A criticism in a comment section does not define a person's worth. And silence from an online audience does not make one's efforts meaningless.

The digital maturity lies in internalising that not everything meaningful needs an audience. And that the applause eventually fades. This indeed would be a liberating force. It is important to understand that life is all about learning and not being defined by success; rather, failure teaches you the toughest lessons of life. It is hard work, perseverance, resilience, and dedication, that add value to our lives and polish our personalities. In the age of social media, remember : not everything visible is valuable, and not everything valuable is visible.

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The Pioneer

NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

NSA detention on police confession invalid: SC

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

The Supreme Court on Tuesday ruled that the confession statement of an accused made before a police officer cannot be the basis for detaining him under the National Security Act (NSA).

The top court said preventive detention has always been regarded as an exceptional measure and, therefore, must be invoked with the utmost circumspection and only in those rarest of rare cases where the circumstances genuinely warrant such exercise.

A bench of Justices Dipankar Datta and Sheel Nagu said a confessional statement made before the police is not regarded as trustworthy evidence and is generally excluded from consideration against the maker.

"We are of the considered opinion that a confessional statement made before a police officer cannot, by itself and in the absence of any independent material lending support thereto, constitute a basis for forming the subjective satisfaction necessary to sustain an order of preventive detention.

"To permit such a course would be to allow a detention order to rest upon a foundation which the law itself regards with suspicion and excludes from evidentiary consideration," the bench said. The top court said that if the detaining authority has relied upon other materials apart from the confessional statement, the court has to ascertain whether the detention can be upheld based on such other materials.

"We reiterate that a mere confessional statement of the detenu (without any other substantive grounds



or material) cannot be relied on as the sole ground for passing an order of detention.

"This especially holds true in the facts of the present case where the detenu has consistently stated that his confessional statement has been obtained under threat and torture," the bench said while quashing the preventive detention of Mulla Afroz.

The Uttar Pradesh Police invoked the strict National Security Act (NSA) against Afroz in October 2025 for his alleged role in the 2024 communal violence in Sambhal.

The top court noted that the detention order was passed against Afroz on October 13, 2025, and he has already suffered considerable loss of liberty, even while being granted bail in all the cases relating to the incident in which he featured as an accused. In such circumstances, the process was made the punishment, the bench said, while imposing a cost of ₹10 lakh on the government for passing the illegal preventive detention order.

"Having regard to the peculiar facts and circumstances of the present case, particularly the status of the criminal proceedings against the appellant, the nature of the material relied upon by the detaining authority, and the multiple orders of bail passed in favour of the appellant, we are unable to persuade ourselves to sustain the detention order as legal and valid.

"The requisite nexus between the material relied upon and the satisfaction recorded by the detaining authority is conspicuously absent. In view of our conclusions on the invalidity of the grounds relied upon by the detaining authority, it does not become necessary for us to enter into the question of whether the offences in which the detenu is implicated are of such nature as to fall within the ambit of affecting national security or even disturbance of public order," the bench said. While pronouncing the judgment, Justice Datta also paid tribute to his law clerk, who passed away four days before his 27th birthday.

The NSA empowers the Centre and states to detain individuals to prevent them from acting in a manner "prejudicial to the defence of India". The maximum detention period is 12 months, though it can be revoked earlier. The NSA can be invoked by the local administration and has to be ratified by a board headed by a former high court judge. As it is preventive detention and not arrest, there is no legal obligation to present the detainee before a court of law.

Order Order

Shiv Sena leader's son, 5 others denied bail in Palghar case



A court in Palghar district on Tuesday rejected the bail applications of six accused, including Rohit, son of Shiv Sena MLA and former minister Rajendra Gavit, in a case related to alleged vandalism at a private hospital after an argument over medical bills earlier this month.

The ruling was delivered by First Class Judicial Magistrate Sujata Bandal after multi-day legal arguments between defence counsels and public prosecutors.

On the intervening night of September 5 and 6, Shiv Sena workers barged into Relief Hospital at Palghar where a few injured 'Govindas' (youngsters involved in formation of multi-storeyed human pyramids) who had participated in Dahi Handi celebrations had been admitted.

Claiming that the hospital was charging exorbitant fees, they allegedly vandalised the medical centre, threatened the doctors, assaulted staff members and forcibly took away one of the injured persons from the Intensive Care Unit (ICU). Acting on a complaint by the hospital, the police registered an FIR and arrested 23 individuals, including 12 members of a 'Govinda' troupe and several local political functionaries. (*PTI*)

Pune court acquits gangster in extortion case



A special court in Pune on Tuesday acquitted absconding gangster Nilesh Ghaywal and five others in a 2020 extortion case after the complainant and key prosecution witnesses turned hostile during trial.

Ghaywal is currently hiding abroad and facing separate charges under the Maharashtra Control of Organised Crime Act (MCOCA) over a September 2025 firing incident.

The other accused include Santosh Dhumal, Musa Sheikh, Akshay Gogawale, Kunal Kandhare and Vipul Majhire.

According to the prosecution, the alleged extortion demand was made in 2020 when Ghaywal was in prison in connection with another case. Dhumal had allegedly demanded a jeep from the complainant for a rally.

The Pune Crime Branch took over the investigation in the case. The complainant, however, later alleged that his statement had been recorded under pressure from the police and the investigating agency and denied the allegations. The Bombay High Court subsequently directed the police to record the complainant's statement afresh. The complainant again denied the alleged incident and said no such offence had taken place.

During the trial before the MCOCA court, the complainant denied the contents of the original complaint under oath, and other witnesses and panch witnesses also did not support the prosecution case. (*PTI*)

Antilia case: Court grants bail to Sachin Waze

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Mumbai

On Tuesday, a special court of the NIA granted bail to former police officer Sachin Waze in the case concerning the 2021 Antilia bomb scare and the murder of Mansukh Hiran, the court stating that the prosecution had not been able to prove beyond reasonable doubt a case of terrorism against him under the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA).

The Special Sessions Judge, Chakor S Baviskar, stated that there is no record indicating that the Ambani family was in any way "terrorised".

On February 25, 2021, an SUV containing explosives was discovered near the residence of the industrialist Mukesh Ambani, 'Antilia', in south Mumbai; Masnukh Hiran, the man who had the SUV, was found dead in a creek in the adjacent town of Thane on March 5, 2021.

The court pointed out that the National Investigation Agency (NIA) had not recorded any statements from any member of the Ambani family to show that they had



Sachin Waze

been terrorised. The record shows absolutely nothing, no matter how far one may stretch the imagination, to suggest that the Ambanis, or any of them, were or are terrified in any way.

The court stated that the Ambanis' everyday business had not seemed to be in any way disrupted from the time of the incident until now.

The fact that, as the prosecution claims, Sachin Waze had intended to instil terror or that the act of the accused was likely to have instilled terror in the minds of the Ambanis... is not something that can be found in the records, it was observed.

The court also observed that the gelatin sticks discovered in the SUV parked near the Ambani residence did not have any detonators and therefore could not be used to cause an explosion, thus failing to meet the 'means' necessary to constitute a 'terrorist act' as defined in Section 15 of the UAPA.

About the murder of businessman Mansukh Hiran, the court said that although it was a homicidal death, it had not been the direct result of a terrorist act.

The court pointed out that it remains an independent offence under Section 302 (murder) of the Indian Penal Code (IPC), avoiding the strict bail limitations under the UAPA.

The court granted Waze's bail request by releasing him on a personal bond of Rs 1 lakh with a surety. The prosecution has accused Waze and others of forming a "terrorist gang" and entering into a criminal conspiracy between February and March 20.

On February 25, 2021, an SUV with explosives inside was found near billionnaire industrialist Mukesh Ambani's residence.

Businessman Hiran, who was in possession of the SUV before it was allegedly stolen, was found dead in a creek in neighbouring Thane on March 5, 2021.

Sachin Waze was arrested by the National Investigation Agency (NIA) on March 13, 2021. He was subsequently made an accused in a corruption case being probed by the CBI and Enforcement Directorate. Waze has already got bail in the corruption case.

Kamra moves SC over legislative privileges

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Stand-up comedian Kunal Kamra and journalist Seema Chishti have moved the Supreme Court seeking to intervene in a case on the interpretation of provisions related to the scope of legislative privileges of MLAs and its effect on the freedom of speech and expression.

A seven-judge Constitution bench would commence hearing on October 6 on the interpretation of provisions related to the scope of legislative privileges of MLAs and its effect on the freedom of speech and expression.

In his plea, the comedian submitted that he is directly affected by the questions of law before the top court because of the privilege proceedings pending against him in the Maharashtra Assembly over his stand-up comedy special "Naya Bharat". Kamra submitted that the exercise of legislative privilege "to stifle" the speech of citizens strikes at the heart of democracy.

The stand-up comedy kicked up a huge controversy over jokes targeting Maharashtra Deputy Chief Minister Eknath Shinde. BJP legislator Pravin Darekar had moved a breach of privilege notice against Kamra and Shiv Sena (UBT) spokesperson Sushma Andhare.

"The applicant believes that his case demonstrates that the exercise of legislative privileges affects not only the freedom of speech and expression of members of the press, but also of any citizen who wishes to speak about the actions of members of the legislature," Kamra said in his plea.

HC grants Suvendu more time to file reply in Mamata's poll plea

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Kolkata

The Calcutta High Court on Tuesday granted Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari further time until October 1 to file a written statement in an election petition by his predecessor Mamata Banerjee challenging his victory from Bhabanipur Assembly constituency.

Banerjee moved the election petition in June alleging corrupt practices, illegal deletion of voters from the electoral roll and irregularities in the counting process.

Justice Gaurang Kanth extended the time for Adhikari to file the written



statement until October 1.

The chief minister, who was declared winner in Bhabanipur seat by over 15,000 votes, moved an application seeking three days' leave to file a written statement in the election petition by Banerjee. Adhikari's counsel stated before the court that the copy of the election petition was received on July 3.

After the initial period for filing the written statement expired in the first week of August, Justice Kanth had on August 4 granted a further four weeks to file a written statement, which expired on September 1.

The court noted that the written statement could not be filed within the said period. Adhikari's counsel submitted that the delay was due to conferences which were required to be held with the applicant's representatives.

Delhi High Court slaps ₹1 lakh cost over virtual court appearance

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The Delhi High Court has imposed a cost of ₹1 lakh on a lawyer for appearing virtually before it from a moving car, holding that the lawyer's conduct was in violation of the rules. Justice Om Prakash Shukla said while the convenience offered by virtual hearings was appreciated, it could not be at the cost of the court's decorum or causing disturbance in the conduct of judicial proceedings.

"When this court has to deal with more than 70 matters in a day, background noise and movement during the hearing are disruptive for this court to proceed," said the judge in the order passed on September 28.

"In view of the aforesaid, a cost of ₹1 lakh is imposed upon learned Counsel for the Decree Holder, payable to Delhi High Court Legal Services Committee within one week from today," the court ordered.

In its order, the court observed that under the high court's Electronic Evidence and Video Conferencing Rules, an endeavour has to be made by advocates not to join proceedings from vehicles except in exceptional circumstances and with permission. Justice Shukla underscored that such a requirement was not merely procedural and to ensure that even when lawyers appear virtually, they do so from an environment conducive to the proper functioning of the court.

Panel formed under ex-CJI for home buyer's claims

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

The Delhi High Court on Tuesday constituted a monitoring committee headed by former chief justice of India Sanjiv Khanna to verify genuine homebuyers of the stalled Greenopolis housing project in Haryana's Gurugram and to streamline the restitution process.

The scope of the committee is to verify and prepare a list of genuine homebuyers of the Greenopolis project, regardless of whether such persons have paid money towards purchase of units in the project to Three C Shelters or to Orris Infrastructure, the high court said.

Justice Anup Jairam Bhambhani passed the order while dealing with pleas by the Enforcement Directorate, Greenopolis Welfare Association (GWA) and Greenopolis Welfare Confederation (GWC) challenging a November 27, 2025 order of a trial court.



Former chief justice of India Sanjiv Khanna

While Justice Khanna would be the chairperson of the committee, he would be assisted by former judicial officers HS Sharma and AK Kuhar. The high court asked the committee to endeavour to complete its work within eight months of its first meeting and submit reports every three months. "The Monitoring Committee shall formulate an expeditious and transparent procedure to verify genuine homebuyers and the quantum of payments made by them, cross-referencing the material provided by the Directorate of Enforcement and the homebuyers," the court said in its 98-page judgment.

The committee will maintain a list of the assets attached by the ED in the PMLA proceedings, including particulars of the claimed owners of the particular assets; the updated status of attachment of each asset, viz., whether any challenge is pending to the attachment of any particular asset and, if so, at what stage and before which forum; and to obtain a valuation of each such asset.

The ED should also furnish to the committee the details of any other assets that the agency may attach in their ongoing proceedings.

The dispute relates to the Greenopolis project in Gurugram, developed by Three C Shelters and Orris Infrastructure. Of 1,862 units, 1,650 had been allotted before abandonment. Three C Shelters allegedly collected ₹776.60 crore and Orris collected ₹383.06 crore from homebuyers. The ED argued that ₹214.09 crore was siphoned off to related entities.

The special court, in its November 27, 2025 order had ordered restoration and disposal of properties attached by the ED. The federal agency challenged the order, citing improper identification of beneficiaries and non-compliance with the statutory framework.

The high court constituted the monitoring committee noting that there were several complexities in the case.

Ex-RCom executive gets bail in loan fraud case

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Mumbai

A special CBI court on Tuesday granted bail on medical grounds to former Reliance Communications Group managing director Amitabh Jhunjhunwala in a multi-crore State Bank of India loan fraud case.

Special Judge Nitin V Jiwane allowed the plea citing Jhunjhunwala's deteriorating health and relied on a recent Delhi High Court order that granted him statutory relief in a linked money-laundering probe. The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) arrested Jhunjhunwala on June 1.

Jhunjhunwala, through his advocates Aabad Ponda, Rahul Agarwal and Jasmine Purani, had sought relief citing unresolved spinal fractures, peripheral osteoporosis, sarcopenia, and coronary artery disease requiring sustained medical rehabilitation that could not be effectively administered in judicial custody.



Reliance Communications Group managing director Amitabh Jhunjhunwala

Ponda informed the court that the Delhi High Court had on September 22 granted the jailed executive regular bail under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) after finding him "sick or infirm".

Accepting the contention, the special judge noted that since the medical condition remains the same, the applicant is entitled to regular bail on medical grounds in the CBI case as well.

The Delhi High Court in clear and unequivocal words had observed that his medical condition "requires specialised treatment which is not confined to administration of medicines or symptomatic pain relief, but involves sustained rehabilitation and supervision over a period of time," the special court order said.

It then allowed his bail on execution of a PR bond of Rs 1 lakh with one or two local sureties in the like amount.

The CBI case stems from an August 2025 complaint by the State Bank of India against RCom and others alleging criminal conspiracy, cheating, and criminal breach of trust that resulted in an initial wrongful loss of ₹2,929.05 crore to the bank.

The probe agency claimed ₹1,200-crore loan disbursed by SBI in August 2016 based on purported asset-sale plans to Brookfield, which later turned non-performing and caused a wrongful loss of ₹970.25 crore.

The CBI submitted that Jhunjhunwala had served as Group Managing Director in the Anil Ambani-led group, exercised substantial control over corporate finance and banking operations, and actively participated in the alleged diversion and round-tripping of borrowed funds.

Engineering a future that works with nature



ANUBHA SINGH
Vice-Chancellor, COER University, Roorkee

Every monsoon brings a familiar story across India: flooded streets, stalled traffic, and submerged basements filling social media feeds. In Bengaluru, commuters gridlock on roads never built for today's vehicle volumes. In the hills of Uttarakhand, a heavy downpour can turn a freshly cut road into an active landslide zone. While one part of the country struggles to drain water away, another fights to keep the mountain itself from sliding down. These recurring crises are sharp reminders that we can no longer design infrastructure in isolation from nature.

For a long time, the dominant idea of development was straightforward: build more roads, wider drains, taller buildings and larger structures. Concrete became the visible symbol of progress. But Indian cities and landscapes are telling us that the question is no longer only how much we can build. It is whether what we build can withstand the conditions in which it has to function.

Take urban flooding. When torrential rain hits, the issue is rarely just about drain capacity. Water flows across an interconnected landscape shaped by soil permeability, land slope, built-up density, wetland conditions and tree coverage.

Artificial intelligence can become an important part of this transition. AI models



ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE CAN BECOME AN IMPORTANT PART OF THIS TRANSITION. AI MODELS CAN SYNTHESISE THESE COMPLEX VARIABLES TO SIMULATE VARIED RAINFALL SCENARIOS AND PINPOINT EXACT ACCUMULATION ZONES

can synthesise these complex variables to simulate varied rainfall scenarios and pinpoint exact accumulation zones. Instead of relying on guesswork, engineers can evaluate specific solutions, testing whether a site needs an expanded drain, a restored lake, permeable pavement, a rain garden, or simply clearing an obstruction along a natural drainage path. AI helps us view and plan the city as an integrated, living ecosystem.

The same principle applies to the mountains, perhaps even more urgently. At COER University in Roorkee, our proximity to the Himalayan region constantly reminds us that engineering solutions have to be sensitive to geography, climate and local communities. A student studying civil engineering here should not see a mountain road simply as a construction project but evaluate the slope stability, natural drainage, vegetation and surrounding settlements.

Technology elevates this holistic perspective. By combining sensors, satellite imagery, drones and AI-driven pattern recognition, we can continuously monitor slopes, bridges and retaining structures. Early detection of subtle ground shifts or altered water flows gives engineers crucial time to inspect and intervene before a minor issue escalates into a major disaster. At COER, our engineering and technology programmes sit alongside areas such as agriculture, management, legal studies, health sciences and humanities. That proximity creates an opportunity to ask questions that do not fit neatly inside one department: How should a climate-resilient city be planned? How can technology support farmers facing changing weather? How should AI be governed when it affects public infrastructure?

This is also the kind of interdisciplinary thinking that universities must encourage. The smartest infrastructure of the future may not always be the largest or most visible. Sometimes it may be a restored lake, a shaded street, a carefully monitored hillside or a drainage system designed around the natural movement of water.

The challenge is to use technology to understand nature better. A civil engineer designing a road, for instance, needs to understand more than materials and construction techniques. The engineer must also understand hydrology, ecology, climate patterns, urban planning and the social consequences of infrastructure decisions. Similarly, an AI engineer developing a predictive model for floods or landslides needs to understand the limitations of the data on which that model is trained.

The idea of resilience also needs to move beyond emergency response. A city should not become resilient only after a flood, a bridge failure or a landslide has occurred. Resilience should be built into the design stage itself. This means asking difficult questions before construction begins: Where does water naturally flow? What happens when rainfall exceeds the historical maximum? What will happen to this slope after vegetation is removed? Can the infrastructure be repaired locally? What happens to the surrounding community if the system fails?

Universities have a responsibility to prepare young engineers for this reality. Classrooms should increasingly become spaces where students work on real problems rather than only hypothetical ones. A student team could map a local watershed, analyse traffic and rainfall data, examine a vulnerable hillside, or design a low-cost early-warning system. Such experiences teach students that engineering is not simply about finding technically correct answers; it is about finding solutions that work in the real world.

India has the talent, technology and institutional capacity to make this transition. What we need is a stronger connection between them. Universities, governments, industry and communities must work together to make infrastructure more adaptive, predictive and responsive. India will continue to build. But the next phase of development should teach us to build with greater humility.

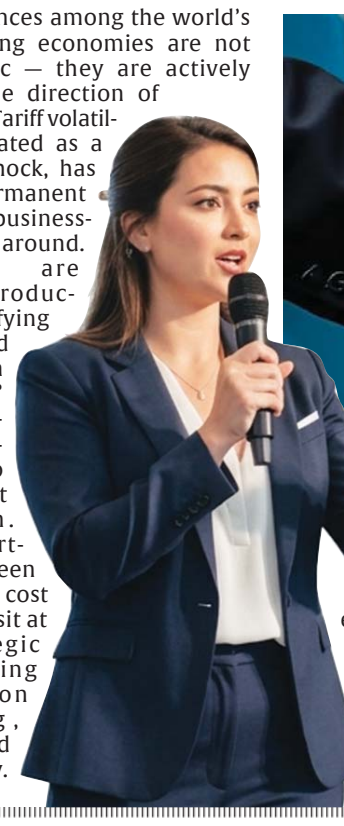
Why global trade needs a new generation of talent

ALKA MAURYA
Director, Symbiosis Institute of International Business (SIIB)

In just the past month, two major summits brought together leaders from the world's largest developing economies: the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO) and BRICS. Together, these two blocs represent a huge share of the world — the SCO alone accounts for 43 per cent of the global population and 23 per cent of the world economy, while BRICS nations make up nearly half the world's population and about 40 per cent of global GDP.

The SCO summit ended with the Bishkek Declaration, in which member countries promised "special and differential treatment for developing countries" in global trade rules, and reaffirmed their preference for diplomacy over Western sanctions pressure. At the BRICS summit, Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi called on developing nations to become "rule-shapers" instead of "rule-takers", describing the goal as turning the current "pyramid of privilege" into a "platform of partnership."

These alliances among the world's fastest-growing economies are not just symbolic — they are actively reshaping the direction of global trade. Tariff volatility, once treated as a temporary shock, has become a permanent feature that businesses must plan around. Companies are reshoring production, diversifying suppliers, and moving from "just-in-time" to "just-in-case" inventory models to guard against disruption. Trade departments once seen as back-office cost centres now sit at the strategic table, shaping decisions on sourcing, pricing, and market entry.





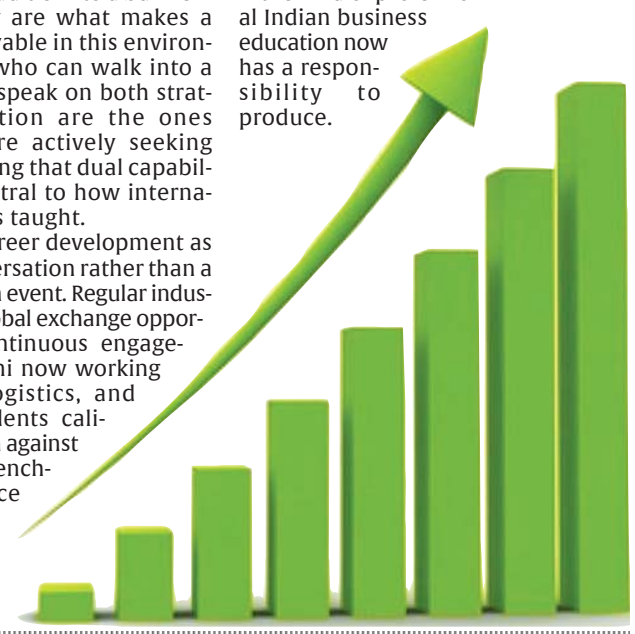
For a country like India, with its growing manufacturing base and expanding services exports, this moment is both a challenge and an opportunity. What this shift demands, more than anything, is talent that understands global trade as a living, moving system rather than a static subject.

Professionals today need to read regulatory signals as fluently as balance sheets, understand regional trade agreements alongside currency risk, and combine analytical rigour with the cultural fluency to negotiate across markets. This is precisely the gap international business education must close — and institutes preparing this workforce carry real responsibility.

Classroom learning in this field can no longer stay divorced from the realities businesses face outside it. Case studies drawn from live tariff disputes, simulations of supply chain rerouting, and exposure to trade compliance and digital trade tools are no longer optional additions to a business curriculum; they are what makes a graduate employable in this environment. Students who can walk into a boardroom and speak on both strategy and execution are the ones organisations are actively seeking today, and building that dual capability has to be central to how international business is taught.

We also see career development as an ongoing conversation rather than a placement-season event. Regular industry immersion, global exchange opportunities, and continuous engagement with alumni now working across trade, logistics, and policy help students calibrate their growth against a fast-changing benchmark. Confidence built this way tends to last well beyond the first job.

The world of international trade will keep shifting — that much is certain. What organisations, and nations, will increasingly compete for is talent that can shift with it: technically sound, globally aware, and personally resilient. That is the kind of professional Indian business education now has a responsibility to produce.



Skills and mindsets of management students

DIVYA SHARMA
Assistant Professor (Information Management), MDI Gurgaon

Gen-Z knows a thing or two about plot twists. The workplace they are entering is likely to offer plenty of them - artificial intelligence reshaping the workplace, business models transforming, career trajectories becoming non-linear, and skills becoming obsolete in no time. For a student pursuing management education, the only certainty is perhaps that uncertainty is the new normal.

A degree in management can prepare a student for the day-to-day realities of managerial work. But organisations today are looking for recruits with more than conceptual understanding and the ability to practically apply their classroom learning in the industry. They need individuals who have the resilience to withstand change, the skills to work with change, and the judgement to shape change responsibly.

Careers today seldom unfold along clearly defined paths. Young managers, therefore, need to take greater ownership of their career trajectories from the outset. They must be agile enough to learn, unlearn and relearn repeatedly as technologies, industries and roles evolve.

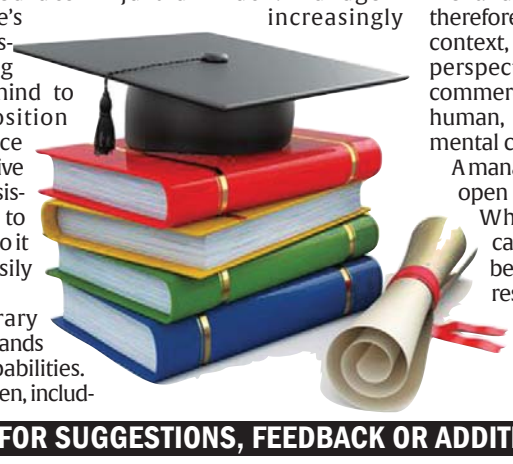
Equally important is resilience. Setbacks, difficult assignments, rejection and failure are inevitable parts of professional life. What matters is the ability to recover from them without allowing a single episode to define one's career or confidence. Young professionals must be able to handle disagreement, accept criticism, and remain emotionally robust in workplaces that may not always be psychologically comforting or reassuring.



This does not mean becoming insensitive. It means developing the confidence and conviction to hold one's ground when necessary, while retaining the maturity of mind to change one's position when the evidence changes. The objective is not to become resistant to change, but to remain responsive to it without being easily destabilised by it.

The contemporary workplace also demands a wider set of capabilities. Technological acumen, including data literacy, AI fluency and digital know-how, will increasingly be fundamental. Yet, as technology becomes better at producing answers, the distinctive managerial ability to ask the right questions and frame the right problems becomes even more valuable.

Communication, collaboration and influence matter just as much. Managers increasingly work across functions, organisations and geographies, often needing to achieve outcomes without formal authority. The ability to communicate persuasively, work with diverse stakeholders, and build alignment will remain critical. Perhaps the most enduring capability, however, will be learning agility, that is, the ability to know what to learn, when to learn it and how to keep oneself relevant.



Finally, management students must develop a professional compass, that is, a sense of the kind of manager they want to become. Ethical judgement and responsibility assume even greater importance at a time when managers have access to powerful technologies and businesses operate across geographical and cultural boundaries.

Managerial decisions increasingly have consequences that extend beyond profits and performance to employees, customers, communities and the environment. Future managers must, therefore, learn to recognise context, appreciate diverse perspectives, and balance commercial objectives with human, social and environmental considerations.

A management degree may open the door to a career. What sustains that career, however, will be the ability to remain resilient, keep learning, exercise judgement and use managerial power responsibly.

Business schools must move beyond subject silos

RADHIKA SHRIVASTAVA
President & CEO, Fortune Institute of International Business (FIIB)

Every year, thousands of young Indians enter MBA classrooms and choose between Finance, Marketing, Operations and HR. There is good reason for this. Business decisions require domain knowledge. You cannot exercise sound financial judgement without understanding finance, build a credible brand without understanding consumers, or make good people decisions without understanding organisations and human behaviour. The issue with MBA specialisations is not that they are irrelevant. The problem is that they are not sufficient.

The world our graduates are entering is increasingly problem-oriented rather than discipline-based. A finance professional might find themselves analysing data, engaging with technology, assessing risk or communicating with senior executives. A marketer increasingly operates at the intersection of consumer insights, data, technology and commercial strategy. An HR professional must understand people as well as productivity, data and the impact of AI.

Despite the continued need for expertise, careers are increasingly multidisciplinary.

This poses a different challenge for management education. We need to continue building strong disciplinary foundations while also teaching students how to transfer what they learn into new contexts. This is even more important in the age of AI.

AI can retrieve information and generate analysis quickly, but speed is not expertise. Evaluating AI still requires deep knowledge to ask the right questions, spot gaps and judge accuracy. Domain expertise, therefore, remains essential.

Meanwhile, knowledge alone cannot be the endpoint of management education. Employers ultimately assess graduates through what they can do: the problems they can frame, the decisions they can make, the tools they can use, the people they can work with and how quickly they can learn when circumstances change.

Business schools, therefore, need to move beyond the traditional equation of subjects + courses + specialisation = career readiness.

This thinking led us to create FIIBX, a capability system that sits across our PGDM. While students continue to develop disciplinary depth, learning is also organised around career pathways: Consulting & Business Transformation, Revenue & Growth, Finance, Operations & Analytics, People & Organisation, and Founders & Ventures.

The distinction is deliberate. A pathway does not replace a discipline. It asks a different question: not just what have you studied, but what are you becoming capable of doing with what you have studied?

This means giving students exposure to industry, opportunities to make decisions with incomplete information, experience in applying AI thoughtfully, cross-functional collaboration and ways to demonstrate capabilities through work rather than examinations alone.

WHAT MAY BE BECOMING OBSOLETE IS THE ASSUMPTION THAT CHOOSING ONE IS ENOUGH TO PREPARE SOMEONE FOR A CAREER



It also changes what we should assess. If tests primarily reward recall, students will optimise for recall. If they reward polished outputs, generative AI can increasingly produce those outputs. But if we assess how students frame problems, interrogate evidence, challenge AI recommendations, reconcile competing perspectives and defend solutions, we begin to measure something closer to managerial capability.

The relationship between AI and management education, therefore, cannot simply be about adding AI courses to an existing curriculum, nor about dismantling disciplines.

The more important question is how we combine depth, breadth and application. Students need depth because judgement without knowledge becomes superficial. They need breadth because business problems rarely respect disciplinary boundaries. And they need the capability to apply both because careers will continue to evolve long after the knowledge acquired during an MBA has changed. The MBA specialisation is not becoming obsolete. What may be becoming obsolete is the assumption that choosing one is enough to prepare someone for a career.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

India-China relations back on track: Jaishankar

YOSHITA SINGH ■ New York


Union Minister S Jaishankar during an event at Asia Society in New York, US PTI

The ties between India and China are "better" today as compared to a couple of years ago, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar has said, underlining that as the border issues are resolved, the relationship returns to normalcy.

Jaishankar was responding to a question on India-China relations, which have seen an upswing in recent times, including with President Xi Jinping's recent visit to India for the BRICS Leaders' Summit hosted by New Delhi.

"If you asked me, compared to where you were in 2025, is the relationship better today? I would say yes. Compared to 2024, even more so," Jaishankar said during a conversation hosted at Asia Society . He said it's not so much a "structural change", but part of the reason why things have improved is "they had gone so much off-track that the moment you stabilised it, it was going to improve, because after what happened in 2020 and the long standoff that we had on the border, the relationship had really been impacted."

Following the 2020 border standoff between India and China, all "normal contacts" between the two nations had come to a halt, he said, adding that while "trade was continuing", official exchanges, visa issuance, and flights had been impacted.

"So once the border standoff was resolved, it was natural that this would start to improve," he said.

There was also this logic, which Delhi had long been conveying to Beijing, that a "standoff between us, a dip in our relationship, actually doesn't help either of us. In fact, it is third parties who will take advantage of that.

"We also maintained consistently a very elementary principle of statecraft - don't get locked into a problem which benefits others," Jaishankar said. "It took a little while for the Chinese side to agree with that, for whatever reason, but I don't think that long standoff served our interests. It certainly didn't serve theirs. And to the extent there is an improvement in our relations, I think it certainly helps our position," not only vis-a-vis China but vis-a-vis the rest of the world, he said. "Because I don't want to get totally focused to my disadvantage on one particular relationship and issue. If I can find a solution which works for me, I would rather do that," he said.

"We came down to a very fundamental principle, which is that the state of the border determines the state of the relationship.

You can't have tension...on the border and say the relationship should be normal. So what we've had is, as the border comes back more towards normalcy, the relationship comes back more towards normalcy, and if the relationship comes back more towards normalcy, it helps both of us," Jaishankar said. (*PTI*)

China rolls out new measures to bolster property sector, economy



ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ Beijing

China on Tuesday rolled out new measures to help boost its economy and sluggish property sector as pressures ramp up ahead of a year-end target for hitting the government's economic growth goal.

The measures, some of the bigger moves made this year by Chinese officials, include encouraging targeted bank lending and new subsidies for homebuyers' mortgage interest payments.

China's central bank – the People's Bank of China – said it will be lowering the interest rate for its "pledged supplementary lending" facility, or PSL, by a quarter of a percentage point, bringing the one-year rate down to 1.5 per cent. PSL is low-cost financing that China's central bank provides to its major state policy banks to support state and public projects. The central bank said that by cutting the rates it hopes to better incentivise banks and better "serve national strategies".

The central bank will also increase the quota of relending for technological innovation by 200 billion yuan to a total of 1.4 trillion yuan. Separately, China's Government announced new mortgage interest subsidies for homebuyers.

From October, eligible first-time homebuyers can receive subsidies equal to an annualised rate of 1 percentage point on the mortgage principal.

UN envoy meets Houthis to avert Yemen escalation

SAMY MAGDY/ AHMED HATEM ■ Cairo



The UN envoy for Yemen said Tuesday he met with Houthi negotiators over the weekend in efforts to avert further escalation in Yemen amid fierce battles on the country's western coast between the Iran-backed Houthis and the Saudi-supported, but fragmented, Government forces.

The renewed violence, which has killed hundreds and displaced tens of thousands, is the latest twist in Yemen's conflict, which began in 2014 when the Iran-backed rebels took over the capital, Sanaa, forcing the country's Government to settle into exile in Saudi Arabia. The kingdom entered the war a year later with a multinational coalition.

In an interview with The Associated Press in Cairo, Hans Grundberg said his meeting in Muscat with the Houthis' chief negotiator, Mohammed Abdul-Salam, aimed to explore "if there are ways of how to avoid seeing the current escalation go even further." He also held talks in the Saudi capital, Riyadh, with the internationally recognised Government and regional powers, including Saudi Arabia, which has been the main target of the Houthis' latest escalation that he described as "unprecedented" and "dramatic."

Grundberg said the instability in the region, and the "influence of regional parties, including Iran, and also other neighbours to Yemen" has also impacted the course of the Yemen conflict.

Aided by Iranian experts, the Houthis stormed down the Red Sea coast earlier in September, capturing the strategic city of Mokha and a number of Red Sea islands, extending their reach to the key maritime waterway of the Bab el-Mandeb Strait. It was the Houthis' biggest land grab in years, and ended a 2022 ceasefire that largely stopped major fighting in Yemen's 12-year civil war.

The rebels have also intensified their attacks across the border into Saudi Arabia, attacking its oil facilities and preventing its tankers from passing through the Bab el-Mandeb strait, through which around 12 per cent of global trade passes. (*AP*)

Heavy snow halts search for 12 missing in Nepal

SHIRISH B PRADHAN ■ Kathmandu



Heavy snowfall on Tuesday halted the operation to rescue 12 missing people in the Himlung Himal avalanche that killed four people, an official said.

The avalanche struck the base camp of the 7,126-metre Himlung Himal peak in the Nar Phu area of Nepal's Manang district on Sunday, burying tents where 16 people, including supporting staff and mountain guides, were taking shelter. According to officials, so far four bodies have been recovered and 12 people remain missing – all of them Nepalese.

Earlier on Monday, Nepal Police said in a statement that eight people were missing in the avalanche. Officials had also said 22 people were initially reported missing, but rescuers managed to establish contact with 10 of them. These numbers were corrected by the relevant authorities on Tuesday.

"Twelve people who were hit by the avalanche are still out of contact," Sovbit Kunwar, administrative officer at Nepal National Mountain Guide Association, said on Tuesday.

According to officials, the rescue work has been hampered by bad weather at the accident site on Tuesday.

A 14-member rescue team has been deployed to search for the missing workers and guides, who usually provide logistical and other support to climbing expeditions.

The team left Kathmandu on Sunday and stayed overnight in Chame. On Monday morning, it was flown by helicopter from Chame to the Himlung base camp, where the search operation began. (*PTI*)

Pakistan forces kill 7 TTP terrorists in KPK, Balochistan

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA ■ Peshawar



Seven TTP terrorists were killed in separate intelligence-based operations in Pakistan's Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and Balochistan provinces on Tuesday, security sources said.

While five terrorists were killed in a security operation in the Bara area of Khyber district in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, two were killed in Chagai district of Balochistan.

A large quantity of weapons and ammunition was recovered from the terrorists killed in Bara, and their hideouts were also destroyed during the operation, the sources said.

The militants belonged to the banned Tehreek-i-Taliban Pakistan (TTP) outfit, they said.

The latest operations came two days after the military killed 71 terrorists in Shaban and other areas of Balochistan.

In Khyber Pakhtunkhwa, eight terrorists were killed, while two security personnel and four others died in a gunfire in Hangu on September 20.

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is to inform to the public at large that Mr. Sumit Awana and Mr. Anit Kumar had acquired House measuring 250 sq. yrds., Khasra No. 310, at Village Gejha Tilptabad, Pargna and Tehsil Dadri Distt. Gautam Budh Nagar U.P. vide Gift deed dt. 24.11.2025 executed by Mr. Azad Singh w.r.t said property. Now Mr. Sumit Awana and Mr. Anit Kumar are the undisputed owners of above said property and willing to Mortgage the above said property with CIFCL.

OR

Any person / firm / institution / company having any claim or right in respect of the said Property by way of inheritance, share, sale, agreement, lease, license, gift, possession, legal heirs, partners or encumbrance howsoever or otherwise is hereby required to intimate in writing to the undersigned within 07 days from the date of publication of this notice of his/her/their share or claim, if any, with all supporting documents at below mentioned address. After expiration of notice period, the claims, if any, of such person shall be treated null and void and also treated as waived and not binding on our client.

Ajay Kumar Giri (Advocate) H No. 26/161, Basement, Vikram Vihar, Lajpat Nagar 4, New Delhi -110024

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that my client, Seema Singh, is in process to Purchase the Ground Floor(LHS portion), Without Roof Rights, measuring 25 Sq. Yds. out of 80 Sq. Yds., comprising of Khasra No. 46, situated at Residential colony Ram Kishan Enclave in Village Khoda, Pargana Loni, Tehsil & District Ghaziabad, UP from Sikandar Saifi and Gulshan Khatoon by availing the loan from Roha Housing Finance Pvt. Ltd. That Sikandar Saifi and Gulshan Khatoon had purchased the said entire plot from Sanjay Kumar vide Notarized GPA, ATS and WILL dated 15.12.2025

All person/s having any claim against or in respect of the said Property, or any part thereof, by way of sale, exchange, mortgage (equitable/registered or otherwise), gift, trust, inheritance, family arrangement, maintenance, bequest, partnership, possession, lease, sublease, tenancy, license, lien, charge, pledge, easement or otherwise howsoever, are hereby requested to notify the same in writing to us with supporting documentary evidence at the address mentioned below within 7 days from the date hereof, failing which the claim or claims, if any, of such person or persons will be considered to have been waived and/or abandoned.

Kamal Kant Gupta (Advocate)
Unit No. FF-2, First floor, Mahaluxmi Metro Tower Sec-4, Vaishali, Gzb., U.P., Mob. 9810063351

किच्छा शुगर कम्पनी लिमिटेड, किच्छा
जनपद–ऊधम सिंह नगर (उत्तराखण्ड)
Mob. No. 9410121166/9927087957 Email: purchasekichha@gmail.com

पत्रांक: 1090/क्रय/किच्छा/2026–27 **ई–निविदा सूचना** दिनांक: 29.09.2026

पेराई सत्र 2026–27 के लिए विभिन्न स्टोर सामग्री एवं जॉब कार्य हेतु GST के अन्तर्गत पंजीकृत निर्माता / अधिकृत विक्रेता / सक्षम आपूर्तिकर्ता एवं ठेकेदारों से, उत्तराखण्ड अधि० प्राप्ति (प्रोक्योरमेन्ट) नियमावली 2025 में निहित प्रविधानों के अन्तर्गत दो निविदा प्रणाली (Two Bid System) के अन्तर्गत ई–निविदाये **www.uktenders.gov.in** पर आमंत्रित की जाती है। **www.uktenders.gov.in** पर प्राप्त निविदा ही मान्य होगी, अन्य माध्यम से प्राप्त निविदा स्वीकार्य नही होंगी। आवश्यकता होने पर नेगोशिएऐसन L–1 / H–1 (प्रथम उच्चतम / न्यूनतम) दरदाता से किया जायेगा। L–1 / H–1 से दरों के सम्बन्ध में सहमति न होने पर अन्य निविदादाताओं से वार्ता की जा सकती है। विस्तृत सूचना मिल की वेबसाइट **www.kichhasugar.com** पर उपलब्ध है। निविदा में किसी भी प्रकार के संशोधन की दशा में संशोधन का प्रकाशन केवल **www.uktenders.gov.in** एवं **www.kichhasugar.com** के माध्यम से ही प्रकाशित किया जायेगा।

अधिशासी निदेशक

kotak Kotak Mahindra Bank

NOTICE

Locker Hired by **MR. MOHIT KUMAR** having address at **E-2 INDUSTRIAL AREA MANGOL PURI PHASE 2 DELHI -110083** with **KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK** Situated at **F-19/12 BASEMENT AND GROUND FLOOR SECTOR 8 ROHINI, DELHI-110085** remains un-operated from last 9 years & 6 Months and the rent due for the last 5 years & 6 Months.

All the 3 letters earlier sent to **MR. MOHIT KUMAR** calling him to clear dues and to operate the locker has returned unserved and he is not contactable.

It is hereby informed that despite this notice, if dues not cleared and locker is not operated by **MR. MOHIT KUMAR** within 90 days from the date of this notice, break open of the said locker will be done on **December 29, 2026** at around **12p.m.**

kotak Kotak Mahindra Bank

NOTICE

Locker Hired by **MRS. PINKI SINGH** having address at **LA CASA INFRATECH PVT LTD 707 7TH FLOOR DDA BUILDING-2 DISTRICT CENTER JANAKPURI NEW DELHI 110058** with **KOTAK MAHINDRA BANK** Situated at **B1/517 A JANAK PURI DELHI - 110058** remains un-operated from last 9 years & 2 Months and the rent due for the last 9 years.

All the 3 letters earlier sent to **MRS. PINKI SINGH** calling her to clear dues and to operate the locker has returned unserved and she is not contactable.

It is hereby informed that despite this notice, if dues not cleared and locker is not operated by **MRS. PINKI SINGH** within 90 days from the date of this notice, break open of the said locker will be done on **December 29, 2026** at around **12p.m.**

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, प्रथम वृत्त,
लोक निर्माण विभाग, अल्मोड़ा
ई–मेलः sepwdalm@rediffmail.com

पत्रांक : 3811 / निविदा–01 / 2026–27 दिनांक : 28 / 09 / 2026

राष्ट्रीय प्रतिस्पर्धात्मक ई–निविदा
(E-Tendering) सूचना

मा० राज्यपाल महोदय, उत्तराखण्ड की ओर से अधीक्षण अभियन्ता, प्रथम वृत्त, लो०नि०वि०, अल्मोड़ा द्वारा **राज्य योजना के अन्तर्गत जनपद अल्मोड़ा के विधानसभा क्षेत्र अल्मोड़ा के विकासखण्ड हवालबाग में लोधिया से चौमू (चै0 4.500 से 9.500 तक 5 किमी०) मोटर मार्ग का पुनः निर्माण एवं सुधारीकरण का कार्य** की निविदा पंजीकृत **ठेकेदारों / फर्मों** से टू बिड सिस्टम (Two Bid System) के अन्तर्गत ई–टैण्डरिंग के माध्यम से ऑनलाईन आमंत्रित की जाती है।

निविदाओं के विस्तृत विवरणों / सशोधनों / शुद्धि पत्रों / आदि को ई– प्रोक्योरमेन्ट पोर्टल **http://www.uktenders.gov.in** पर दिनांक 30 / 09 / 2026 से देखा जा सकता है।

अधीक्षण अभियन्ता

NOIDA New Okhla Industrial Development Authority
Administrative Building, Sector-96, Noida, G.B. Nagar (U.P.)
Website : www.noidaauthorityonline.in

E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tenders are invited from firms/contractors registered with UPLC Lucknow for the following jobs against which bids can be uploaded and same shall be opened/downloaded as per schedule mentioned. The details and conditions of all tenders are available on NOIDA Authority's official website: **www.noidaauthorityonline.in** & **https://etender.up.nic.in**. Please ensure to see these websites for any changes/ amendments & corrigendum etc.

(A)

1. **41/S.M.-Jal-III/E.T./2026-27**, D/o Village (Water line Repair, Repairing Sluice Valve (flushing), Repairing of Chamber etc. related work Village-Agahpur & 5% Abadi Barolla), Noida. (AMC for Two Year). Cost Rs. 44.01 Lac
2. **42/S.M.-Jal-III/E.T./2026-27**, M/o W/s (Rewinding of V.T. Motor at Network Sec-39, 40, 41, 49 & Rewinding of V.T./Booster Motor, R/o Transformer & Panel at UGR/TWs in Network Sec-155, 158 & Miscellaneous Electrical Work), Noida. (AMC for Two Year). Cost Rs. 47.77 Lac
3. **43/S.M.-Jal-III/E.T./2026-27**, Village Development (P/Laying of PVC Water line in Village-Shahdra), Noida. Cost Rs. 90.47 Lacs

Which can be uploaded by date :- 13.10.2026 upto 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date :- 14.10.2026 at 11.00 AM.

(B)

1. **65/S.M.-JAL-I/E.T./2026-27**, Equipment and Machinery (Two Years Annual Repairing of Sewer Cleaning Machines in Jal Division-I, Sector-05), Noida. Cost Rs. 48.12 Lacs.
2. **74/S.M.-JAL-I/E.T./2026-27**, M/o Sewerage (Supply of Mustard Oil and Soap for Two Years in Jal Division-I, Sector-05), Noida. Cost Rs. 44.47 Lacs
3. **29/S.M.-Jal-III/E.T./2026-27**, Water Chlorination (Repairing, Operation & Maintenance of Chloromak Chlorination Plants at UGR-76, 77, 80 & 81), Noida. (AMC for Two Years). Cost Rs. 87.81 Lacs
4. **14/S.M.(JAL-O.A.)/2026-27**, O/M of Sewer line and MSPS/SPS at Expressway (Two Year Repairing of Transformer and Diesel Generator Set with other related Electrical works at IPS-5, 6, 7, 8 and MSPS-2 along N.G.N. Expressway), Noida. Cost Rs. 59.10 Lac
5. **15/S.M.-JAL-(O.A.)/2026-27**, O/M of Sewer Line and MSPS/SPS at Expressway (Two Year Repairing of Damage Rising main pressure PSC/DI/M.S. Pipe line LHS Ch-0 TO 10.00 Km. of Green belt along allied N. Gr. N. Expressway) Noida. Cost Rs. 70.89 Lac
6. **17/S.M.(JAL-O.A.)/2026-27**, M/o Sewer line and MSPS/SPS at Expressway (R/o Damaged manhole, chambers and related work in Green belt LHS along Noida Gr. Noida Expressway and MSPS-2 to STP-168) NOIDA (For Two Year). Cost Rs. 80.47 Lac
7. **18/S.M.-JAL-(O.A.)/2026-27**, M/o STP Treated Water Line in Sewerage Distric-C (Two Year Annual Repairing, Maintenance of PVC, M.S., C.I./D.I. Treated Water Lines and R/o Sluice valve, Reflex valve and C/o Chamber in network Sector-75, 76, 77, 78, 79, 112, 113, 115, 116, 117 and 118), Noida. Cost Rs. 94.74 Lacs

Which can be uploaded by date :- 06.10.2026 upto 5.00 PM. Pre-qualification shall be opened/downloaded on date :- 07.10.2026 at 11.00 AM.

Office: Sector-5 General Manager (Jal) NOIDA

CLEAN, GREEN, SAFE & SECURE NOIDA

The Pioneer Classified

CHANGE OF NAME

I, Shilpi Aggarwal W/o Vijay Kumar Aggarwal R/o CGV-111, DLF Capital Greens, Shivaji Marg, Moti Nagar, Delhi-110015 declare that name of mine has been wrongly written as Shilpi Agarwal in my minor son namely Maahir Aggarwal aged 13 years in his school records. Actual name of mine is Shilpi Aggarwal.

I, Vijay Kumar Aggarwal S/o Gangadhar Aggarwal R/o CGV-111, DLF Capital Greens, Shivaji Marg, Moti Nagar, Delhi-110015 declare that name of mine has been wrongly written as Vijay Kumar Agarwal in my minor son namely Maahir Aggarwal aged 13 years in his school records. Actual name of mine is Vijay Kumar Aggarwal.

I, Jitender Kumar Arya S/o Sh. Nath Ram R/o 339,T Huts, Ring Road, Anna Nagar, Dariyaganj Delhi 110002, Declare that my name has been wrongly written as Jitender Kumar in the school records of my daughter where as my correct name is Jitender Kumar Arya .

I, Vinita W/O Deepak Bisht R/O A 122 Top Floor, Street No. 3, Near Naina Devi Mandir, West Vinod Nagar, Mandawali Fazalpur, East Delhi, Delhi - 110092, have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Vinita Bisht.

I, hitherto known as Jitendra Kumar alias Jitendra Kumar Rai alias Jitender Kumar Rai S/o Late Maldhani Rai R/O 816, Type-2, Ground Floor, Sector-7, C.P.W.D., VTC: Pushp Vihar, PO: Malviya Nagar, South Delhi, Delhi-110017 have changed my name and shall hereafter be known as Jitender Kumar Rai.

I, Matadeen Saini, Father of- No.8378654M WO Netram Saini, R/o- Vill- Chhipari, PO-Harsora, Teh- Bansur, Dist-Alwar, Rajasthan- 301412, have changed my name from Matadeen Saini to Matadin, vide affidavit dated 29/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Nitin Kumar Yadav, S/o No. 4200741A Hav Suryanath Yadav, R/o- Vill- Chowk Bazar (Kattaiya), PO- Chowk Bazar, Dist- Maharajganj, U.P, have changed my name from Nitin Kumar Yadav to Nitin Kumar, vide affidavit dated 29/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Hanifa Begum, Mother of- JC-473934N Nb Sub Clk (SD) Mohammad Anwar, R/o-Vill- Bal Koote, Uri, Baramula, Jammu & Kashmir- 193123, have changed my name from Hanifa Begum to Haneefa Begum, vide affidavit dated 29/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Naliniprava, Mother of- No.17007485P Nk Samrat Kumar Jena, R/o- At-Benjarapur, PO- Mandari, Dist- Jajapur, Odisha-755003, have changed my name from Naliniprava to Nalini Jena, vide affidavit dated 29/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Jag Devi, Mother of No.15218292M Hav Deshraj Singh, R/o- Vill- Mahmadpur, PO- Gandhi, Teh- Amritpur, Dist- Farrukhabad, U.P., have changed my name from Jag Devi to Jagdevi, vide affidavit dated 29/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, No.14684997W CFN Khataliya Ramji Raja, R/o-Vill- Baghala, Ta- Lalpur, Dist-Jamnagar, Gujarat- 361170, have changed my daughter's name from Rishita to Khataliya Rishita Ramjibhai, vide affidavit dated 29/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Khataliya Raja Kamabhai, Father of- No.14684997W CFN Khataliya Ramji Raja, R/o- Vill- Baghala, Ta- Lalpur, Dist- Jamnagar, Gujarat-361170, have changed my name from Khataliya Raja Kamabhai to Khataliya Rajabhai, vide affidavit dated 29/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Dharam Dev Chouhan, Father of No.15205833K BHM(OPR) Sanjay Kumar Chauhan, R/o- Vill & PO-Halpur, Teh- Bansdih, Dist-Ballia, U.P.- 277213, have changed my name from Dharam Dev Chouhan to Dharmdev Chauhan, Vide affidavit dated 14/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Khatliya Ratanben, Mother of- No.14684997W CFN Khataliya Ramji Raja, R/o- Vill- Baghala, Ta- Lalpur, Dist- Jamnagar, Gujarat-361170, have changed my name from Khatliya Ratanben to Khatariya Ratanben, vide affidavit dated 29/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Chavan Ajinath, Father of Nk (GNR) Chavan Datta Ajinath, R/o- Vill & PO- Anala, Teh- Paranda, Dist-Osmanabad, Maharashtra-413505, have changed my name from Chavan Ajinath to Ajinath Rama Chavan, vide affidavit dated 15/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Rita Chouhan, W/o- No.15205833K BHM(OPR) Sanjay Kumar Chauhan, R/o-Vill & PO- Halpur, Teh-Bansdih, Dist- Ballia, U.P.-277213, have changed my name from Rita Chouhan to Rita Devi, Vide affidavit dated 14/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Dakhshri, Mother of- No.15189176Y Hav Vivek Kumar, R/o- Vill- Kurina Daulatpur, Dist- Etah, Uttar Pradesh- 207001, have changed my name from Dakhshri to Dakshari, vide affidavit dated 15/09/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

Outgoing Indian envoy meets Nepal PM Shah

SHIRISH B PRADHAN ■ Kathmandu

India's outgoing envoy to Nepal Naveen Srivastava on Tuesday discussed bilateral relations and mutual cooperation with Prime Minister Balendra Shah in a farewell meeting.

Srivastava called on Shah at his office in Kathmandu as he prepares to return to India after completing his four-year tenure, according to the Prime Minister's secretariat. "Called on Rt Hon Prime Minister Balen Shah ji (@ShahBalen) for a farewell meeting as I prepare to leave Nepal.

Thanked him and Government of Nepal for their support in progressing our bilateral partnership throughout my tenure," Indian Ambassador Srivastava posted on X after the meeting. During the meeting, the two discussed bilateral relations and matters of mutual cooperation, the PM's office said.

Prime Minister Shah said that there have always been deep and cordial relations between Nepal and India, extending special thanks to the Government of India for providing support to Nepal at the time of natural disasters, including floods and landslides, it said.

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform general public that Mr. Kunal Krishna s/o. Mr. Ram Chandra Singh has acquired Property bearing No. 17, area measuring 60 sq. yds. i.e. out of Khasra no. 476, situated in the revenue estate of village Nawada Mazra Hastsal, in the colony known as Mohan Garden Extn. Block G, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi 110059, vide by way of GPA dated 02.11.2025, ATS & Will. Now, Mr. Kunal Krishna intending sell above said property to Mr. Aman Sharma and further availing a loan on above said property from Truhome Finance Limited (earlier known as Shriram Housing Finance Ltd.) in case anyone has any objection, the same may be raised within 7 days of this publication to Mr. Ajit Sharma (Advocate), Partner of AccuLaw Source LLP, Office no. 361, 2nd Floor, Sec-1, Vaishali, Ghaziabad, U.P. Pincode 201010 or contact : +91 9560309909 (M).

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Sitharaman meets Qatar FM, discusses UPI expansion

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Doha

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman on Tuesday met Qatar's Minister of Finance Ali bin Ahmed Al Kuwari and discussed expansion of Indian UPI system in Qatar.

Meeting her Qatari counterpart on the sidelines of the AIIB annual meeting, Sitharaman also sought finalisation of the Bilateral Investment Treaty (BIT).

"The leaders discussed expansion of Indian UPI payments across Qatar; implementation of $10 billion Qatari investment commitment in India; engagement with National Infrastructure and Investment Fund @NIIFIndia; and finalisation of the Bilateral Investment Treaty," the finance ministry said on X.

They also discussed the Double Taxation Avoidance Agreement as a strengthened framework for trade, investment and tax certainty, the ministry added. Sitharaman recalled India's recent engagements with Qatar's leadership which elevated India-Qatar bilateral relations to a "strategic partnership".

Qatar's Finance Minister thanked the Indian community for being part of the success story of Qatar. He looked forward to bigger opportunities for strengthening trade, finance and investment relations between the two countries, the ministry added.


Union Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman with AIIB President and Chair of the Board of Directors Zou Jiayi on the sidelines of the AIIB 2026 annual meeting in Doha, Qatar PTI

Amazon Business logs 65% sales growth in 2026

Amazon Business, the B2B platform of e-commerce major Amazon, has so far recorded a 65 per cent year-on-year growth in sales nationally this year, driven by strong demand from MSMEs and corporate buyers, a top company official said on Tuesday.

The company is also working towards increasing the growth rate in West Bengal, where sales were up 35 per cent during the period, while bulk orders in the state surged 80 per cent, Amazon Business Director Mitranjan Bhaduri said. "At the national level, our five-year growth rate is about 40 per cent on sales. But if you look at just this year, we have seen a 65 per cent year-on-year growth rate for the year-to-date period," the company official told reporters here.

West Bengal is showing "strong growth at 35 per cent", but there is a "large upside potential" here, Bhaduri said, adding that the company was working to expand awareness among business customers.

The lion's share of Amazon Business in the State is consumption driven by businesses and not resellers, while services and manufacturing are the key sectors that lead the sales. (*PTI*)

India probes dumping by Chinese firms



India has started a probe into the alleged dumping of as many as seven products, including engineering and pharma sector goods, from China after domestic manufacturers filed complaints.

The commerce ministry's arm, the Directorate General for Trade Remedies (DGTR), is carrying out the investigations.

According to seven separate notifications of the directorate, the eight products are – Para-tert-Octyl Phenol Formaldehyde Tackifier Resin (used in the tyre and rubber industry), Penicillin G and its salts (an active pharmaceutical ingredient), 6-Amino Penicillanic Acid (a vital drug intermediate), T-Shaped Elevator/Lift Solid Guide Rails, Amoxycillin Trihydrate (used in the pharma

Govt to launch FTA awareness drive for farmers: Chouhan

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan on Tuesday said the Government will ensure farmers receive accurate and timely information about the Free Trade Agreements (FTAs) India has signed with various countries.

Speaking to reporters after a two-day national conference in the national capital, Chouhan said several international markets are accessible to Indian produce at zero import duty.

However, he said, farmers need to know which products are in demand abroad and what quality standards they must meet to export.

To bridge this gap, the Centre will launch an awareness campaign covering global market opportunities, products covered under the FTAs, export-quality requirements, and the crops, fruits and vegetables that can be cultivated for overseas markets. The Centre will also brief the states on the potential benefits of these agreements for Indian farmers and for specific regions, the minister said.


Union Agriculture Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan

Since 2014, the Narendra Modi government has signed nine FTAs, including the one between India and New Zealand in April 2026.

Meanwhile, Chouhan said on Tuesday said that there are concerns about the drought situation in Karnataka, Maharashtra, parts of Andhra Pradesh, Telangana and Rajasthan.

"The information received so far indicates concerns in Karnataka, Maharashtra, parts of Andhra Pradesh-including Rayalaseema and adjoining areas-parts of Telangana, and parts of Rajasthan. Detailed reports from the states are still awaited," minister told reporters.

The Agriculture Minister said that he would personally visit the affected states and remain in constant contact with their Governments. "The immediate objective is to ensure that agricultural fields do not remain fallow," Chouhan added.

Govt targets 600 MT steel capacity under NSP 2047

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

The Government is formulating a new steel policy aimed at boosting capacity additions to achieve 600 million tonnes of capacity by 2047 and enhancing industry competitiveness while addressing key import challenges, Steel Secretary Sandeep Poundrik said on Tuesday. The new National Steel Policy (NSP) will be put in the public domain for stakeholder feedback in about a week, the secretary said at an event here.

The NSP will set a roadmap through 2047 for the Indian steel industry to reach over 600 million tonnes of capacity by 2047, with a higher share of value-added and special steel.

The official also said an incentive scheme is being formulated with an outlay of ₹5,000 crore for MSME steel units to encourage emissions reduction in the steel sector. Speaking with reporters at the Manufacturing Confluence 2026 event organised by CII, Poundrik said the National Steel Policy will be made public in about a week for stakeholder comments.



As far as imports are concerned, the policy also includes measures to discourage cheap, substandard imports, including safeguard measures like safeguard duty, anti-dumping duty, etc, as well as to make the Indian steel industry, especially small steel players, competitive in terms of technology and price.

The Government had introduced a National Steel Policy in 2017, aimed at increasing India's steel manufacturing capability to 300 MT by 2030 along with other parametres such as consumption, ensuring raw material availability, among others. However, according to the official, the 2017 policy "needed a relook" taking current challenges and requirements.

The Steel Secretary said that since 2017, emerging priorities like artificial intelligence, machine learning and technical upgrades require greater focus. Additionally, India's global standing in the steel sector has risen with increasing consumption and capacity.

India is the only country in the world growing in capacity and consumption at such speed, he said, adding that issues like decarbonization and sustainability remain.

Mobile phone price up 16% in India in first half of 2026

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Mobile phone prices have increased by 16 per cent on average in India due to an increase in the cost of memory, with a weaker rupee adding to the woes as it made imported components more expensive for local manufacturers, market research firm Counterpoint Research said on Tuesday.

According to Counterpoint Research, the overall smartphone market is expected to decline in double digits except that of Chinese mobile phone brand OnePlus because of limited increase in price. "Smartphone prices in India rose 16 per cent on average in the first half of 2026, but OnePlus kept its own increase to 8 per cent. The hikes came as memory costs climbed, pushing India's average smartphone selling price to a record USD 318 in the second quarter of 2026," the research firm said.



Phones priced below 10,000 saw the sharpest hikes, around 32 per cent on average, because memory now makes up a much bigger share of what these devices cost to build. Shipments in the sub ₹10,000 segment fell 65 per cent YoY in the first half (H1), 2026, and the ₹10,000-INR 15,000 band, historically one of the biggest in the market, dropped 20 per cent.

Phones above ₹20,000 kept growing, helped by higher launch prices, trade-in offers and no-cost EMIs that made pricier devices easier to afford.

"AI data centres have been soaking up DRAM and NAND supply, and a weaker rupee has made imported components more expensive, leaving most brands with little choice but to raise prices through the first half of the year," the research firm said. Around 99 per cent of mobile phones sold in India are made locally.

According to the firm, most brands passed a large share of those costs on to buyers except OnePlus which took a different route.

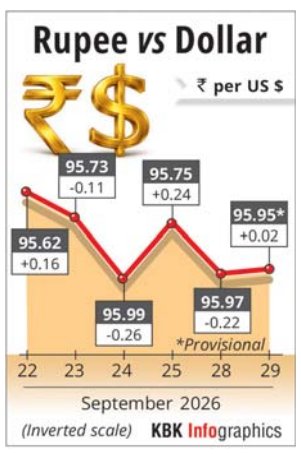
"Its (OnePlus biggest single price increase was 12 per cent, compared with 113 per cent for the rest of the industry, so the gap held not just on average but at the extremes as well.

Rupee settles on flat note, up 2 paise at 95.95 against US dollar

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Mumbai

The rupee settled on a flat note on Tuesday, just a tad over the psychologically important 96 per dollar level, driven by possible RBI intervention and a pull-back in oil prices following hopes of negotiations between the US and Iran. Forex traders said gains in the rupee were capped by US dollar demand from local importers and a stronger greenback.

Additionally, the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is likely to intervene as the rupee approaches the 96 level against the American currency, they said. At the inter-bank foreign exchange market, the rupee opened at 96.03, then lost ground and touched an intraday low of 96.15 against the American currency. At the end of Tuesday's trading session, the domestic unit was quoted at 95.95 (provisional) against the greenback, higher by 2 paise over its previous close.



On Monday, the rupee breached the 96 level for the second time in two weeks.

"We expect the rupee to trade with a negative bias on risk aversion in global markets and concerns over elevated crude oil prices. A strong dollar and surge in US Treasury yields may also pressurise the rupee.

"However, hopes that US and Iran officials are expected to talk through mediators may support the rupee at lower levels. Any positive outcome may improve global sentiments and may see a fall in crude oil prices. Traders may take cues from JOLTS job openings and consumer confidence data from the US," said Anuj Choudhary,

NITI member urges shift from sectoral to spatial planning

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

NITI Aayog member R Balasubramaniam on Tuesday called for a shift from sectoral planning to a spatial planning approach, with greater emphasis on human and social capital and the development of local economic clusters.

Balasubramaniam was speaking at a national workshop on 'Viksit Panchayat: Connecting People, Places, Resources and Opportunities' organised by NITI Aayog.

According to an official statement, the inaugural session highlighted the importance of decentralised governance, spatial planning, capacity development, digitalisation, and convergence for advancing Viksit Gram Panchayats.

Spatial Planning Approach integrates geographical, land-use, and spatial data into rural development planning to decide where infrastructure and services should be located for maximum efficiency and equity.

The deliberations focused on four key areas: decentralised and spatial planning, grassroots capacity development, spatial planning for priority sectors, and integration of spatial planning into the Gram Panchayat Development Plan (GPDP) process, it added.


NITI Aayog member R Balasubramaniam

Participants discussed the constitutional foundation of Panchayati Raj under the 73rd Constitutional Amendment and Part IX of the Constitution.

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NOTICE INVITING TENDER (NIT)

MPSEDC invites online proposals for following bid on MP Tender :-

S.No.	Tender No.	NIT
1	MPSEDC/2026/714	Request For Proposal Supply Installation and Maintenance of Hardware's & Software's

For detail scope of work, terms and conditions please refer to the respective bid document available on MP Tender Portal **(www.mptenders.gov.in)**.
M.P. Madhyam/128283/2026 **EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR**

Executive Engineer Provincial Division, P.W.D Bijnor

Letter No. 2695 / E -Tender /26-27 Dated : 24.09.2026

(Short -Term E-Tender)

1. The Executive Engineer Provincial Division, U.P.P.W.D. Bijnor on behalf of Governor of Uttar Pradesh invites the percentage rate bids online from the eligible and approved Contractors registered in Building Works with UP PWD, class A,B,C,D The Bidder may submit bids for any or all of the works. Bidders are advised to note the minimum qualification criteria specified in Clause 4 of the Instructions to Bidders to qualify for the award of the contract.
2.

Sl. No	District	Name of Work	Estimated cost (Rs. In Lakhs)	Bid Security (Rs. In Lakhs)	Cost of Bid Document	Time of Completion	Address of Executive Engineer of the Executive the work	Address of Superintending Engineer	Address of Chief Engineer
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1	Bijnor	Roof Repair of District Megistrate, Bijnor awas in Bijnor.	4.40	0.44	854/- (Tender Cost be accepted only by Net banking)	02 Months	Provincial Division, P.W.D. Bijnor	Rampur Circle P.W.D Rampur	Chief Engineer Moradabad Zonc P.W.D. Moradabad

- The Rate adopted in the BOQ include all Other taxes but excluding GST.
- Tender cost should be deposited online through Net Banking as per Column No. 5 & 6 in the table.

Bids must be downloaded online from 10:00 AM on date 05.10.2026 to 12:00 PM on dated 10.10.2026 and the technical bids will be opened online on date 10.10.2026 at 12:30 PM in Office of Executive Engineer Provincial Division PWD Bijnor and Financial bids of the qualified bidders will be opened on date & time as notified. According to the provisions of Government Order no. 1/2018/3070/78-2-2018/42 IT/2017 (22) Date 03-01-2018 after opening of the technical and financial bids, the qualified bidder has to submit original documents personally in department/ office. In the event of non submission of original documents by the bidder, the appropriate action will be taken in accordance with the provisions of G.O.

All terms & conditions can be seen on website http:/etender.up.nic.in

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Provincial Division, PWD, Bijnor
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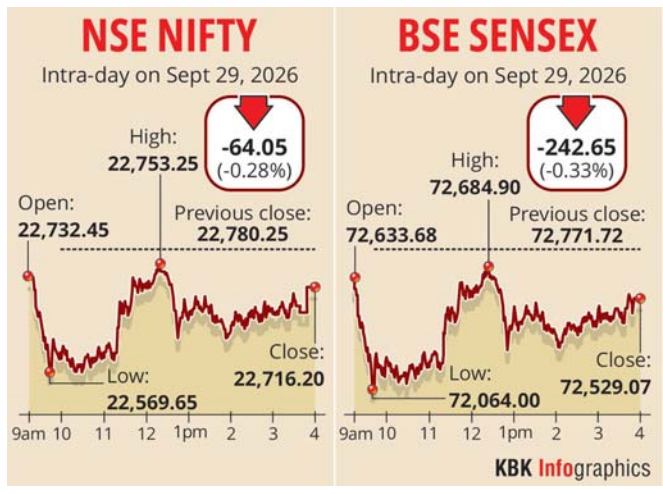
Markets fall for second day, FPI outflows weigh in

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Mumbai

Equity benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty ended lower for the second day on Tuesday as elevated crude oil prices, uncertainty over the Iran war peace deal, higher US Treasury yields and foreign fund outflows weighed on investor sentiment.

The 30-share BSE Sensex dropped 242.65 points, or 0.33 per cent, to settle at 72,529.07. During the day, it slumped 707.72 points, or 0.97 per cent, to 72,064.

The 50-share NSE Nifty declined 64.05 points, or 0.28 per cent, to end at 22,716.20. From the 30 Sensex firms, Titan, HCL Tech, Tata Consultancy Services, UltraTech Cement, Hindustan Unilever and Tech Mahindra were among the major laggards.



Adani Ports, Sun Pharma, Tata Steel and Kotak Mahindra Bank were among the winners. Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, dipped 0.09 per cent to $105.1 per barrel. Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) offloaded equities worth `5,353.22 crore on Monday, according to exchange data.

"Domestic equities continue to face correction-led headwinds amid volatile crude prices, US Treasury yields hovering near two-decade highs, and persistent FII outflows exerting pressure on the rupee. Adding to the pressure, the unprecedented pace of IPO fundraising is absorbing incremental liquidity. Investor risk appetite remains subdued against a hawkish global backdrop amid rising odds of additional rate hikes later in the year," Vinod Nair, Head of Research, Geojit Investments Ltd, said. According to Ajit Mishra, SVP — research, Religare Broking, markets also witnessed selling pressure amid the monthly F&O expiry.

"Markets remained under selling pressure on the monthly expiry day, extending the ongoing corrective trend. After a weak opening, the benchmark indices remained under pressure through most of the session and traded near their lowest levels in nearly six months, before recovering marginally from the lows. Global concerns continued to weigh on sentiment, with crude prices remaining elevated, the US 10-year Treasury yield staying firm," Mishra said.

The BSE MidCap Select index dropped 0.99 per cent, while the SmallCap Select index was up 0.25 per cent.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

YouTube contributes over ₹18,000 cr to GDP: Report

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Video-sharing platform YouTube's creative ecosystem contributed over ₹18,000 crore to India's Gross Domestic Product (GDP) and supported over 9.6 lakh full-time equivalent jobs in the country in 2025, according to a report by Oxford Economics.

The findings point to a significant shift in India's digital creator landscape, where independent content creators are increasingly evolving into full-fledged media enterprises, driving employment and local economic activity across both metropolitan centres and smaller towns.

According to the report, the number of YouTube channels in India generating six figures or more in revenue (INR) rose by over 30 per cent year-on-year. Furthermore, over 18,000 Indian channels have crossed the threshold of one million subscribers.

The report noted that 73 per cent of creators who monetise content on YouTube consider the platform to be their primary source of income.

Beyond direct earnings, monetising creators supported more than 3 lakh apprentices over the past year. Creative clusters have sprung up in non-metro hubs such as Jaipur, Lucknow and Kochi, generating local demand for video editors, camera operators and scriptwriters.

The platform highlighted that hyper-local and regional-language content is gaining significant traction internationally, with over 15 per cent of watch time on content produced by Indian channels coming from viewers outside the country.

Additionally, 81 per cent of media companies with a presence on the platform said that YouTube assisted them in reaching global audiences.

Over 160 million hours of content were uploaded by Indian channels in the past year, the report said.

YouTube said it is collaborating with the Ministry of Information & Broadcasting and the Indian Institute of Creative Technologies (IICT) to advance national digital skilling under the "Create with AI" initiative. It is also partnering with the Ministry of Culture to preserve heritage and promote traditional folk and tribal music on the global stage.

On the product front, the company is rolling out artificial intelligence-driven production tools, including conversational AI editing for Shorts and agentic channel management features in Ask Studio.

To address digital authenticity, the platform said it is introducing 'AI Likeness Detection' alongside clear labels and disclosures for synthetic content.

TRAI directs telcos to act against spam callers

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Telecom operators have been mandated to take action against pesky callers or spammers flagged by their AI-based caller ID system — even without the need for consumers filing complaints, a Trai notification has said.

The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (Trai) has notified Telecom Commercial Communica-tions Customer Preference (Third Amendment) Regulations, 2026 (05 of 2026), which mandates telecom operators to restart KYC of senders identified as spammer and take action against violators by disconnecting phone connection and even filing complaint against it with law enforcement agencies.

According to the notification published on Monday, every telecom operator receiving an incoming call flagged as "suspected spam" by its artificial intelligence or machine learning enabled system will have to share details of such calls with telecom operators (originating access providers) from whose network the call has originated within two hours of such identification.

The originating access providers (OAP) shall, within one business day of the receipt of the flagged calls, identify unique KYC identifiers of the sender associated with such calls and share those details with other telecom operators.

All telecom operators within one day will need to check within their system if there are other connections within their network linked to the suspected spammer in the last 10 days.

"If it is found that five or more CLIs (called line identification) of the Sender have been so identified within the last ten days, all the OAPs concerned shall take action against the Sender," the notification said.

In case of the first violation triggered using AI system, outgoing services of all telecom resources, including allotted to the sender shall be barred by all the telecom operators for a period of 15 days, irrespective of whether those telecom resources were actually used or not in making such communications.

"For subsequent instances of violations, - (i) all telecom resources, including PRI/SIP trunks, SIMs etc. of the Sender shall be disconnected by all the Access Providers for one year, irrespective of whether those telecom resources were actually used or not in making such communications," the notification said.

The telecom operators or the OAP will have to put the sender under the blacklist category during the period of one year and no new telecom resources shall be provided by any telecom operator to the violator.

However, the violator will still be provided with one telephone number with outgoing services barred. The telephone connection will be allowed to connect with notified emergency outgoing services.

The notification bars all call management applications or similar services like Truecaller from tagging, blocking or filter incoming calls originating from any number series designated by the authority like those starting with 1600 or the central government for commercial and government communication.

Consumers will have the freedom to filter or block any calls on their own devices, at their personal discretion for their own purpose. The amended rule allows Terminating Access Provider (TAP) to charge the OAP up to Rs 0.05 (five paisa only) per minute (on per minute pulse basis), for A2P calls.

Under the amended rule, subscribers opting to block telemarketing calls from all categories will need to text BLOCK PROMO code to 1909.

"BLOCK PROMO option shall block only promotional types of Commercial Communications for all categories of content, mode, time band and day types but shall not block transaction and service type of Commercial Communications and Government Communications," the notification said.

HDFC Flexi Cap Fund delivers 18.37% CAGR since inception; ₹10,000 monthly SIP grows to ₹22.96 cr

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Mumbai



HDFC Flexi Cap Fund has delivered a CAGR of 18.37 per cent since its inception, with a ₹10,000 monthly SIP made on the first business day of every month growing to approximately ₹22.96 crore as of August 31, 2026, according to HDFC Asset Management Company Limited (HDFC AMC).

HDFC AMC, the investment manager of HDFC Mutual Fund (HDFC MF) and one of India's leading mutual fund houses, highlighted the long-term wealth-creation journey of the HDFC Flexi Cap Fund, launched on January 1, 1995.

The fund has completed more than three decades of navigating market cycles and investing across large-cap, mid-cap and small-cap stocks.

A ₹1 lakh investment in the fund at inception would have grown to approximately ₹2 crore, compared with approximately ₹37.71 lakh for the NIFTY 500 Index (TRI).

As of August 31, 2026, the fund delivered a CAGR of 18.37 per cent since inception and 17.69 per cent over five years.

The fund follows a disciplined investment approach centred on valuation discipline, quality and diversification, while retaining the flexibility to identify opportunities across market capitalisations. Its investment framework evaluates valuations holistically and focuses on businesses with strong fundamentals, quality management and sustainable competitive advantages.

The market-cap agnostic approach enables the portfolio to adapt to changing market conditions and identify relative opportunities across large-cap, mid-cap and small-cap segments.

Commenting on the fund's performance, Navneet Munot, Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer, HDFC Asset Management Company Limited, said, "HDFC Flexi Cap Fund's track record spans more than three decades and several market cycles. The fund has a time-tested philosophy rooted in research, aimed at long-term wealth creation. We are grateful to every investor and distribution partner who has been with us on this journey, and we look forward to continuing it together for many years to come."

According to HDFC AMC, the fund has navigated multiple market cycles and outperformed the NIFTY 500 Index (TRI) in 21 of 31 calendar years.

Its rolling return analysis also highlights the consistency of its long-term performance, with the fund delivering more than 10 per cent CAGR in 96 per cent of instances for investment periods exceeding 10 years. The analysis is based on daily rolling returns since inception through August 31, 2026.

Amit Ganatra currently manages the HDFC Flexi Cap Fund and has managed the scheme since February 1, 2026.

RGCIRC holds BMT conclave 2026, focus on nursing care and infection control

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Rajiv Gandhi Cancer Institute & Research Centre (RGCIRC) organised BMT Conclave 2026, titled "Guarding the Graft: Nursing Care and Infection Control in BMT," on September 26, bringing together specialists, nurses and healthcare professionals to discuss the clinical, nursing, infection-control and operational aspects of bone marrow transplantation.

Sessions covered the physical set-up of a BMT unit, pre-transplant preparation, conditioning therapy, donor management, stem cell collection, nursing responsibilities, post-transplant complications and newer approaches such as CAR-T cell therapy.

The programme opened with a session on "BMT Unit Physical Set-up: Building an Infection-Safe Environment," chaired by Dr Narendra Agrawal, Senior Consultant and Unit Head, Hemato Oncology and BMT, RGCIRC. Agrawal said bone marrow transplantation is among the most complex treatment pathways in oncology and hematology, with success depending on meticulous infection control, continuous monitoring and coordinated nursing care alongside the transplant procedure itself.

Afternoon sessions covered post-BMT management in paediatric patients, focusing on complications and nursing interventions, followed by an overview of CAR-T cell therapy.

Dr Dinesh Bhurani, Director, Department of Haemato-Oncology and Bone Marrow Transplant, RGCIRC, said BMT requires seamless coordination across multiple disciplines, and platforms like the conclave help healthcare professionals share experiences and advance transplant care standards.

A key highlight was the panel discussion "Unique Complexities in BMTU: Tracking Emotional, Clinical and Operational Challenges," moderated by Col Madhumita Dhall, Director of Nursing, RGCIRC, with experts from hemato-oncology, microbiology, infection control and BMT nursing. Dhall said BMT nursing demands technical competence, discipline, empathy and constant vigilance, with nurses often remaining closest to patients throughout the transplant journey.

NALCO contemplating new 0.5m tonne aluminium smelter in Andhra Pradesh

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Kolkata



BP Singh, CMD

State-owned National Aluminium Company Ltd (NALCO) is contemplating a new 0.5 million tonne smelter in Andhra Pradesh to convert all of its expanded alumina capacity into aluminium, and will not export alumina after the expansion, its CMD BP Singh said.

NALCO's alumina production capacity is currently 2.1 million tonnes per annum and will go up to 3.1 million tonnes with the commissioning of its new refinery by FY28.

The company presently exports about 0.13 million tonnes of alumina, but with the vision of the ministry, the aluminium major aims to produce value-added aluminium from its entire alumina capacity.

Singh, speaking on the sidelines of a roadshow for Angul Aluminium industrial park, said that with the Andhra Pradesh smelter, NALCO can use 100 per cent of the expanded alumina capacity of 3.1 million tonnes for its own aluminium production.

The company is targeting aluminium capacity of about 1.5 million tonnes.

"Land is not yet visible. We are holding talks with the state government. Once that comes, it will be announced," he said.

NALCO's current smelter capacity is 0.46 million tonnes per annum. In September this year, the company signed a technology licensing agreement with the UAE's Emirates Global Aluminium (EGA) to use its DX+ Ultra smelting technology for a 0.5 million tonne per annum brownfield expansion at Angul in Odisha.

The company has announced a capital expenditure of ₹25,000 crore till 2031. The Andhra Pradesh project would be over and above this outlay, Singh said.

A 0.5 million tonne smelter requires an investment of about ₹18,000 crore and 1,000 MW of power, which would cost another ₹11,000 crore, he said.

NALCO has also engaged a consultant to work out a product strategy, including for aerospace and other specialised applications, Singh said.

CBI nabs Nirav Modi's aide Sandeep Mistry after deportation from UAE

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
New Delhi


Sandeep Mistry

The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) arrested Sandeep Mistry, a close associate of fugitive diamond merchant Nirav Modi, in Mumbai on Tuesday after extraditing him from the United Arab Emirates. This arrest is a major development in the ongoing Punjab National Bank fraud case, one of India's biggest banking scandals.

Mistry was extradited on Monday and brought before a special CBI court the next day. The agency did not ask for police custody, so the court sent him to judicial custody until October 6. This action followed a non-bailable warrant issued by a special court in November 2025.

Mistry was the director of Fancy Creations Ltd, a Hong Kong company connected to Nirav Modi. Investigators say he was actively involved in a scheme that cheated Punjab National Bank out of nearly ₹6,498.20 crore. The larger fraud, which involved fake Letters of Undertaking from PNB's Brady House branch in Mumbai, is estimated at over $2 billion, or more than ₹13,000 crore.

The CBI says Mistry worked closely with Nirav Modi and others accused in the case. The agency also claims that Mistry, along with Modi's brother Nehal and another wanted person, threatened employees who acted as dummy directors for Modi's companies in Dubai. After the case was filed in India, these employees were reportedly forced to leave Dubai and move to Cairo because they feared arrest. The accused are also said to have destroyed their phones to remove evidence.

The CBI and the Enforcement Directorate have investigated Nirav Modi, his uncle Mehul Choksi, and several others since 2018. The CBI is looking into the bank fraud, while the ED is investigating related money-laundering charges. The accused are believed to have worked with bank officials to get fake LoUs that allowed them to secure large overseas loans.

The PNB case was first discovered in early 2018 when the bank found that LoUs had been issued without proper collateral or paperwork. These documents let Modi's companies get buyer's credit from Indian banks' overseas branches. When the loans went unpaid, PNB had to cover the losses. The size of the losses and the involvement of well-connected business people made this a high-profile case that has continued for years, with some accused still outside India.

Mistry's extradition from the UAE and his arrest in Mumbai are important steps in bringing alleged co-conspirators to Indian courts. While he is in judicial custody until early October, investigators will have time to question him about Fancy Creations Ltd, the circulation of money, and the reported threats to dummy directors.

This case continues to show weaknesses in trade-finance tools and the difficulties of tracking down accused people in other countries. While Nirav Modi and Mehul Choksi remain outside India, bringing back an associate like Mistry helps the CBI gather more evidence and testimony that could strengthen the prosecution.

IDFC First Bank case: ED raids jewellers in Haryana, Punjab

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Chandigarh



The Enforcement Directorate on Tuesday conducted searches against some jewellery shops in Haryana and Punjab as part of its money laundering investigation into the alleged embezzlement of ₹645 crore from bank accounts linked to the Haryana government and maintained with the IDFC First Bank, officials said.

They said about 14 premises in Chandigarh, Mohali (Punjab) and Panchkula (Haryana) were covered during the raids.

The central agency said the "embezzled" public funds were routed and layered through the bank accounts of various jewellers and projected as business transactions.

These transactions were allegedly carried out in connivance with the accused persons to conceal and project the proceeds of crime as legitimate funds, ED officials said.

The proceeds of crime are also alleged to have been laundered by jewellers which allegedly reached accused IAS officers and other government servants involved in the IDFC First Bank "fraud", they said.

The CBI recently filed its third charge sheet in this case before a Panchkula court and named six Haryana-cadre IAS officers and other government servants in connection with the bank fraud case.

The ED had arrested four persons, filed a charge sheet against 14 entities and attached assets worth ₹211 crore as part of this investigation.

The money laundering case stems from an FIR registered by the Haryana State Vigilance and Anti-Corruption Bureau.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | WEDNESDAY | SEPTEMBER 30, 2026

BRIEFLY

Tough draws await Sujeet, Antim, Aman in Asian Games



Sujeet Kalkal's red-hot form, Antim Panghal's bid to reclaim the spotlight and Olympic bronze medallist Aman Sehrawat's return to the Asian Games will headline India's wrestling campaign here, with all three facing challenging draws in their quest for a continental gold.

The wrestling programme will be conducted in a one-day format for each weight category, meaning the qualification rounds, semifinals and medal bouts will all be held on the same day.

Among the biggest talking points is Sujeet's 65kg campaign with the 23-year-old arriving in Japan as India's most in-form freestyle wrestler.

The U-23 world champion has enjoyed a breakthrough 2026, winning the Asian Championships and collecting gold at the Zagreb Open and Muhamet Malo Ranking Series before heading to the Asian Games. *(PTI)*

Indian golfers face star-studded field as Asiad campaign begins



India's six-member golf contingent, led by 2023 silver medallist Aditi Ashok, will have its task cut out against a star-studded field when it begins its Asian Games campaign here on Wednesday.

With 66 men and 45 women in the field, players will not have to worry about making cuts as they often do on the professional circuit and can go all out. With two of the three best scores counting towards the team medals, India will fancy its chances with a squad that has considerable depth.

The Indian team is fairly experienced, with Yuvraj Sandhu, Veer Ahlawat and Saptak Talwar making up the men's trio. In the women's section, the team will be led by the only Indian woman to have won an Asian Games medal, Aditi, who will have Diksha Dagar and Pranavi Urs for company.

This is Aditi's third Asian Games, having also featured in the 2014 and 2023 editions, while Diksha was part of the team in 2018 and Pranavi played at the 2023 Games. *(PTI)*

India wins first-ever women's trap gold at Asiad

AJAI MASAND
Nagoya

A determined Neeru Dhanda became the first Indian woman to claim an individual trap shooting gold at the Asian Games, battling relentless rain and plunging temperatures to smash the continental record against a formidable field after guiding the country to a team silver here on Tuesday.

The 26-year-old from Haryana's Jind ended a 48-year wait for the nation's second men's or women's individual trap gold at the continental showpiece after combining with Aashima Ahlawat and Manisha Keer for the team silver in the same event earlier in the day.

The 5'2" Naib Subedar in the Indian Army produced a stunning display of composure and precision, shooting 28 out of 30 targets in the women's trap final to finish ahead of China's Sun Yunong (26) and Kuwait's Abdulmalik Hajar (21). Neeru could add more to her tally when she teams up with Kynan Chenai in the trap mixed team competition on Wednesday.

On a rain-soaked range where visibility was poor, making it extremely difficult to track the flying clay targets, Neeru refused to buckle, delivering when it mattered most to script a landmark moment for Indian shooting.

Her gold is significant for more than one reason.

It is the first ever Asian Games individual medal in women's trap for India and also the country's first individual shooting gold at the ongoing Games.

Indian rifle and pistol shooters endured a difficult campaign, with the 10m air pistol mixed team gold won by Suruchi Inder Singh and Kamaljeet being the best show before Neeru's breakthrough.

India's first Asian Games trap gold came through Randhir Singh in the men's event at Bangkok in 1978. It took another 32 years for the country to win gold in the discipline, with double-trap shooter Ronjan Sodhi achieving the feat at the 2010 Guangzhou Games.



India's Neeru Dhanda holds the event mascot during the victory ceremony for the women's trap shooting individual event at the 20th Asian Games 2026, in Nagoya, Japan on Tuesday *PTI*

Neeru has now added another chapter to that legacy, while opening an entirely new one for Indian women in shotgun shooting. The triumph was all the more remarkable given that Neeru was battling a serious health scare barely 10 days before the competition.

Down with a severe bout of flu, possibly H1N1, she was hospitalised in Bhopal and unable to eat for five days. Her participation and form were uncertain, but her personal coach, former international shooter and Commonwealth Games gold-medallist Mansher Singh, urged her to put the illness behind her and go all out.

"Mansher sir only told me to forget what has happened and focus on the target, which I did," Neeru said after her victory.

That advice proved pivotal as the Jind-born shooter produced a performance that belied her recent ordeal. Her early journey included a move to the Madhya Pradesh Shooting Academy in 2017 after her cousin and 2018 Asian Games silver-winning men's trap practitioner Lakshay Sheoran encouraged her to take up the sport.

In the finals on Tuesday, Neeru signalled her intent by finishing the four opening rounds of qualification with a commanding 95 out of 100, taking the sole lead into the final day.

Despite the worsening weather, she held her nerve in the fifth and final round, shooting 23 to finish with 118, level with Qatar's Bassil Ray, and secure her place in the eight-shooter final.

The qualification scores also contributed to the team event, in which Neeru combined with Aashima Ahlawat and Manisha Keer to win silver. Neeru shot 118, Aashima managed 106 and Manisha scored 104, taking India's aggregate to 328. China claimed gold with 346, while Kuwait secured bronze with 325. In the final, Neeru was relentless from the outset. As the field began to thin after the opening 10 targets, with the first eliminations bringing the contest into sharper focus, she maintained her rhythm and refused to let the weather dictate her performance.

One after another, her rivals faltered in the difficult conditions, but Neeru continued to find the targets with remarkable consistency. Heading into the final five shots, she held a two-point advantage over China's Sun Yunong, who eventually settled for silver. A brief interruption, during which Neeru was shown a yellow card in a decision that was contested before she was given the benefit, threatened to disrupt her concentration. *(PTI)*

India wins first athletics gold at Asiad

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nagoya



India?s Kiran, Prachi, Poovama Machettira, and Vithya Ramraj pose for photographs after winning gold medal in the women's 4 x 400 relay final in the ongoing Asian Games 2026, in Nagoya, Japan on Tuesday *PTI*

The Indian quartet of Kiran Pahal, Poovamma Machettira, Prachi, Vithya Ramraj produced an exceptional performance to claim the gold medal in the women's 4x400m relay at the 2026 Asian Games here on Tuesday.

The Indian team won the top prize with a time of 3:29.69 minutes, giving the country its first gold medal in track and field events at the ongoing games. Bahrain and China finished second and third respectively. Earlier, Gurindervir Singh, Animesh Kujur, Sneha Sathyanarayana and Harita Bhadra won the bronze medal in the 4x100m mixed relay final after clocking a season best time of 41.06 seconds.

India's Pooja Singh fared well below her personal best with a leap of 1.84 metre but that was enough to clinch a bronze medal in women's high jump. This was after India's Gulveer Singh continued his spectacular run of form at the ongoing games by winning a bronze medal in men's 5000m with a time of 13:32.75, completing a hat-trick of podium finishes in the Japanese city.

This is Gulveer's third podium finishes at the 2026 games, having won silver medals in men's 1500m and 10000m events earlier in the multisport extravaganza. Gulveer thus became the second Indian man and fourth from the country to win three medals in track and field events in a single edition of the continental games. Before Gulveer, Lavy Pinto, PT Usha and KM Beenamol (Busan 2002, 3 medals) had achieved a similar feat. After Gulveer, the Indian quartet ended third with a time of 41.06 in 4x400m mixed relay, having finished second behind China in the heats. China won the gold with a time of 40.78 seconds, while Thailand took silver after finishing in 40.87 seconds.

India win bronze in 4x100 mixed relay, Gulveer completes hat-trick



Gurindervir Singh, Animesh Kujur, Harita Bhadra and Sneha Sathyanarayana Shanuvalli pose for photographs after winning bronze medal in 4 x 100 relay mixed final in Asian Games 2026, in Nagoya *PTI*

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA
Nagoya

The Indian quartet of Gurindervir Singh, Animesh Kujur, Sneha Sathyanarayana and Harita Bhadra won the bronze medal in the 4x100m mixed relay final after clocking a season best time of 41.06 seconds at the 2026 Asian Games here on Tuesday.

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DAILY SUDOKU

							6	2
2		8		9	7			
		3		1				
	2		4					9
7			5		3			6
5					8		7	
				5		7		
			7	3		9		4
1	3							

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★☆☆☆

HOW TO SOLVE IT

Sudoku is a logic puzzle where you fill a 9×9 grid so that numbers 1 to 9 appear once in every row, column, and 3×3 box, using elimination and logical deduction- no maths involved.



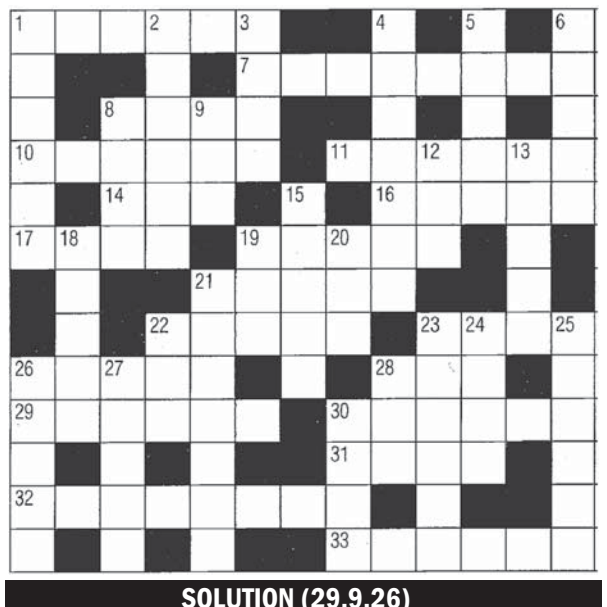
No.SS2257 Distribution: www.knightfeatures.com

SOLUTION (29.9.26)

3	8	9	6	7	5	4	1	2
1	7	5	4	2	3	8	9	6
4	6	2	9	8	1	3	5	7
6	4	7	1	3	9	2	8	5
9	2	3	8	5	6	7	4	1
5	1	8	2	4	7	6	3	9
2	9	6	3	1	8	5	7	4
7	3	4	5	9	2	1	6	8
8	5	1	7	6	4	9	2	3

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DOUBLE CROSSWORD
WEDNESDAY | SEPTEMBER 30, 2026



ACROSS

1 She's maybe in Madrid for the wrong reason (6)
7 How to go on a spree? (8)
8 River nominally female (4)
10 One's personal part ribbed all round (6)
11 Waste a lot, getting Susie upset (6)
14 Would one make an exemplary sleeper? (3)
16 Contests without deception? (5)
17 The horse galloped around for nothing (4)
19 Masterly trap for an artist! (5)
21 Having stuffed oneself with dates? (5)
22 Thick part of a wooden seat (5)
23 In which people parrot their opinions? (4)
26 Vessel bachelors get in? (5)
28 Time share, nominally? (3)
29 Seem a very quiet listener (6)
30 Imitations in circulation? (6)
31 One you knit soundly (4)
32 Musical producer (8)
33 As worn when sozzled at the Saracen's Head (6)

DOWN

1 The Irish one, perhaps, posing a puzzle? (6)
2 Honour a fellow as king (6)
3 Soccer club's Greek hero (4)
4 Loudly urged to reveal insight? (7)
5 Saint given a new suit at the civic centre (5)
6 They tread on the road (5)
8 Look Al up, girl! (4)
9 Continually complain in the rain again (3)
12 All you need is to be determined (3)
13 A picture of placidity (5)
15 Person to blame for a pasty mess (5)
18 Fluently available (2,3)
19 His wife may bring endless woe to him (3)
20 French born? (3)
21 Politician taking money to fiddle a rota (7)
22 Enough dieting to make you fade away? (3)
23 Producing hot music? (6)
24 Neglect to put it on order (4)
25 In a girl's embrace, he flails! (6)
26 Kind of loaf that means a lot (5)
27 Frothy letter that's turned up for me (5)
28 To a new leader, it can be a burden (3)
30 Short cut round the far end (4)

SOLUTION (29.9.26)

ACROSS
1, B-L-abs
6, Jinks
9, Optimum
10, Snowy
11, Paper
12,Mini-M
13, Tow-er-ed
15, Men
17, One-R
18, Re-tire
19, Si-tar
20,Gretna
22, Fine
24, Sir
25, Lo-GI-cal
26, D-rain
27, Roy-Al
28,Osier
29, Weed out
30, Grand
31, Ta-nya

DOWN
2, London
3, Bowler
4, S-py
5, LIVID
6, Jupiter
7, I'm-AM
8, Keeper
12, Media
13, Tongs
14, Weser
15, Mimi-c
16, New-el
18, Rayon
19, Snarled
21, Rigour
22, F-I-esta
23, Nam-Ely
25,Linda
26, Dawn
28, Out

Boxing: Ankush, Parveen punch their way to Asiad finals, Narender settles for bronze

PHILEM DIPAK SINGH
Nishio (Japan)



Parveen Hooda FILE PHOTO

Ankush Panghal ended India's eight-year wait for a male Asian Games boxing finalist while Parveen Hooda stormed into the 65kg gold-medal bout with a commanding victory here on Tuesday as Narender Berwal signed off with a bronze after bowing out in the +90kg semi-finals. Parveen defeated China's Li Shu 5-0 before Ankush produced a stirring comeback to out-punch reigning 75kg world champion Uzbekistan's Fazliddin Erkinboev 4-1 and book his place in the 80kg summit clash.

Narender, however, went down 0-5 to reigning super-heavyweight world champion Aibek Oralbay of Kazakhstan in the last-four stage.

The bronze is Narender's second at the Asian Games after he also finished on the podium in Hangzhou in 2023.

Ankush became the first Indian male boxer in eight years to reach an Asian Games final, with Amit Panghal, who won the 49kg title in 2018, the last to achieve the feat.

The Commonwealth Games gold medallist showed remarkable resilience against Erkinboev, recovering from slow start to dominate final round and secure victory. *(PTI)*

Fariba Hashimi becomes Afghanistan's first Asiad medallist in women's cycling

HARDIK SHARMA
New Delhi



When Fariba Hashimi's father first saw her attempting to ride a bicycle, his immediate fear for her was not injury from a fall. It was what might happen to her if somebody else got a whiff of it in the orthodox Afghan society.

But the stoic father decided her dreams were bigger than his fears and last week, she became the first Afghan woman to medal in an Asian Games cycling event by clinching the road race silver in Aichi-Nagoya. It also made Hashimi her country's first female Asian Games medallist since 2002.

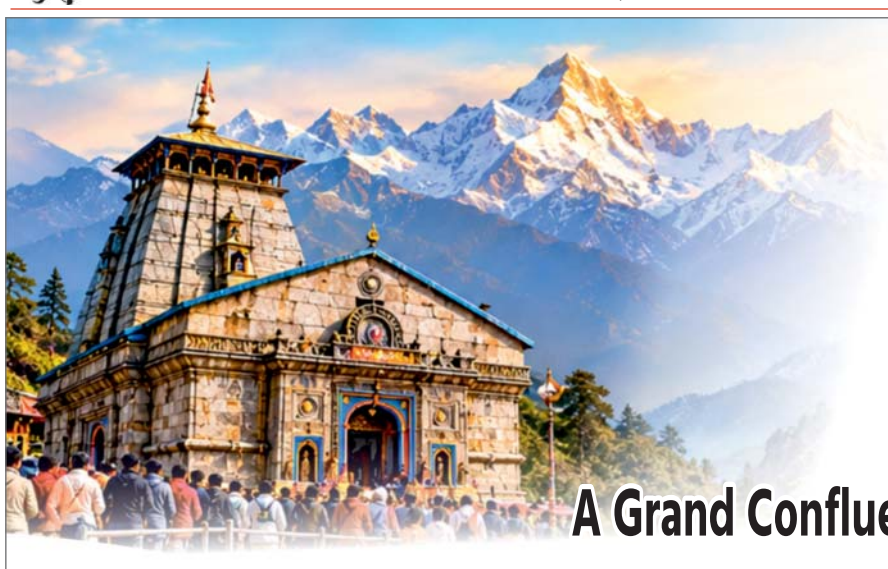
For Hashimi, the medal around her neck was not merely a reward for racing 2 hours and 50 minutes on a course. It was a reminder of the stones thrown at her, the men's clothes she wore to train, the fear her father carried every time she rode outside and the country she was forced to leave behind when the Taliban returned to power in 2021.

"Fariba doesn't want to go alone. Fariba wants to have other Faribas from the country," Hashimi, who is now based in Italy, told PTI in an interview.

"I'm really hoping someone can come from inside the country outside, and that will be one of my big dreams in Los Angeles Olympics. Of course, I keep training a lot and I'm doing my best to perform well and to get a qualification for Los Angeles," the 23-year-old said.

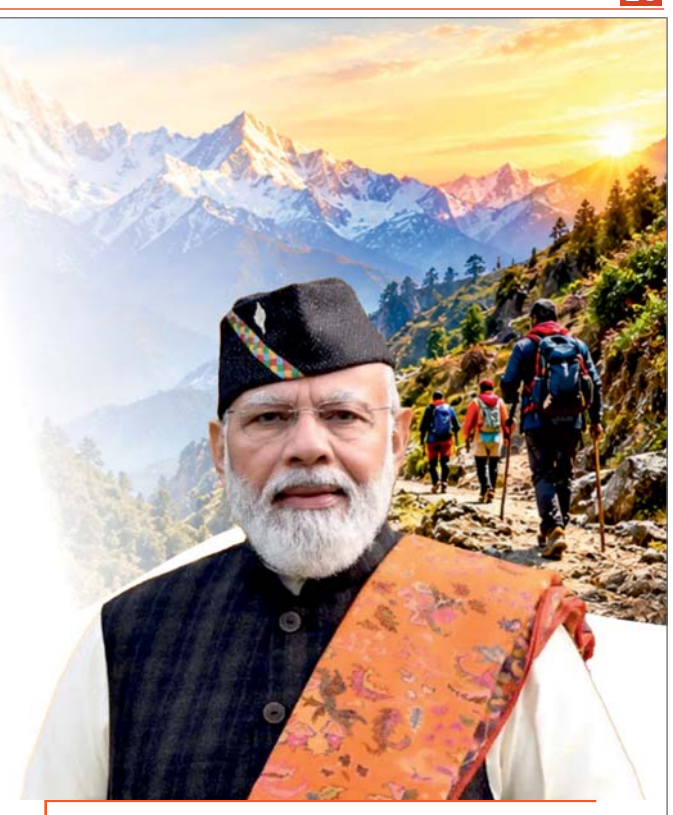
The achievement came five years after she fled Afghanistan following the Taliban's return to power and amid restrictions that have severely curtailed women's rights and opportunities. But Hashimi's cycling story began long before she reached Italy, and at a time when simply riding a bicycle in her home country could put her in harm's way.

"When I was young, I never touched a bike, I never rode a bike," she recalled, saying she heard about a women's cycling race after her sister came across it on social media. *(PTI)*



DEVBHOOMI Uttarakhand

Sewa | Sushasan | Samarpan



A Grand Confluence of Faith, Culture & Spiritual Consciousness



"Uttarakhand holds a special place on the tourism map, owing to its exceptionally rich culture and heritage. Tourism plays a vital role in strengthening the state's economy. Our tourist destinations are symbols of our historical and cultural civilizations, as well as our identity. Uttarakhand is a center of faith and spiritual experiences. To link tourism with employment, plans for developing new tourist destinations are being implemented here. Uttarakhand has always conveyed the message of 'Atithi Devo Bhava' to the nation and the world. The state is ready to welcome its guests."

Pushkar Singh Dhami
Chief Minister, Uttarakhand





The resonant chants of "Har Har Gange" echoing from Har Ki Pauri, the sacred wisdom of revered saints, the unwavering faith of devotees, and the pristine flow of Mother Ganga—Haridwar Kumbh is not merely a religious gathering, but a magnificent celebration of India's timeless Sanatan culture and spiritual heritage.

The Haridwar Kumbh Mela 2027 will commence on 14 January 2027 (Makar Sankranti) and conclude on 20 April 2027 (Chaitra Purnima). The sacred land of Haridwar is once again preparing to welcome millions of pilgrims from across India and around the world. This monumental festival offers a rare opportunity to collectively experience devotion, spiritual discipline, selfless service, and cultural heritage. From holy dips in the sacred Ganga and darshan of venerable saints to the grand processions (Peshwai) of the Akharas and an array of spiritual ceremonies, every moment of the Kumbh carries a transcendent grace.



Concerted efforts are underway to ensure the event is seamless, safe, and well-organized, with dedicated emphasis on enhanced connectivity, efficient traffic management, immaculate cleanliness, robust security, and world-class pilgrim amenities.

This grand gathering is not solely an expression of faith; it is a living embodiment of "Ek Bharat, Shreshtha Bharat", uniting people from diverse corners of the nation in a shared spirit of spiritual oneness. In view of this, the state government has initiated comprehensive preparations to ensure a flawless, hassle-free experience for every visiting pilgrim, sadhu, and seer.

"The construction of a developed India in the 21st century rests on two main pillars: first, pride in our heritage, and second, making every possible effort for development. Today, Uttarakhand is continuously strengthening both these pillars. This decade is the decade of Uttarakhand."

Narendra Modi
Prime Minister

Uttarakhand Tourism Policy 2023

A Robust Roadmap Driving Sustainable Development & Investment

The geographical, cultural, and natural diversity of Uttarakhand has positioned it among the most preferred tourism destinations in North India. The state has witnessed a steady rise in tourist footfall. In 2014, approximately 22 million (2.2 crore) tourists visited Uttarakhand, a figure that surged to around 39 million (3.9 crore) by 2019. During this period, the state recorded a Compound Annual Growth Rate (CAGR) of 11.97% in tourist arrivals.

According to a World Travel & Tourism Council report, India ranks as the world's seventh-largest tourism economy in terms of size. The report projected an estimated growth of approximately 7% in the tourism sector between 2017 and 2027. The state's new tourism policy aims to formulate a long-term roadmap for the sustainable and balanced growth of Uttarakhand's tourism sector. The role of the state government and its departments will primarily focus on policymaking, regulation, and tourism promotion. Concurrently, the private sector will play a central role in delivering services such as accommodation, tourist amenities, transportation, tour operations, activities, and events. The state government will act as a facilitator to create an enabling environment for these ventures.

Promoting Private Sector Investment

The policy highlights that private capital and industry expertise are vital for driving Uttarakhand's future tourism growth. To advance this objective, the government will promote Public-Private Partnerships (PPP). For efficient implementation, the state government will:

Reduce its direct involvement in sectors where private enterprise is encouraged, such as the development and management of tourist accommodations.

Focus on enhancing Ease of Doing Business for tourism investors.

Strengthen the Single Window Clearance System to ensure swift statutory approvals and project clearances.

Unlocking New Pathways for Tourism Development

The policy supports and incentivizes both greenfield and existing tourism ventures:

Capital Subsidy Eligibility: Newly established projects/enterprises in progress up to the subsidy application date qualify for capital subsidies. Existing units undertaking significant expansion or diversification are also eligible.

Turnover-Based Incentives: Operational tourism units and enterprises active by the application submission date are eligible for turnover-linked incentives.

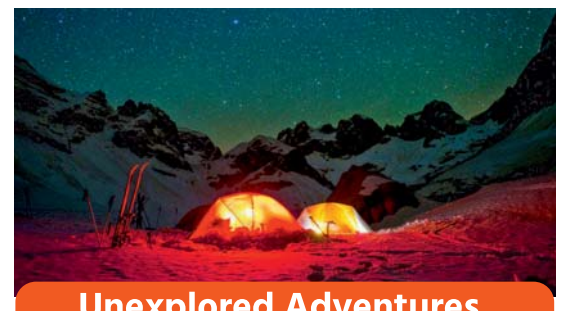
The policy aims to stimulate private investment while generating employment, boosting local entrepreneurship, and strengthening the state's economy.

Priority Focus Segments During the Policy Period : To bolster the tourism landscape, the state government will focus on specific priority niches:

- Promotion of eco-destinations alongside trekking, white-water rafting, and allied adventure pursuits.
- Encouragement of facilities dedicated to Yoga, Ayurveda, Naturopathy, and holistic healthcare. Preserving and highlighting sacred religious circuits, local folk culture, and traditions. Integrating historical landmarks, monuments, and traditional vernacular architecture into the tourism circuit. MICE Tourism: Development of infrastructure for Meetings, Incentives, Conferences, and Exhibitions.

Key Fiscal Incentives and Reliefs Under the Policy : Eligible tourism units will receive structured financial subsidies and concessions, including:

Capital subsidy for the hospitality sector: For hotel and accommodation-related projects. Incentives for marketing and promotion of investment in eligible tourism projects. Assistance for training and skill development. Interest subsidy/relief. Incentives for waste management and disposal. Incentives for increasing bookings through the State's online travel agency platform. Capital subsidy for investment in tourism products and services. Subsidies for projects and units that are not eligible for capital subsidy. Special incentives for premium and high-end hospitality projects. Incentives to attract foreign tourists. Incentives for organizing MICE events, art, social and cultural events, fairs, & festivals. Incentives to promote helicopter-based transportation. Exemption from electricity duty. Exemption from stamp duty.



Unexplored Adventures, Unforgettable Experiences

Uttarakhand – A Global Adventure Destination

When it comes to adventure tourism in India, Uttarakhand stands out as a favourite destination for adventure enthusiasts, thanks to its diverse landscapes and breathtaking natural surroundings. The state offers an abundance of thrilling activities that are sure to fill you with excitement and adrenaline. This is what makes Uttarakhand an exceptional destination for adventure lovers from across the world. Many tourists visit Uttarakhand specifically to experience these exciting activities. For adventure enthusiasts, the state offers a wide range of thrilling sports and experiences, including river rafting, trekking, hiking, bungee jumping, and much more.



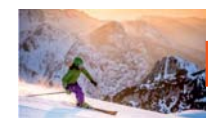
Trekking & Hiking

Trekking and hiking offer the perfect way to explore the remote and scenic landscapes of Uttarakhand. The traditional Roopkund Trek takes you through lush green forests and meadows, while the Valley of Flowers offers a breathtaking experience amidst vibrant alpine blooms. For adventure seekers, the Kedarkantha and Gaumukh–Tapovan treks promise unforgettable experiences that stay with you for a lifetime.



Bungee Jumping

Known as the Yoga Capital of the World, Rishikesh is also famous for its thrilling adventure experiences, including one of India's highest bungee jumping sites. Adventure enthusiasts come here to challenge gravity while taking in the spectacular Himalayan surroundings.



Skiing

Located in Chamoli district, Auli is a paradise for skiing enthusiasts. Adventure seekers travel through its winter wonderland, surrounded by snow-covered mountain slopes stretching into the distance. Auli is also renowned for hosting national winter sports events, giving athletes an opportunity to showcase their skills.



River Rafting

The rivers of Uttarakhand not only enhance the state's natural beauty but also offer exhilarating experiences for water-sports enthusiasts. From conquering rapids through white-water rafting to enjoying peaceful canoeing and kayaking experiences, the Ganga, Tons and Alaknanda rivers offer adventure seekers an unforgettable experience on the water.

Spiritual & Natural Gems Along the Journey

Near Yamunotri
Janki Chatti, Hanuman Chatti, Kharsali Village, Saptarishi Kund, Pandava Cave, Lakhamandal, Gangnani Kedarkantha Trek, Rana Chatti

Near Gangotri
Gaumukh Trek, Bhojbasa, Tapovan, Surya Kund & Gauri Kund, Harsil Valley, Mukhimath (Mukhba), Gangnani Dayara Bugyal Trek, Gartang Gali, Kashi Vishwanath Temple, Nachiketa Tal, Dodital

Near Kedarnath
Bhairavnath Temple, Vasuki Tal, Gaurikund, Triyuginarayan Temple, Chopta–Tungnath–Chandrashila, Guptkashi, Deoria Tal

Near Badrinath
Mana Village, Vyas Cave & Ganesh Cave, Bhim Shila, Auli, Valley of Flowers, Vasudhara Falls, Charan Paduka, Tapt Kund, Narad Kund, Jyotirmath (Joshimath), Satopanth Lake, Pandukeshwar, Adi Badri Temple, Hemkund Sahib

Seamless Journeys Through Devbhoomi

Uttarakhand is leveraging technology and infrastructure to provide visitors with a safe, comfortable and enriching travel experience.

The state is shaping a modern and culturally sensitive tourism model. Guided by Prime Minister Narendra Modi and inspired by the leadership of Chief Minister Pushkar Singh Dhami, Uttarakhand is combining technology, infrastructure development and heritage conservation to create safer and more enriching experiences for travellers.

For the Char Dham Yatra, an Aadhaar-based cloud registration system has been introduced to enhance pilgrim safety, enable hassle-free entry at checkpoints and ensure transparent data management. This innovation is modernising the pilgrimage experience while prioritising safety and accountability.

At Kainchi Dham, associated with the memory of Neem Karoli Baba, the government has invested ₹17 crore. The initiative aims to improve road connectivity, parking facilities, pilgrim amenities and environmentally sensitive infrastructure, while preserving the sanctity of this revered destination.

A ₹100-crore project is being implemented in the Jaunsar-Bawar region to restore Mahasu Devta temples, preserve traditional wooden architecture and promote cultural tourism. With active participation from local communities, the initiative is also empowering rural communities through homestays, festivals and handicrafts, ensuring that the benefits of tourism reach the grassroots.

Together, these initiatives present a shared vision of a "Seamless, Safe and Spiritual" journey across Uttarakhand. By balancing modern needs with cultural preservation, the state is positioning itself as a global example of sustainable and transformative tourism.

Uttarakhand Tourism A divine blend of natural splendor and spiritual sanctity. Nestled in the lap of the Himalayas, its renowned destinations captivate travelers from around the world. Trekking, white-water rafting, and wildlife sanctuaries also make it a prime hub for adventure enthusiasts.

Manaskhand Mandir Mala Scheme: A New Lifeline for Ancient Temples



Jageshwar Temple | Nanda Devi Temple | Katarmal Sun Temple | Kainchi Dham Temple | Purnagiri Temple

Under the Manaskhand Mandir Mala Scheme, the state government is undertaking infrastructure development around 48 ancient temples across the Kumaon region. In the first phase, 16 temples have been selected for development.

These include Jageshwar Temple, Golu Devta Temple, Katarmal Sun Temple, Kasar Devi, Nanda Devi, Patal Bhuvaneshwar Cave, Hat Kalika, Purnagiri, Naina Devi, Baleshwar, Kainchi Dham, Varahi Devi, Baijnath, Bagnath and Chaiti Balasundari Temple, along with other important religious sites across the region.

The scheme also covers several prominent temples and pilgrimage sites in Almora, Pithoragarh, Udham Singh Nagar, Champawat, Bageshwar and Nainital, including Jhankar Saim, Naithna Devi, Vindhyavasini, Mallika Devi, Syahi Devi, Mostamanu, Berinag, Malyanath, Thalkedar, Kotgiri, Atariya Temple, Nanakmatta, Moteswar Mahadev, Meetha Reetha Sahib, Guru Gorakhnath Temple, Maneshwar Temple, Kot Bhramari, Shikhar Bhanar, Girija Devi Temple, Hanuman Temple, Somwari Mahadev, Devguru Brihaspatidham and Hanuman Garhi Temple.

The initiative is expected to strengthen infrastructure, improve pilgrimage experiences and boost economic activity around the ancient temples of the Kumaon region.

Excellent Connectivity: Easier Access to Remote Areas

With new roads, ropeways and air services, Uttarakhand is making journeys through the mountains faster, safer and more comfortable than ever for pilgrims and tourists.

Rapid infrastructure development across Uttarakhand is creating new travel experiences for tourists and residents alike, generating greater interest in exploring the Himalayas. Through initiatives such as the Parvatmala Scheme and the All-Weather Road Project, the state is ensuring that faith and ease of travel progress together.

The Delhi–Dehradun Expressway enables travellers to reach the gateway to Uttarakhand from the national capital in just about two and a half hours. This important corridor connects with the All-Weather Char Dham Road, making access to Badrinath, Kedarnath, Gangotri and Yamunotri easier, even during challenging weather conditions.

Ropeway projects are transforming travel in the mountains. The 11.5-km Sonprayag–Kedarnath Ropeway is set to become one of the world's highest ropeways and will be capable of transporting thousands of pilgrims to the temple every hour. Similarly, the Govindghat–Hemkund Sahib Ropeway will reduce a difficult 12-hour trek to just 45 minutes, while the Dehradun–Mussoorie Ropeway will transform a 33-km mountain journey into a scenic 15-minute ride.

Air connectivity is also expanding rapidly. Under the Mukhyamantri Udan Khatola Yojana, helicopter services are connecting remote districts, while Jolly Grant and Pantnagar airports are being upgraded to international standards.



To further strengthen spiritual connectivity, the Uttarakhand Tourism Development Council, in collaboration with IRCTC, has launched the Manaskhand Express under the Bharat Gaurav initiative. This special tourist train connects pilgrims from cities such as Pune, Madurai and Mumbai with prominent and lesser-known religious destinations in Uttarakhand, including Jageshwar, Purnagiri, Badrinath, Kedarnath and Kartik Swami Temple.

The initiative is not only improving access to remote areas but also providing a boost to local tourism, homestay businesses and employment opportunities.

This integrated network of roads, ropeways and air services reflects Uttarakhand's commitment to inclusive development. It is making travel easier while strengthening the state's economy, promoting tourism and bringing the vision of a seamless, safe and welcoming journey closer to reality.

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Accelerating Sustainable Development

We come to Dev Bhoomi Uttarakhand from our native places with one or more resolutions in our hearts. In the same spirit, I would like to urge you to take these five pledges
- Narendra Modi

First Pledge – Cleanliness First

Second Pledge – Respect for Nature and the Environment

Third Pledge – Emphasis on Service, Cooperation and Unity

Fourth Pledge – Promote Vocal for Local

Fifth Pledge – Follow Discipline, Safety and Dignity

Welcome to Devbhoomi Uttarakhand